

Section-A

➤ **Reading Comprehension**

Reading Comprehension



Previous Year Questions

Discursive Passage

CBSE 2024

Passage I

Read the text given below:

- (1) Held every year on 21 May, UNESCO leads the celebration of World Day for Cultural Diversity for Dialogue and Development highlighting not only the richness of the world's cultures, but also the essential role of intercultural dialogue for achieving peace and sustainable development.
- (2) A recent international emergency has proved the intrinsic value of the cultural and creative sector at generating social cohesion, educational resource or personal well-being in times of crisis. It has also underscored the sector's potential to generate economic growth, something which is too often underestimated.
- (3) With the adoption in September 2015 of the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development by the United Nations, and the re Answer on Culture and Sustainable Development adopted by the UN General Assembly in December 2015, the message of the World Day for Cultural Diversity for Dialogue and Development is more important than ever. The 17 Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) can best be achieved by drawing upon the creative potential of the world's diverse cultures and engaging in continuous dialogue to ensure that all members of society benefit from sustainable development.
- (4) Bridging the gap between cultures is urgent and necessary for peace, stability and development.

Cultural diversity is a driving force of development, not only with respect to economic growth, but also as a means of leading a more fulfilling intellectual, emotional, moral and spiritual life. This is captured in the culture conventions, which provide a solid basis for the promotion of cultural diversity. Cultural diversity is thus an asset that is indispensable for poverty reduction and the achievement of sustainable development.

- (5) At the same time, acceptance and recognition of cultural diversity in particular through innovative use of media and Information and Communications Technologies (ICTs) are conducive to dialogue among civilizations and cultures, respect and mutual understanding.
- (6) In 2001, UNESCO adopted the Universal Declaration on Cultural Diversity. Next, in December 2002, the UN General Assembly, in its resolution 57/249, declared May 21 to be the World Day for Cultural Diversity for Dialogue and Development, and in 2015, the Second Committee of the UN General Assembly unanimously adopted the resolution on Culture and Sustainable Development, affirming culture's contribution to the three dimensions of sustainable development, acknowledging further the natural and cultural diversity of the world, and recognizing that cultures and civilizations can contribute to, and are crucial enablers of, sustainable development.
- (7) The day provides us with an opportunity to deepen our understanding of the values of cultural diversity and to achieve the goals of the UNESCO Convention on the Protection and Promotion of the Diversity of Cultural Expressions adopted on 20 October, 2005.

Answer the following questions, based on the above passage:

- Based on the reading and understanding of the above passage, list 2 points to describe the purpose of UNESCO leading the celebration of World Day for Cultural Diversity for Dialogue and Development.
- Select the option that corresponds to the meaning of the following sentence from para (2). The recent international emergency has proved the intrinsic value of the cultural and creative sector at generating social cohesion, educational resource or personal well-being in times of crisis.
 - the real worth of cultural sector at generating social cohesion during pandemics
 - the real worth of creative sector at undermining the social cohesion during an international emergency
 - questioning the real worth of creative sector at generating education resource during an international emergency
 - highlighting the real worth of cultural and creative sector at generating social cohesion and educational resource during an international emergency
- Based on your reading of the passage, examine in about 40 words how Sustainable Development Goals can be achieved.
- What is the tone of the writer in the given line from paragraph (4)? Rationalise your response in about 40 words: "Cultural diversity is an asset."
- The phrase 'bridging the gap' in paragraph (4) refers to:
 - widening the differences
 - connecting two desperate ideas
 - supporting the bridging
 - filling in the space between two connected things
- In sets below, identify two sets of synonyms.
 - richness and poverty
 - intellectual and moral
 - reduction and promotion
 - essential and intrinsic
 - urgent and crucial

Options:

(a) (i) and (iii)	(c) (ii) and (v)
(c) (vi) and (v)	(d) (ii) and (iv)
- Complete the sentence appropriately:
The Second Committee of UN General Assembly in 2015 adopted _____.
- Complete the following sentence:
_____ is urgent and necessary for peace, stability and development.

Passage 2

Read the text given below

- Fossil fuels (oil, coal, and natural gas) are our most traditional sources for power generation. The energy that's produced from any source other than fossil fuels is termed as alternative energy. Between the two sources, using alternative energy has a lower environmental impact.
- We now know that alternative energy sources are the sources we use to supplement or even replace traditional energy sources used for power generation. You could almost say the same thing about renewable energy sources. But there is one subtle difference between the two. All renewable energy sources fall under the category of alternative energy sources, but it doesn't work the other way around.
- That's because renewable energy sources are derived from naturally replenished sources or processes of Earth, such as the sun, wind, and water. We refer to these resources as renewable or sustainable since, unlike fossil fuels, this naturally occurring continual renewal makes them inexhaustible. However, alternative energy sources are exhaustible, and therefore not renewable. That's the difference!
- The equipment necessary to harness energy from alternative sources used to be so expensive that it wasn't practical for consumer use. However, thanks to increased demand, more experienced energy developers, competitive supply chains, improved renewable technologies, and enhanced energy efficiency capabilities, that's no longer the case.
- When it comes to energy efficiency, the leader of the renewable energy pack is wind energy. Behind wind comes geothermal energy, hydropower, nuclear energy, and then solar power. Wind power serves both individuals and entire communities. It is versatile, and can be produced from small-scale windmills or wind turbines on residential properties. It can also be produced from large-scale offshore wind farms in the ocean.
- We generate geothermal power by tapping into underground reservoirs of hot water and steam. Geothermal electricity can directly heat and cool buildings. Generated from the energy of moving water, hydroelectricity (also known as hydropower) is produced when water behind a dam causes turbine blades to move as it flows through an intake. The turbine blades then rotate

a generator to produce electricity that is sent to power homes.

- (7) Nuclear energy is created in the form of heat through the fission process of atoms. The initial fission process creates energy and triggers a chain reaction that repeats the process and generates more energy. In nuclear power plants, the heat that fission produces creates steam. The steam then rotates a turbine, which leads to the production of electricity.
- (8) Solar power most commonly refers to the use of solar cells to create energy. On a small scale, you may see a few solar panels on a house roof used to produce energy for just that one home. On a larger scale, you may see a solar farm used as a power plant to produce electricity for its consumers.

Answer the following questions, based on the above passage:

- Which of the following statements best describes the difference between renewable energy sources and alternate energy sources?
 - Alternative energy sources are more expensive than renewable energy sources.
 - Renewable energy sources are inexhaustible whereas alternate energy sources could be exhaustible.
 - Alternative energy sources are as renewable as renewable energy sources.
 - Renewable energy sources are exhaustible but alternative energy sources are inexhaustible.
- What is the tone of the writer in the given lines from para (4)? Rationalise your response in about 40 words.

"However, thanks to increased demand, more experienced energy developers, competitive supply chains, improved renewable technologies, and enhanced energy efficiency capabilities, that's no longer the case".
- Complete the sentence appropriately: In the past, alternative energy sources were not used much by the consumers because _____.
- The passage includes some words that are opposites of each other.

From the sets (a) to (e) below, identify two sets of antonyms:

 - generate and produce
 - exhaustible and inexhaustible
 - subtle and versatile
 - power and energy
 - sustainable and exhaustible

- Who is the leader of renewable energy pack and why?
- Based on the reading of the passage, examine, in about 40 words, the difference between geothermal electricity and hydroelectricity.
- What is the message conveyed by the passage?
 - Only those energy sources should be used which are renewable.
 - Wind energy is a renewable as well as inexhaustible source of energy.
 - There are plenty of renewable energy sources that can be used to replace traditional energy sources.
 - Alternative energy sources are the emerging energy trends and are still evolving.
- State whether the following statement is True or False with reference to the given extract.

Hydroelectricity as a renewable energy source is used for residential as well as commercial purposes.

Passage 3

- Plastic pollution has become one of the most pressing environmental issues, as rapidly increasing production of disposable plastic products overwhelms the world's ability to deal with them. Plastic pollution is most visible in developing Asian and African nations, where garbage collection systems are often inefficient or non-existent. But the developed world, especially in countries with low recycling rates, also has trouble properly collecting discarded plastics. Plastic trash has become so ubiquitous that it has prompted efforts to write a global treaty negotiated by the United Nations.
- Plastics made from fossil fuels are just over a century old. Production and development of thousands of new plastic products accelerated after World War II. It transformed the modern age so much that life without plastics is unrecognizable today. Plastics revolutionized medicine with life-saving devices, made space travel possible, lightened cars and jets – saving fuel and pollution – and saved lives with helmets, incubators, and equipment for clean drinking water.
- The conveniences plastics offer, however, led to a throw-away culture that reveals the material's dark side: today, single-use plastics account for



40 percent of the plastic produced every year. Many of these products, such as plastic bags and food wrappers, have a lifespan of mere minutes to hours, yet they may persist in the environment for hundreds of years.

- (4) Most of the plastic trash in the oceans, Earth's last sink, flows from land. Trash is also carried to sea by major rivers, which act as conveyor belts, picking up more and more trash as they move downstream. Once at sea, much of the plastic trash remains in coastal waters. But once caught up in ocean currents, it can be transported around the world.
- (5) Millions of animals are killed by plastics every year, from birds to fish to other marine organisms. Nearly 700 species, including endangered ones, are known to have been affected by plastics. Nearly every species of seabirds eats plastics. Most of the deaths of animals are caused by entanglement or starvation. Seals, whales, turtles, and other animals are strangled by abandoned fishing gear or discarded six-pack rings.
- (6) The solution is to prevent plastic waste from entering rivers and seas in the first place, many scientists and conservationists including the National Geographic Society say. This could be accomplished with improved waste management systems and recycling, better product design that takes into account the short life of disposable packaging, and reduction in manufacturing of unnecessary single-use plastics.

Answer the following questions, based on the above passage:

1. Which of the following statements best describes the reason why plastic pollution has become one of the most pressing environmental issues?
2. What is the tone of the writer in the given lines from paragraph 2? Rationalise your response in about 40 words.
3. The passage includes some words that are opposites of each other. From the sets (i)-(v) below, identify two sets of synonyms.
 - (i) garbage and trash
 - (ii) starvation and strangled
 - (iii) disposable and reduction
 - (iv) persist and downstream
 - (v) transformed and revolutionized

4. Complete the sentence appropriately:

The writer says that most of the plastic trash is found in the Earth's last sink and the reason it is transported around the world is _____.

5. Based on the reading of the passage, examine, in about 40 words, the downside of the convenience that plastic offers.
6. Complete the sentence appropriately:

According to conservationists, the two ways in which most of the deaths of animals are caused are _____.
7. Based on the passage, how can we contribute to the reduction of plastic waste?
 - (a) by internationalising the waste management system
 - (b) by minimizing the use of single-use plastics
 - (c) by not abandoning fishing gear
 - (d) by not using helmets made for plastic
8. State one reason why plastic pollution is most visible in developing Asian and African nations.

Passage 4

Read the following passage carefully:

- (1) The words probiotics, prebiotics, and postbiotics may sound like variations of the same thing, but what a difference a prefix makes. The first is a category of health-promoting microbes. The latter two groups are types of beneficial molecules. But all three biotics are critical for supporting the community of microscopic organisms that live in the gastrointestinal tract, known as the gut microbiome. With both beneficial and harmful bacteria living in the human body, these diet-related factors the biotics help tip the balance in the positive direction. It is important to understand their differences, as you'll see, because each of these factors serves a distinct purpose, even as they work together.
- (2) Despite their importance for the gut microbiome, the health benefits of these 'biotics', which are present in certain foods or result from their metabolism, extend beyond the digestive tract. A growing body of scientific evidence has linked prebiotics, probiotics, and postbiotics, with improvements in metabolic diseases including obesity and cholesterol abnormalities depressive symptoms and poor sleep quality, among many other conditions.

- (3) Besides promoting general gut health, consuming food rich in probiotics can improve irritable bowel syndrome and antibiotic-related diarrhea, prevent traveller's diarrhea, produce vitamins and increase nutrient absorption, and decrease the risk of common infections. In fact, when consumed regularly, probiotics have been found to reduce the occurrence of upper respiratory tract infections (like the common cold),
- (4) Many different types of beneficial bacteria are considered probiotics. The most common ones include Lactobacillus and Bifidobacterium, of which there are dozens of strains. "You have to match what it is you're concerned about with the probiotic you should use," says Gregor Reid. Many different types of beneficial bacteria are considered probiotics.
- (5) Some foods, such as yogurt, kefir, kimchee, and fermented soybeans and kombucha naturally contain probiotics. But here's where things get complicated: not all fermented foods or yogurts contain probiotics, Reid says. As a consumer, a good starting point is to look for the phrase "contains live and active cultures" on the label; it's even better if specific strains of bacteria are listed, because then you'll know you're getting the right stuff.
- (6) Simply put, prebiotics are sources of food for those beneficial microbes the probiotics. They are typically a form of carbohydrate or fiber that we don't have the enzymes to digest. As a result, they move through the digestive tract to the intestine, where beneficial bacteria (probiotics) can feast on them.
- (7) When you consume foods that are rich in probiotics and prebiotics, the microbes in your gut consume the undigestible prebiotic fiber and produce bioactive compounds called postbiotics. They are ultimately the endgame that we want they affect how our gut operates and keeps the good bacteria there and the bad bacteria out.

Answer the following questions, based on the above passage:

1. Which of the following statements best describes the author's attitude towards probiotics?
 - (a) Probiotics, prebiotics and postbiotics are variations of the same thing, with just a difference of a prefix.
 - (b) All fermented foods or yogurts naturally contain probiotics.

- (c) All three biotics are equally important to support microscopic organisms that live in the gut microbiome.
 - (d) Only probiotics are important as they can improve irritable bowel syndrome and antibiotic-related diarrhea.
2. According to the writer, health benefits of all the 'biotics' extend beyond the digestive tract. Rationalise your response in about 40 words.
3. Complete the sentence appropriately. To get the right probiotic and to match it with your body's requirement, it is important to see the label for _____.
4. The passage includes some words that are opposites of each other. From the sets (i)-(v) below, identify two sets of antonyms.
 - (i) increase and decrease
 - (ii) probiotic and postbiotic
 - (iii) beneficial and harmful
 - (iv) feast and fermented
 - (v) consuming and digestive
5. Complete the sentence appropriately.
The author wants to stress the fact that there is not just one type of beneficial bacteria considered as probiotic, in fact, some probiotics have_____.
6. Based on the reading of the passage, examine in about 40 words, the importance of prebiotics for the human gut and how they are related to probiotics.
7. As a consumer, if you want to pick a probiotic product, what is the most important thing to keep in mind? Pick the best answer.
 - (a) Any fermented product that contains probiotics.
 - (b) Checking the label for specific strains of bacteria.
 - (c) All products under "probiotics" section in a grocery store are safe to pick.
 - (d) Checking the label which clearly says "probiotics" is sufficient.
8. "Despite their importance for the gut microbiome, the health benefits of these 'biotics', which are present in certain foods or result from their metabolism, extend beyond the digestive tract."
As per this statement from the passage, how relevant are the 'biotics' for humans? Pick the best answer.
 - (a) Their relevance has been proven by scientific evidence.
 - (b) Not very relevant as more study is needed.
 - (c) Their relevance cannot be generalised for everyone.
 - (d) Only probiotics are relevant for humans.



Passage I

Read the passage given below:

- I. If you're like most kids, you may love snow. Not only can it get you out of school, but it's also fun to play with. Who doesn't love to sled and build snowmen ? Snow can also be dangerous, too. You may have heard your parents talk about how difficult it can be to drive in snow. Car accidents aren't the only dangers created by snow. If you're ever skiing in the mountains, you'll want to be aware of avalanches. An avalanche is a sudden flow of snow down a slope, such as a mountain. The amount of snow in an avalanche will vary based on many things, but it can be such a huge pile that it can bury the bottom of a slope in dozens of feet of snow.
- II. Avalanches can be caused by many things. Some of them are natural. For example, new snow or rain can cause built up snow to loosen and fall down the side of a mountain. Earthquakes and the movement of animals have also been known to cause avalanches. Artificial triggers can also cause avalanches. For example, snowmobiles, skiers, gunshots and explosives have all been known to cause avalanches. Avalanches usually occur during the winter and spring, when snowfall is greatest. As they are dangerous to any living beings in their path, avalanches have destroyed forests, roads, railroads and even entire towns.
- III. Warning signs exist that allow experts to predict – and often prevent – avalanches from occurring. When over a foot of fresh snow falls, experts know to be on the lookout for avalanches. Explosives can be used in places with massive snow build-ups to trigger smaller avalanches that don't pose a danger to persons or property. When deadly avalanches do occur, the moving snow can quickly reach over 80 miles per hour. Skiers caught in such avalanches can be buried under dozens of feet of snow. While it's possible to dig out of such avalanches, not all are able to escape.
- IV. If you get tossed about by an avalanche and find yourself buried under many feet of snow, you might not have a true sense of which way is up and which way is down. Some avalanche victims have tried to

dig their way out, only to find that they were upside down and digging themselves farther under the snow rather than to the top ! Experts suggest that people caught in an avalanche try to “swim” to the top of the moving snow to stay close to the surface. Once the avalanche stops, do your best to dig around you to create a space for air, so you can breathe easier. Then, do your best to figure out which way is up and dig in that direction to reach the surface and signal rescuers.

Based on your understanding of the passage, answer the questions given below:

1. Complete the sentence by choosing an appropriate option:
Avalanches can be caused by
(a) new snow or rain.
(b) heavy winds.
(c) high altitude.
(d) global warming.
2. Comment on warning signs exist which allow experts to predict avalanches in two sentences.
3. Mention two reasons which destroyed the natural scenery.
4. Select the option that conveys the opposite of 'massive' :
(a) tiny (b) lengthy
(c) bulky (d) extensive
5. The writer will agree with one of the given statements (paragraph 4)
(a) People caught in the Avalanche can try to swim to the top.
(b) Put on an oxygen Mask.
(c) Digging is not possible.
(d) Should not come close to the surface.
6. Select the option that corresponds to the following relation below :
You may not have an idea of which way is up and which way is down.
(a) The crowd will gather at Gate No. 1 and disperse from Gate No. 2.
(b) Due to the torrential rain, there was heavy flooding.
(c) The guest felt uneasy and uncomfortable watching the child's performance.
(d) The more the effort, the bigger the gain.

7. The major causes which do not trigger an avalanche:
 - (a) Earthquakes
 - (b) Snowfall
 - (c) Rain
 - (d) Plastic waste
8. Explosives can be used in places _____.
(complete the sentence)
9. The word 'deadly' in the (3) paragraph most nearly means
 - (a) likely to cause death
 - (b) harmful
 - (c) very boring
 - (d) scary
10. Select the most suitable title for the above passage :
 - (a) Avalanches
 - (b) Adventure with Snow
 - (c) Ice Games
 - (d) Calamity

CBSE 2022

Passage I

Read the passage given below.

- I. History in general remains an endeavour to search for the truth about the past in a contemporary light. The search is done by examining the treasure trove of a documented past. This also holds true for the history of food. Cookbooks have always played an instrumental role in researching the history of any community. The roots of recording the history of food are nearly as old as the history of writing itself. In the East, Meng Shen of T'ang dynasty recorded the origin and usage of every food consumed in the court. In India, mythology mentions that the oldest and first ever book on cookery is Pakadarpanam (The Mirror of Culinary Skills), written by King Nala.
- II. Cookbooks are a guiding light that can take one on a journey of understanding traditions and culture. Scholars in the past also believed that cookbooks are a source of information not only to understand social or gender-specific roles but also material factors such as trade and network.
- III. So what could be considered a cookbook in our modern society? It has been noted recently that there is a surge in the number of infotainment and documentary programs about food. Recipes are no

longer just about cookbooks. In fact, a new breed of Indian culinary experts are cooking their way to celebrity status. And they are achieving this via social media. As they demystify Indian cuisine and offer step-by-step guidance to creating mouthwatering Indian dishes, these talented men and women are inspiring a lot of Indians to pick up their ladles and try out various recipes in their own kitchens.

- IV. The social media chefs are here to stay. No longer does an amateur home chef have to struggle with trying to understand what exactly the recipe instruction means when it says things like, "the batter should be of pouring consistency". Now one can see the chef demonstrate on video what exactly 'pouring consistency' ought to be like.
- V. A lot of people used these recipes that were easily available on social media to get through the COVID-19 pandemic. Cooking, which was considered a necessity at the beginning of the COVID-19 lockdown days, turned into a recreational activity over time. It also functioned as a tool to improve people's psychological well-being. This gave them a goal-oriented behaviour to engage in, while also being a way to connect with others by sharing recipes or posting pictures of their creations on social media. Thus, documenting recipes online is the modern version of authoring a cookbook.

On the basis of your understanding of the passage, answer the following questions:

1. The search is done by examining the treasure trove of a documented past. This also holds true for the history of food. (Paragraph II) Why would the author refer to cookbooks as a 'treasure trove'?
 - (a) because they contain recipes for rich foods.
 - (b) because writing them requires a lot of time and money.
 - (c) because they hold a wealth of information about the past.
 - (d) because writing recipes is considered a rewarding experience.
2. Refer to the following from Paragraph I
Meng Shen: Records of food consumed in court
King Nala: Pakadarpanam, the oldest book on cookery. (Paragraph I) Which of the options display the MOST LIKELY the reason the first cookbooks were from royal households?
 - (a) The royalty was involved in the planning of all their meals.
 - (b) The royalty wanted ordinary folk to know how to eat like kings.



- (c) The royalty had to be ready to serve special food to foreign visitors.
- (d) The royalty had the resources to create complex dishes and document them.
3. Cookbooks are a guiding light... (paragraph II)
- (a) It takes you on a journey of understanding traditions and culture.
- (b) These grapes are as sweet as candy.
- (c) These biscuits are delicious. They're the best!
- (d) This recipe was so interesting. It jumped right off the page.
4. The author says 'cookbooks are a source of information to understand gender-specific roles.' (Paragraph II) State one of the ways how cookbooks could reveal information on gender-specific roles.
5. Provide one example of how cookbooks can be a source of information about trade and network.
6. Complete the following with a phrase from paragraph III.

Phrase	Meaning
_____	gradually progress from one stage to the next

7. The social media chefs are here to stay. (Paragraph IV) Which of these best describes the tone in the above line?
- (a) curious (b) hopeful
- (c) confident (d) argumentative
8. Based on the passage, state any two reasons why more Indians are exploring the art of cooking.
1. _____
2. _____
9. In the passage, which of these is NOT suggested as a reason for people posting on social media about the food they cooked?
- (a) to share that they have completed a task.
- (b) to maintain a record of all that they have cooked.
- (c) to explain the steps they used for making the dish.
- (d) to create a sense of competition among their followers.
10. Write an appropriate title for this passage.

CBSE 2021

Passage I

Read the passage given below.

- I. Nature is our mother, our first teacher. The greatest lesson that she teaches us is to maintain an

equilibrium in life. We learn to maintain composure through our joys, sorrows and fears. In fact, there are a thousand lessons that nature can teach us, provided we look for them.

- II. With time, a sapling grows into a full-grown tree; something so tiny and delicate develops into a strong tree capable of supporting others. No matter how tall it grows, how much it may flourish, or how many animals and birds it may support, its roots are firmly buried from where it once rose. That's a lesson - to keep ourselves grounded, respect and embrace our roots, and give something back to those humble beginnings that nurtured us into who we are.
- III. Then there is the message of peaceful coexistence. 'I am because we are.' Nature provides every creature a chance to exist. However, the existence of one creature or being depends on the existence of the other. The tiger eats the antelope; without the antelope, the tiger wouldn't survive. Likewise, without tigers, the over-abundance of antelopes would cause them to starve to death.
- IV. I wonder if you have noticed that when birds or squirrels see a predator, they give out an alarm call to their fellow creatures, of the lurking danger. They put themselves in danger to save the lives of others. Many animals, like the salmon, usually die after they spawn, but this doesn't stop them. One life extinguished for the betterment of others is a small price to pay.
- V. The snow melts in the warmth of spring to give birth to fresh green leaves. In autumn these leaves age into shades of gold only to be buried in the cold grave of winter. Change is inevitable; the sooner we embrace this, the better it is for us. We must also understand that even in pain there is growth. If you cut a hole in the tree, it will grow around it. No matter what may come in its way, a river will continue to flow. Similarly, no matter what grief may break your heart, nature teaches us that life goes on.
- VI. Keep in mind life isn't about making lists and trying to be one step ahead of others. Life is to live. Take a break-stop being a workaholic, and smell the roses, do whatever makes you feel happy and most of all spend some time with nature to pick up invaluable lessons.

On the basis of your understanding of the passage, answer the following questions:

- According to the author, what, from the following, is the greatest lesson being taught by nature?
 (a) balanced in our emotions.
 (b) partial to joys in life.
 (c) afraid of unhappiness.
 (d) indifferent to fears.
- Select the option that suitably completes the dialogue with reference to paragraph II.
 Jai: I've done well for myself in this school. I'm the best they have. I can get admission anywhere. This is my moment!
 Sid: Congratulations! Just remember, we should
 (a) become strong despite our weakness.
 (b) be kind and supportive towards everyone.
 (c) respect the origins from where we have grown.
 (d) nurture ourselves well from the beginning.
- Choose the option that best conveys the message in- 'I am because we are.'
 (a) Tigers are dependent on antelope.
 (b) Antelope are dependent on tigers.
 (c) Humans are dependent on animals.
 (d) Everyone is dependent on each other.
- What qualities do the birds and squirrels display when they warn others of possible danger? Choose one option from the following:
 (a) Observation skills and alertness.
 (b) Tendency to get easily frightened.
 (c) Selfless assistance to help others.
 (d) Determination to protect themselves.
- Select the option with the underlined words that can suitably replace lurking (paragraph IV).
 (a) The policeman pulled up the person who was wandering aimlessly through the city.
 (b) The thief knew that remaining hidden was the best strategy to avoid being caught.
 (c) The policeman was caught on camera while pouncing with force, to grab the fleeing culprit.
 (d) The thief was walking boldly into the house thinking it was devoid of residents.
- A Portmanteau words like smog (smoke + fog), is a blend of words in which parts of multiple words are combined into a new word.

From the options given below, select a Portmanteau word that appears in the para VI.

- coexistence
 - workaholic
 - full-grown
 - flourish
- Select the qualities from paragraph III, that the author wants us to imbibe.
 Being-
 (1) acceptive (2) passionate
 (3) emotional (4) resilient
 (5) perceptive
 (a) (2), (4) and (5) (b) (1), (3) and (4)
 (c) (1), (4) and (5) (d) (3), (4) and (5)
 - Which of the following is shown by the changing of seasons?
 (a) The beauty of nature.
 (b) Nature's creativity.
 (c) All seasons are equal.
 (d) Nothing lasts forever.
 - What does the writer advise, in paragraph VI?
 (a) Indulging in competition with others.
 (b) Making priority lists.
 (c) Taking life seriously.
 (d) Having free time for ourselves.
 - Choose the option that lists the quote best expressing the central idea of the passage.
 (a) Nature: She pardons no mistakes. Her yea is yea, and her nay, nay. -Ralph Waldo Emerson
 (b) Look deep into nature, and then you will understand everything better. - A. Einstein
 (c) Nature never deceives us; it is we who deceive ourselves. -Jean Jacques Rousseau
 (d) All the ugliness of the world can best be forgotten in the beauty of nature! -Mehmet Murat

CBSE 2020

Passage I

Read the following passage carefully:

- After water, tea is the most popular beverage in the world. Its popularity has survived thousands of years and has played an important role in many cultures. It is enjoyed both hot and cold, as a refreshing drink, as part of a ceremony, or as a tonic for improving health.



- II.** The drink of Asia for hundreds of years, tea is believed to have been brought to Europe by the Dutch. Today, from remote Ladakh in India to Buckingham Palace in London, tea means happiness. It is rightly said that there will be no agreement on a perfect cup of tea. Though for tea drinkers, the drink is addictive, the preferred method of preparation and taste differ from person to person and region to region. From traditional black teas, to the newer, and extraordinarily healthy white teas, and recognizable flavoured teas such as Earl Grey, to exotic blends such as Rooibos Love, there is a flavour and a blend for everyone. Today many varieties of tea and tea brands are available in the market. An innovation is the tea bag that is easy, quick and less messy than traditional ways of making tea. Green tea is popular in China.
- III.** In Japan, the tea ceremony is a traditional way of greeting guests and is a social occasion. Unlike the tea we are familiar with, green tea is not drunk with sugar or milk. It is an olive-coloured liquid served in porcelain cups. In Morocco, green tea is served with freshly plucked mint.
- IV.** Some scientists believe that tea prevents tooth decay because it is a rich source of fluoride.
- V.** Tea is also a traditional remedy for stomach upsets, flu and diarrhoea. Tea is also said to have anti-oxidants that fight cancer and also have anti-ageing properties that fight the free radicals in our bodies. Research suggests that drinking tea reduces the risk of heart disease and cancer and lowers cholesterol levels in the blood.
- VI.** A welcome thought for tea drinkers. Tea is the new apple a day to keep the doctor away. On the basis of your reading of the passage given above, answer the following questions by choosing the most appropriate options from the given choices:
- The most popular beverage in the world is:
 - cold drink
 - tea
 - green tea
 - water
 - Who introduced tea to Europe?
 - Indians
 - Chinese
 - Dutch
 - Japanese
 - Which kind of tea is not mentioned in the passage?
 - Black tea
 - Green tea
 - White tea
 - Yellow tea
 - The new and convenient way of making tea is:
 - using many brands of tea
 - making flavoured tea
 - by using tea bags
 - by boiling tea leaves
 - Why is 'a cup of tea a day' compared to 'an apple a day'?
 - Both tea and apple are prescribed by the doctors
 - All teas are as inexpensive as apples
 - Both tea and apple promote health
 - Tea is full of anti-oxidants and apple is very tasty
 - Where is the tea ceremony a traditional way of greeting guests?
 - China
 - Japan
 - Morocco
 - India
 - Complete the statement given below: Fluorides in tea are useful for preventing
 - Earl Grey is a green tea. (True/False)

Case-Based/Factual Passage

CBSE 2024

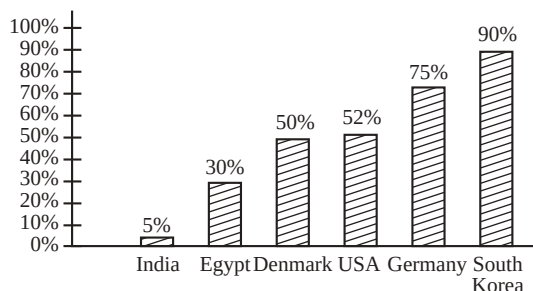
Passage I

Read the extract given below:

- The National Education Policy 2020 proposes the revision and 10 Marks revamping of all aspects of education, including the educational structure, regulations and governance, to create a new system which is aligned with the aspirational goals of 21st century students. According to the policy, by 2025, at least 50% of learners through the school and higher education system shall have exposure to skill education, for which a clear action plan with targets and timelines are to be developed.
- The policy aims to overcome the social status hierarchy associated with skill education and integration of skill education into mainstream education in all educational institutions in a phased manner. Beginning with skill exposure at early ages in middle and secondary school, quality skill education will be integrated smoothly into school and higher education.

- (3) Every child will learn at least one skill and is exposed to several more. This would lead to emphasizing the dignity of labour and importance of various vocations involving Indian arts and artisanship.
- (4) The development of skill capacities will go hand-in-hand with the development of 'academic' or other capacities. To achieve this objective, secondary schools will have to collaborate with Industrial Training Institutes (ITIS), Polytechnics, Local Industry, etc. Skill labs will also be set up and created in the schools in a Hub and Spoke model, which will allow other schools to use the facility. Higher education institutions will offer skill education either on their own or in partnership with industry and other institutions.

The Global Scenario of Students in Skill Education Sector.



- Based on the reading of the extract, list 2 objectives of NEP 2020:
- Fill in the blank with the appropriate option from those given in the brackets, based on the understanding of paragraph (4):

The development of skill capacities will go hand-in-hand with the development of academic or other capacities” is a/an_____ (fact/opinion) because it is a/an_____ (subjective judgement / objective detail)

- Select the option that corresponds to the meaning of the statement given below:

According to the policy, by 2025, at least 50% of learners through the school and higher education system shall have exposure to skill education.”

- Maximum 50% learners shall have exposure to technical education.
- Minimum 50% learners shall have exposure to technical education.
- Minimum 50% learners shall have exposure to skill education.
- Maximum 50% learners shall have exposure to skill education

- Based on the understanding of the passage, complete the following statement appropriately:

The benefit of the hub and spoke model will be_____.

- Complete the following analogy correctly with a word/phrase from paragraph (3):

Racism : condemn :: _____ : respect

- As per the Global Scenario, which country has the maximum percentage of students in Skill Education and what can be the possible reason?

- Fill in the following blank choosing the most appropriate option from the ones given below:

As per NEP 2020, skill exposure will begin at

- middle and secondary school.
- primary school
- higher school
- senior secondary school

- Justify the statement – “The NEP will create an awareness and appreciation of Indian arts and artisanship.”

Passage 2

Read the passage given below:

- Mango (*Mangifera indica*) is Asia's most popular fruit, and it has gained popularity around the world. It has long been a component of culture and religion as a useful and tasty fruit. In addition to taste, it has many good qualities thus making it to be called as "King of Fruits Major mango-growing states in India include Andhra Pradesh, Uttar Pradesh, Karnataka, Bihar, Gujarat and Tamil Nadu. Andhra Pradesh and Uttar Pradesh are the leading states in mango production.
- Mango is grown in an area of 5.58 million hectares of area in the world. India is the largest producer of mangoes with 46.02 and 45.88 percent of the total world area and production, respectively However, India being the major shareholder in terms of mango production, exports only 0.52% of its total production indicating the huge gap in exporting of mangoes. Peru exports about 46%, Thailand 24%, Mexico 18% and Brazil 11% of their total mango production. These countries are the bigger challenges for Indian mango exports. Hence, efforts are needed to evolve cheap transportation mechanism, increase the trade agreements with major importing countries and enhance the productivity.

- (3) The top importing country is United States of America, however India exports only two percent of its total exports to the USA. The USA, European countries, the UK, Malaysia and Russia can be the other hotspots where India can target to export the mangoes. The critical issue for exporting to the USA is transportation cost (due to sea route distance) and limited shelf life of mango, while for Europe transportation costs as well as competition by African countries are the major hurdles

The following chart shows the major export destinations of Indian mangoes in 2019-20:

S.No.	Country	Percentage
1.	U.S.A.	2
2.	Kuwait	2
3.	Saudi Arabia	3
4.	Qatar	6
5.	Bangladesh	6
6.	Oman	7
7.	U.K.	9
8.	Nepal	24
9.	United Arab Emirates	33
10.	Bahrain	2
11.	Others	6

(Adapted for academic usage.)

Answer the following questions, based on the passage above

1. Complete the following analogy appropriately, based on your understanding of Para (1) :

We can say that for becoming the king of jungle, Lion has to be the strongest, bravest and the fiercest. Similarly, Mango is known as the king of fruits because_____.

2. Fill in the blanks with the appropriate option from those given in brackets, based on your understanding of Para (2):

The statement that, India is the largest producer of Mangoes with 45.88 percent of the total world production can be attributed to Indian orchardists, is a/an_____. (fact/opinion) because it is a/an_____. (subjective judgement/objective detail)

3. Justify the following in about 40 words:

India being the major shareholder in terms of mango production, exports only 0.52% of its total production.

4. Based on the table, which three countries were at par with each other in terms of mango import from India in 2019-20?

5. The top mango importing country is the U.S.A., however, India exports only two percent of its total exports to the U.S.A. State any one inference that can be drawn from this.

6. In the given sentence taken from para-2, select the option that correctly replaces the underlined word, with its most likely antonym.

These countries are the bigger challenges for Indian mango exports.

- (a) enigmas (b) solutions
(c) provocations (d) disputes

7. Why is India described as the largest producer of mangoes in the world? (Answer in about 40 words.)

8. Which of the following is the main takeaway from the study mentioned in the passage?

- (a) India needs to produce more mangoes so that more can be exported.
(b) The UAE imported most mangoes from India in 2019-20.
(c) India is the largest producer of mangoes and by putting in more efforts, has the potential to be the largest exporter too.
(d) More study is needed to find ways to increase the export of mangoes from India.

Passage 3

Read the following text, an excerpt from a case study titled:

"Scouts and Guides Around the World."

- (1) Many young people aged between 6 and 25 belong to the Scout movement. It is a worldwide organization, which was set up to help young people achieve their full potential as they grow up.
- (2) The organization was established in 1907 by a British general called Robert Baden-Powell. While in the army, he wrote a publication about scouting (which means searching and keeping watch) and how to survive in the wild, called 'Aids to Scouting'. He realized how popular this was, and the result was another book, 'Scouting for Boys', which had less emphasis on the military. To test his ideas, he held a week-long camp for 21

boys from various schools in London, Poole and Bournemouth. This took place in August 1907, on Brownsea Island, in Southern England. These boys had the chance to enjoy outdoors, which became another of the movement's objectives.

- (3) The Scout Movement quickly got established in Europe. It then spread throughout the world, starting in Chile in 1909. To begin with, the focus was on boys aged 11 to 18. However, as the movement grew, it was clear that younger boys, older boys and girls all wanted to be involved too. Baden-Powell's sister set up the Girl Guides in 1910, and in 1914 she started Rosebuds, later renamed Brownies, for younger girls. The movement's intention to help young people play useful roles in society applies equally to girls and boys. By 2010, there were 32 million scouts, and by 2006, there were 10 million guides around the world, from a total of 216 different countries.
- (4) 2007 marked 100 years of the Scout Movement, and events took place around the world to celebrate this centenary. To mark the occasion, a colourful badge was produced for scouts to sew onto their uniforms or bags. The design included the official scout emblem, as well as the phrase, 'one world one promise', and images of doves and the globe.
- (5) 2007 was also the 150th anniversary of Baden-Powell's birth. To honour both occasions, a flame was lit at Baden-Powell's grave in Nyeri. This is the place in Kenya where he spent the last few years of his life. The flame was then carried through several countries until it reached the UK.

Country	Membership	Population participation	Scouting introduced	Guiding introduced
India	41500000	0.3%	1909	1911
Indonesia	17100000	7.2%	1912	1912
Philippines	21500000	2.2%	1910	1918
Thailand	1300000	1.9%	1911	1857
United States	7500000	2.4%	1910	1912

Answer the following questions based on your reading of the above passage:

1. Infer one reason for the following, based on the information given in paragraph 4:
'Colourful badge was sewn on to the uniform and bags of the Scouts'.

2. From paragraph 1, we can infer that Scout Movement was set up ____.
3. Complete the following analogy correctly with a word/phrase from paragraph 4.
10 years: decade : : 100 years: ____.
4. After reading the passage, bring a contrast between the books 'Aids to Scouting' and 'Scouting for Boys'.
5. What does the writer mean by the following phrase? 'One world one promise.'
6. According to the chart, which country took maximum time to introduce 'Guiding' after 'Scouting'? Choose your answer from the options given below:
(a) India (b) Indonesia
(c) Thailand (d) Philippines
7. List two reasons why a flame was lit at Baden-Powell's grave in 2007.
(a) _____
(b) _____
8. Fill in the blank by selecting the correct option:
The establishment of Scout movement from 1907 to 2006 showed _____ results.
(a) uniform (b) encouraging
(c) inconsistent (d) disappointing

Passage 4

Read the following passage carefully:

10

- (1) Rotation of crops is a universal phenomenon which is practised by most of the farmers of the tropical and temperate countries. The main objective of rotation of crops is to obtain higher agricultural returns on the one hand, and to maintain the soil fertility on the other.
- (2) In other words, the rotation of crops helps in making agriculture more sustainable. The importance of crop rotation is more in the areas where farmers grow two, or more than two crops in the same field in a year. Irrigation facilities have also been appreciably developed in the country during the last three decades. The availability of water to the arable land has helped in the intensification of agriculture.
- (3) In the areas such as Punjab and Haryana, where the Green Revolution is a big success, one soil exhaustive crop (rice) is followed by another soil exhaustive crop (wheat). Subsequently, the



field vacated by wheat is devoted to either rice or maize or cotton. Thus, in one year, the farmers are harvesting three soil exhaustive crops from the same field. Such a rotation of crops may fetch more income to the farmers, but depletes the soil fertility at a faster pace.

- (4) A number of field studies were conducted to assess the traditional crop rotation pattern. One such field study about the changes in the rotation of crops was conducted in the village Banhera (Tanda), Haridwar district. The main rotation of crops of the village is shown in the table below.

Traditional Rotation of Crops (1960-65) in Banhera (Tanda)				
Year	Kharif (mid-June to mid-October)	Rabi (mid-October to mid-April)	Zaid (April to June)	No. of days land left fallow
1960	Millet/fodder/rice	Gram	Fallow	90
1961	Fallow	Wheat	Fallow	210
1962	Millet/fodder/rice	Gram	Fallow	90
1963	Fallow	Wheat	Fallow	210
1964	Millet mixed with urad/fodder/rice	Gram	Fallow	90
1965	Fallow	Wheat	Fallow	210

Answer the following questions, based on the above passage:

1. Fill in the blanks with the appropriate option from those given in brackets, based on your understanding of para 2.

One of the reasons that there has been an intensification of agriculture in the country is the development of irrigation facilities is a/an_____.
(fact/opinion) because it is a/an_____.
(subjective judgement/objective detail).

2. Based on your understanding of paras 1 and 2, state whether the following statement is true or false.

If proper irrigation facility is provided, higher agricultural returns can be obtained by making crop rotation more sustainable.

3. Justify the following in about 40 words.

Crop rotation may fetch more income to the farmers, but depletes the soil fertility at a faster pace.

4. Based on the table, mention the years when the land was left fallow for maximum number of days.

5. The study conducted in village Banhera (Tanda)

reflects that during the years 1960 to 1965, from April to June, the land was left fallow or uncultivated throughout. State any one inference that can be drawn from this.

6. Select the option that correctly states the significance of crop rotation as given below:

- (1) Crop rotation is done to obtain higher agricultural returns.
- (2) Higher agricultural returns can be obtained by harvesting soil exhaustive crops.
- (3) Crop rotation demands that land should be left fallow for a few months to increase the fertility of soil.
- (4) Better irrigation facility to the arable land has helped in the intensification of agriculture.
- (5) If crops to be harvested are chosen wisely, crop rotation can help in maintaining fertility of soil.

Options:

- (a) (1), (2) and (4)
 - (b) (1) only
 - (c) (3) and (5)
 - (d) (1) and (5)
7. Crop rotation is helping in making agriculture more sustainable. Mention one benefit and one drawback of crop rotation. (Answer in about 40 words)
8. Which of the following is the main take away from the study mentioned in the passage?
- (a) The study needs to include more valid data to support the practice of crop rotation.
 - (b) Crop rotation is a sustainable practice that can transform the agricultural sector.
 - (c) The impact of crop rotation on farmer's upliftment has been thoroughly explained.
 - (d) Crop rotation is independent of the type of crops harvested and availability of water for irrigation.

Passage 5

Read the following passage carefully:

- (1) After more than two years of halted travel, India's tourism and hospitality industry is now cautiously hopeful. Tourism constituted almost 3% of India's GDP and generated around 100 million jobs in 2019. But the sector was severely hit in India — like in other countries in the past two years.
- (2) Indians are now travelling with a vengeance — 'revenge travel', as the phenomenon is called. And many, experts say, now prefer to travel

within the country instead of flying to more expensive destinations abroad. The industry is also benefitting from new trends borne of the pandemic such as micro-holidays and workcations.

- (3) According to a survey, 51 percent of Indian travellers believed that international travel remained an important means of expanding their horizons and connecting with other cultures. Over two years, the Survey said, Indian travellers are now dreaming about their next international trip and more than 70 percent of Indians are excited about being able to travel internationally.
- (4) There has also been an increase in the number of students going abroad to study. The increasing desire to study overseas is credited to the pent-up demand from the pandemic's two-year duration. This has got further pronounced because of growing aspirations and affordability among the middle-class students from Tier II and Tier III cities.

The table below shows foreign travel by Indians for different purposes from 2019 to 2022.

Purpose	2019	2020	2021	2022
Business	14.7 L	2.6 L	1.2 L	4.6 L
Job	25.2 L	7.1 L	8.3 L	21.4 L
Residency	89.5 L	28.9 L	34.9 L	72.5 L
Education	5.8 L	2.6 L	4.4 L	6.5 L
Tourists	63.8 L	13.1 L	12.8 L	30.8 L
Visit	42.1 L	10.1 L	15.1 L	40.9 L
Medical	1,448	390	545	1,253
Pilgrimage	8.8 L	1.1 L	4,139	4.6 L
Others	2.6 L	54,775	58,767	1.6 L
Total	2.5 Crore	66.2 L	77.2 L	1.8 Crore

Answer the following questions, based on the above passage:

1. Complete the following analogy appropriately, based on your understanding of paragraphs 1 and 2.
We can say that the situation when people were travelling with a vengeance is comparable to people going out to dine in hordes, because _____.
2. Fill in the blanks with the appropriate option from those given in brackets, based on your understanding of paragraph 1.
The statement that, "Tourism constituted almost 3% of India's GDP and generated around 100 million jobs in 2019, is a/an _____ (fact/opinion) because

it is a/an _____ (subjective judgement/objective detail).

3. Justify the following in about 40 words.

After being cooped up inside their houses for more than two years, Indians are now excited about being able to travel internationally.

4. Based on the given table, for which 'purpose' did Indian foreign travel increase in 2022 as compared to 2019?
5. "The industry is also benefitting from new trends borne of the pandemic such as micro-holidays and workcations." Which 'industry' is being talked about here?
6. As per the given table, for which purpose did maximum number of Indians undertake foreign travel in 2019 and in 2022?

State any one inference that can be drawn from this.

7. Why are students today choosing to go abroad to study? (Answer in about 40 words.)
8. Which of the following is the main takeaway from the study mentioned in the passage?
 - (a) International travel remains an important means of expanding the horizons and connecting with other cultures.
 - (b) Though travel, both domestic and international, has picked up, it has yet to reach its previous levels.
 - (c) Indians are excited about being able to travel internationally.
 - (d) The study needs to include experts from Tourism Department to offer any recommendations for further research.

CBSE 2023

Passage I

Read the passage given below:

- I. Increasing traffic congestion every year is causing increasing air pollution, wasting time and productivity and diverse respiratory diseases. Moreover, the cost of solving or reducing traffic congestion is enormous. However, neglecting the traffic jam problem would increase the social problems among citizens.
- II. The number of vehicles has increased considerably in the city in the past five years. Due to this increase, the city roads witness frequent traffic congestion,



but above all, the vehicles emitting pollutants are affecting the environment adversely.

III. The Capital's vehicular population saw an addition of more than five lakh vehicles last year, registering an increase of over 4%, according to the Delhi Economic Survey 2020-21.

IV. In spite of the largest road network, through metro and bus services in major cities the transport system is not being able to keep pace with the growing demand. Consequently, more and more people use their private vehicles, leading to increased congestion on the roads. In spite of these challenges people in India prefer road travel over air and other means of travel. Citizens of Delhi/NCR have, time and again, pondered over the possibilities of how to reduce the traffic congestion in the city, especially during the peak hours. People should use public transport, the government must increase the facilities of public transport, people should avoid the unnecessary collection of vehicles and should use carpooling and vehicle sharing.

V. What is required is proper implementation of corrective measures by citizens to get an organized traffic management system.

1. Infer one reason for the following, based on information in paragraph

(1) Reducing traffic congestion is not easy.

2. Select the appropriate option to complete the following sentence. The reasons for increased traffic congestion are _____.

- (1) use of private vehicles
- (2) increase in demand for cars
- (3) inability to keep pace with population control
- (4) travelling by public transport
- (5) emission of pollutants

- (a) 4, 5
- (b) 1, 5
- (c) 1, 2
- (d) 2, 3

3. Complete the following analogy correctly with a word/phrase from the paragraph.

organised: chaotic:: lowest: _____

Clue: Just as organized is an antonym of chaotic, lowest is an antonym of _____.

4. The vehicles emit pollutants which affect _____ badly.

5. Complete the following sentence.

Use of public transport will reduce _____.

6. Select the appropriate option which states the methods of reducing traffic congestions.

- (1) start carpooling
- (2) add electric buses
- (3) increase in public modes of transport
- (4) increase car collection points
- (5) increase taxation

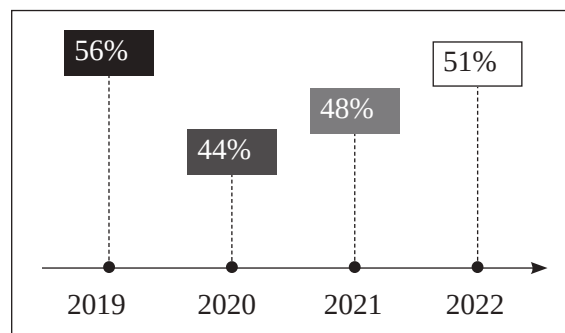
(a) 1, 4, 5

(b) 3, 5

(c) 2, 3, 4

(d) 1, 3

7. Analyse the status of traffic between the years 2019-2022.



8. What is required to get an organized traffic management system?

9. Give the reasons for the increase in vehicular congestion.

10. Fill in the blank by selecting the correct option.

There are _____ consequences of increasing vehicular congestion.

- (a) beneficial
- (b) adverse
- (c) implicit
- (d) explicit

11. Substitute the underlined word with ONE WORD similar in meaning in the following sentence.

Citizens of Delhi/NCR have time and time again pondered over the possibilities of how to reduce traffic congestion.

CBSE 2022

Passage I

Read the passage given below.

I. Playing videogames provides entertainment and many social and psychological rewards. However, videogame addiction also needs to be considered. Researchers have noted that the number of hours spent playing videogames is not necessarily a core indicator of addiction. Instead, several factors such as how fun or challenging a game is, or being able to play with friends are also important determinants

to understanding whether a game is addictive or just engaging.

- II. A study investigated the reasons for smartphone game addiction. This was done by analysing the reviews of games. Reviews were collected from games across different categories in an app store. A total of 25,200 reviews were collected containing references to the game being addictive. These reviews were analysed and the number of times different factors were mentioned for terming a game as addictive was recorded.

- III. **Table 1:** Frequency of factors associated with smartphone gaming addiction, as seen in the reviews of the games.

Types of Games	Factor 1	Factor 2	Factor 3
	'Challenging'	'Friends'	'Fun'
Action	456	256	110
Board	420	697	120
Card	417	512	190
Word	812	23	123

(NOTE: This table displays only a small portion of data from the original study which analysed 9 factors across 14 types of games.)

- IV. It was seen that 22.37% of the total reviews in the study that described a game as 'addictive', also described it as 'challenging'. This was the most common factor associated with addictive games, out of all the 9 factors. This was followed by 15.7% of the reviews mentioning the factor of 'friends'. Although it is a cliché, the ubiquity of the internet has made the world a global village. Friends can now play and interact as a group, build virtual relationships within the game, and attain social recognition from others, without even meeting in person. All of these factors can be highly engaging to players, and for some, these could become addictive.

(248 words) (Adapted)

On the basis of your understanding of the passage, answer the following questions:

- Based on the passage, state any two reasons why we need to study videogames.
 - _____
 - _____
- Layla spends two hours a day playing games on her phone. According to the passage, is this information sufficient to say she is addicted to videogames? Why/why not? Answer in one sentence.

- Complete the following analogy correctly with a word from paragraph I:

flourishes: grows: _____: factors

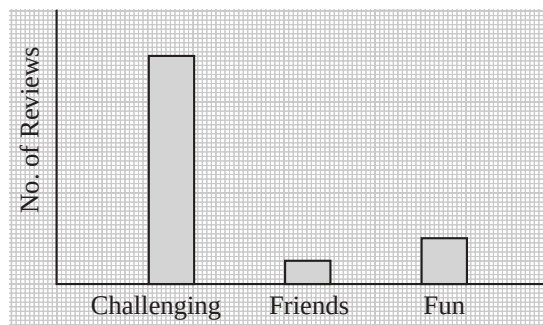
- Based on paragraph I, it can be said that the level of _____ and _____ in a videogame determine how addictive it can be.

Which of these can go in the blanks to complete the sentence correctly?

- variety
- violence
- difficulty
- popularity
- enjoyment

- 1 & 4
- 2 & 3
- 3 & 5
- 4 & 5

- The study mentioned in the passage used game reviews to understand what makes a game addictive. State one reason why game reviews were analysed for the purpose of the study.
- Based on the table in the passage, which type of game does the given graph represent?



- Action
- Board
- Card
- Word

For the Visually Impaired Candidates

Based on the table in the passage, in which category of games does the factor of 'Fun' play the LEAST role? Answer in ONE word.

- A developer of a crossword puzzle app is seeking advice to make improvements to the app. Based on the data provided, which of these ideas is BEST to recommend to the developer?
 - Make the puzzles tougher to solve.
 - Allow players to team up or compete with other players.
 - Create more levels in the game for players to win prizes.
 - Change the colour and design to make it look more appealing.

8. Write a word from paragraph IV that means the SAME as the underlined word in the sentence below.
It is the universal appeal of smartphones that made videogames very popular.
9. Read the sentence given below.
Why is everyone playing on their phones?
In which of these places in the passage can the sentence be used?
(a) at the beginning of paragraph I.
(b) at the end of paragraph I.
(c) at the beginning of paragraph II.
(d) at the end of paragraph IV.
10. Which of these is BEST suited as a title for the passage?
(a) Smartphones Boost Addiction.
(b) Challenge Your Mind with Games.
(c) A New Way to Game with Friends.
(d) Understanding Addiction to Games.

CBSE 2021

Passage I

Read the passage given below:

- I. Research from the Publishers Association has shown that films based on books take 44% more at the box office revenue in the UK and 53% more worldwide than original screenplays. The report explores what impact a book has when adapted for film and TV.
- II. The report reads: "Published material is the basis of 52% of top UK films in the last 10 years, and accounts for an even higher share of revenue from these leading performers, at 61% of UK box office gross and 65% of worldwide gross." The Hollywood adaptation of "My Cousin Rachel" was shown to have a significant impact on the sales of the Daphne Du Maurier thriller. The sales of the book in 2017 alone accounted for 23% of all sales since 1992.
- III. The research suggests that adapted films tend to perform better, because films can "leverage the popularity" of well-known books through an existing audience. Films adapted from books also tend to have a richer, more fully-developed story to draw on. In terms of TV adaptation, it was revealed that a quarter of dramas were based on literary sources and attracted a 56% larger share of the audience than those based on original scripts. Fourteen of the 35 high end series produced in the UK in the period between January and September 2017 were based on books, compared to seven based on true stories or historical events and five based on pre-existing films or TV stories.
- IV. In the case of the 2016 BBC broadcast of "The Night Manager", research revealed that while the novel was in circulation for over 25 years, 82% of the copies it sold were in 2016 and 2017. Sales of the paperback edition remained strong in 2017 even after the series went off the air.
- V. In conclusion, the report states that "there is a strong two-way relationship between publishing and the wider creative economy, wherein a successful adaptation often has spill-over effects and gives a substantial boost to the sales of the original book.

Based on your understanding of the passage, answer any six out of the eight questions by choosing the correct option.

1. The purpose of the research by Publishers Association was to study the _____. Choose the correct option.
(a) variety in films and TV shows.
(b) impact of films on books.
(c) choice of books for film-making.
(d) connect between books and films.
2. Select the option that is true for the two statements given below.
(1) The revenues generated at the box office have increased.
(2) Majority of the top films in the UK are based on published material.
(a) (1) is the result of (2)
(b) is the reason for (2)
(c) (1) is independent of (2)
(d) (1) contradicts (2).
3. Select the option that gives the correct meaning of the following statement. "The sales of the book in 2017 alone accounted for 23% of all sales since 1992."
(a) There were 23% higher sales in 2017 than previous years.
(b) A major chunk of sales happened in 2017.
(c) The sales were limited to 23% in 2017.
(d) There were very few books sold in the previous years.

4. According to the research, the films based on books have greater success because
 - (a) people like to see the characters from the books on screen.
 - (b) the films get the advantage of the fame of the books.
 - (c) it takes less effort for people to watch films than read books.
 - (d) the films get a ready-made script from the books.
5. Select the option listing what the given sentence refers to. 'Films adapted from books also tend to have a richer, more fully-developed story to draw on.'
 - (1) The plot and the storyline of such films are better.
 - (2) The characters are likely to be more vivid.
 - (3) The production of such films is meant for the rich and famous.
 - (4) The settings and costumes are adapted from the book.
 - (5) The making of such films require the author to write a sequel.
 - (a) (1), (3) and (4) (b) (2), (3) and (5)
 - (c) (1), (2) and (5) (d) (1), (2) and (4)
6. On what from the following were the maximum TV serials in UK in the year 2017 based?
 - (a) Books (b) Historical stories
 - (c) Original true stories (d) Previous films
7. This passage lists an example proving that TV dramas based on literary works have. _____
Select the correct option.
 - (a) increased the immediate sales of the book
 - (b) increased the sales of the book during the first screening
 - (c) had no immediate impact on the sales of the book
 - (d) had very little impact on the sales of the book
8. Choose the correct option to answer the following: According to paragraph (v), 'there is a two-way relationship between books and the screen'. This is so because both
 - (a) revolve around the same stories.
 - (b) cater to an audience with the same taste.
 - (c) gain from each other's popularity.
 - (d) belong to the creative field.

Passage I

Read the passage given below:

- I. Caged behind thick glass, the most famous dancer in the world can easily be missed in the National Museum, Delhi. The Dancing Girl of Mohenjo Daro is that rare artefact that even school children are familiar with. Our school textbooks also communicate the wealth of our 5000 year heritage of art. You have to be alert to her existence there, amid terracotta animals to rediscover this bronze image.
- II. Most of us have seen her only in photographs or sketches therefore the impact of actually holding her is magnified a million times over.. One discovers that the dancing girl has no feet. She is small, a little over 10 cm tall – the length of a human palm – but she surprises us with the power of great art – the ability to communicate across centuries.
- III. A series of bangles - of shell or ivory or thin metal - clothe her left upper arm all the way down to her fingers. A necklace with three pendants bunched together and a few bangles above the elbow and wrist on the right hand display an almost modern art.
- IV. She speaks of the undaunted ever hopeful human spirit. She reminds us that it is important to visit museums in our country to experience the impact that a work of art leaves on our senses, to find among all the riches, one particular vision of beauty that speaks to us alone.

On the basis of your reading of the above passage answer the following questions.

1. The dancing girl belongs to_____
 - (a) Mohenjo-Daro
 - (b) Greek culture
 - (c) Homosapiens
 - (d) Tibet
2. In the museum she's kept among
 - (a) dancing figures
 - (b) bronze statues
 - (c) terracotta animals
 - (d) books

3. Which information is not given in the passage?
 - (a) The girl is caged behind glass.
 - (b) She is a rare artefact.
 - (c) School books communicate the wealth of our heritage.
 - (d) She cannot be rediscovered as she's bronze.
4. 'Great Art' has power because :
 - (a) it appeals to us despite a passage of time.
 - (b) it is small and can be understood.
 - (c) it's seen in pictures and sketches.
 - (d) it's magnified a million times.
5. The jewellery she wears:
 - (a) consists of bangles of shell, ivory or thin metal.
 - (b) is a necklace with two pendants.
 - (c) both (i) and (ii) are correct.
 - (d) neither (i) nor (ii) is correct.
6. She reminds us
 - (a) of the never say, die attitude of humans.
 - (b) why museums in our country are exciting.
 - (c) why she will make us come into money.
 - (d) of dancing figures.
7. The synonym of the word "among" in para 1 is _____
8. The size of the dancing girl is equal to the length of human palm. (True/False)



Explanations

Discursive Passage (CBSE-2024)

Passage 1

- (i) Highlighting the richness of the world's cultures.
(ii) Emphasizing the essential role of intercultural dialogue in achieving peace and sustainable development.
- (d)
- By drawing upon the creative potential of diverse cultures and engaging in continuous dialogue to ensure all members of society benefit from sustainable development.
- Positive and affirmative
- (d) 6. (c)
- The resolution on Culture and Sustainable Development.
- Bridging the gap between cultures

Passage 2

- (b) Renewable energy sources are inexhaustible, whereas alternate energy sources could be exhaustible.
- The tone of the writer in the given lines from para (4) is positive and optimistic. The writer highlights various factors contributing to the increased adoption of renewable energy sources, suggesting progress and improvement in the industry.
- In the past, alternative energy sources were not used much by the consumers because they were considered expensive and less efficient compared to traditional energy sources like fossil fuels.
- (b) exhaustible and inexhaustible
(e) sustainable and exhaustible
- The leader of the renewable energy pack is wind energy. This is because wind energy is versatile, can be produced at various scales, from small residential windmills to large offshore wind farms, and it serves both individuals and entire communities. Additionally, wind energy is inexhaustible and renewable, making it a sustainable option for energy generation.
- Geothermal electricity is generated by tapping into underground reservoirs of hot water and steam, while hydroelectricity is produced by harnessing the

energy of moving water behind a dam. Geothermal energy utilizes heat from the Earth's interior, whereas hydroelectricity relies on the gravitational force of water flow.

- (c) There are plenty of renewable energy sources that can be used to replace traditional energy sources.
- True

Passage 3

- (b) Rapidly increasing production of disposable plastic products overwhelms the world's ability to deal with them.
- The tone of the writer is reflective and concerned. The writer highlights how deeply plastics have integrated into modern life, making it unimaginable to live without them, but at the same time, this deep integration poses environmental challenges.
- (a) garbage and trash
(e) transformed and revolutionized
- because ocean currents carry plastic waste from coastal areas across vast distances.
- While plastic offers convenience in daily life, it comes with a significant environmental cost. Its persistence in nature leads to pollution, affecting ecosystems and wildlife, and its excessive use strains waste management systems globally.
- ingestion of plastic and entanglement in plastic debris.
- (b) by minimizing the use of single-use plastics
- Developing Asian and African nations often lack efficient waste management systems, which leads to improper disposal and accumulation of plastic waste.

Passage 4

- All three biotics are equally important to support microscopic organisms that live in the gut microbiome.
- The writer emphasizes that prebiotics, probiotics, and postbiotics not only promote gut health but also have broader health benefits. Scientific evidence links them to improvements in metabolic diseases, depressive symptoms, sleep quality, and reduction in upper respiratory infections.
- To get the right probiotic and to match it with your body's requirement, it is important to see the label for "contains live and active cultures" and specific strains of bacteria.

4. (a) increase and decrease
(c) beneficial and harmful
5. The author wants to stress the fact that there is not just one type of beneficial bacteria considered as probiotic, in fact, some probiotics have dozens of strains.
6. Prebiotics are crucial for gut health as they serve as food for beneficial microbes (probiotics). These undigestible fibers ensure the growth and activity of probiotics, which in turn maintain a balanced gut microbiome and overall health.
7. (b) Checking the label for specific strains of bacteria.
8. (a) Their relevance has been proven by scientific evidence.

(CBSE-2023)

Passage 1

1. (a) new snow or rain.
2. When over a foot of fresh snow accumulates, experts monitor for potential avalanche risks. They may use explosives to intentionally trigger smaller, controlled avalanches to prevent larger, more hazardous ones.
3. Avalanches have destroyed forests and roads.
4. (a) tiny
5. (a) People caught in the avalanche can try to swim to the top.
6. (c) The guest felt uneasy and uncomfortable watching the child's performance.
7. (d) Plastic waste
8. Explosives can be used in places with massive snow build-ups to trigger smaller avalanches.
9. (a) likely to cause death
10. (a) Avalanches

(CBSE-2022)

Passage 1

- | | | | | |
|--------|--------|--------|--------|---------|
| 1. (d) | 2. (b) | 3. (d) | 4. (c) | 5. (c) |
| 6. (b) | 7. (d) | 8. (a) | 9. (c) | 10. (a) |

(CBSE-2021)

Passage 1

1. (c) 2. (d) 3. (a)
4. The authors of the cookbook may have been men as only they knew how to read and write in the earlier times.

5. The ingredients used in cookbooks reveal the availability of resources for the community through trade.
6. Step by step
7. (c)
8. (1) the rise in the number of shows and documentaries about food.
(2) following a video is easier than understanding-texts in a cookbook
9. (d)
10. Importance of Cookbooks

(CBSE-2020)

Passage 1

1. (b) The most popular beverage in the world is:
2. (c) Who introduced tea to Europe?
3. (d) Which kind of tea is not mentioned in the passage?
4. (c) The new and convenient way of making tea is:
5. (c) Why is 'a cup of tea a day' compared to 'an apple a day'?
6. (b) Where is the tea ceremony a traditional way of greeting guests?
7. Fluorides in tea are useful for preventing tooth decay.
8. Earl Grey is a green tea. False

Case-based/Factual Passage (CBSE, 2024)

Passage 1

1. (a) To revise and revamp the entire education system, aligning it with the aspirational goals of 21st-century students.
(b) To integrate skill education into mainstream education and overcome the social status hierarchy associated with it.
2. fact, objective detail
3. (c) Minimum 50% learners shall have exposure to skill education.
4. the sharing of skill labs and facilities among multiple schools, improving access to skill education for a larger number of students.
5. Skill education
6. South Korea has the maximum percentage of students (96%) in skill education.

Reason: The possible reason could be the country's emphasis on vocational training and aligning education with industry needs to develop a skilled workforce.

7. (a) middle and secondary school.
8. The NEP 2020 plans to expose every child to at least one skill, including traditional Indian arts and artisanship, promoting the dignity of labour and vocational skills. This exposure will instill an appreciation for various vocations and help preserve India's rich cultural heritage.

Passage 2

1. of its widespread popularity, cultural significance, and numerous beneficial qualities that make it highly valued across different cultures and regions.
2. fact, objective detail
3. India's low export percentage despite high production is due to challenges such as transportation costs, limited shelf life, and competition from other exporting countries, which hinder its ability to export a larger share of mangoes.
4. According to the table, Saudi Arabia, Qatar, and Bangladesh were at par with each other, each importing 6% of Indian mango exports in 2019-20.
5. One inference that can be drawn is that despite the U.S.A. being a major importer of mangoes, India faces significant challenges or constraints that limit its mango exports to the U.S.A., such as high transportation costs or strict quality standards.
6. (b) solutions
7. India is described as the largest producer of mangoes due to its vast geographical area suitable for mango cultivation, favorable climate conditions, and significant agricultural expertise, which collectively contribute to its high mango production output.
8. (c) India is the largest producer of mangoes and by putting in more efforts, has the potential to be the largest exporter too.

Passage 3

1. The colourful badge was sewn onto the uniforms and bags of the Scouts to celebrate the centenary of the Scout Movement in 2007, marking 100 years since its establishment.
2. From paragraph 1, we can infer that the Scout Movement was set up to help young people achieve their full potential as they grow up.
3. centenary

4. Aids to Scouting' had a military emphasis and focused on survival skills in the wild, while 'Scouting for Boys' had less emphasis on the military and was more focused on the objectives of the Scout Movement, such as enjoying the outdoors.
5. The phrase 'One world one promise' signifies the unity and shared commitment of Scouts worldwide to the principles and values of the Scout Movement, emphasizing global solidarity and a common goal.
6. (c) Thailand
7. (a) To honor the 100th anniversary of the Scout Movement.
(b) To commemorate the 150th anniversary of Baden-Powell's birth.
8. (b) encouraging

Passage 4

1. fact, objective detail
2. True
3. Crop rotation involving soil exhaustive crops, like rice and wheat, may increase farmers' income in the short term due to higher yields. However, this practice rapidly depletes soil nutrients, leading to a decline in soil fertility over time.
4. The years when the land was left fallow for the maximum number of days are 1961, 1963, and 1965, with 210 days each.
5. One inference that can be drawn is that the farmers allowed the land to rest and recover its nutrients during the Zaid season (April to June), which may have been a strategy to maintain soil fertility for the next planting season.
6. (d) (1) and (5)
7. **Benefit:** Crop rotation can maintain soil fertility and reduce the risk of pests and diseases by alternating crops with different nutrient needs and growth habits.
Drawback: Frequent planting of soil exhaustive crops in rotation can still lead to rapid depletion of soil nutrients, requiring careful management and supplementation.
8. (b) Crop rotation is a sustainable practice that can transform the agricultural sector.

Passage 5

1. both "revenge travel" and dining in hordes reflect a surge in consumer demand following periods of restriction. After lockdowns, people eagerly return



to travel and dining, driven by pent-up desire and the easing of regulations.

2. fact, objective detail
3. The pent-up desire to explore beyond local confines has surged among Indians post-pandemic, fueled by the longing for international experiences and cultural connections.
4. Indian foreign travel for the purpose of 'Job' increased in 2022 compared to 2019.
5. The tourism and hospitality industry.
6. In 2019, the maximum number of Indians undertook foreign travel for the purpose of 'Business'. In 2022, the maximum was for 'Visit'.

One inference that can be drawn from this trend is the shift in travel purposes from primarily business-related in 2019 to more visit-oriented in 2022, indicating a broadening of travel motivations possibly influenced by post-pandemic trends.

7. Students are increasingly opting to study abroad due to pent-up demand post-pandemic, enhanced affordability, and aspirations among middle-class students from Tier II and Tier III cities for better educational opportunities and global exposure.
8. (b) Though travel, both domestic and international, has picked up, it has yet to reach its previous levels.

(CBSE-2023)

Passage 1

1. Reducing traffic congestion is not easy due to the enormous cost involved in solving or reducing the problem.
2. (c) 1, 2
3. highest
4. the environment
5. Use of public transport will reduce traffic congestion.
6. (d) 1, 3
7. Decline in 2020: Traffic dropped by 12% due to the COVID-19 pandemic and resulting restrictions.

Gradual Recovery:

2021: Increased by 4% to 48%.

2022: Rose by 3% to 51%.

After a sharp decline in 2020, traffic has been steadily recovering, reflecting a return to normalcy as restrictions eased.

8. Proper implementation of corrective measures

by citizens is required to get an organized traffic management system.

9. The increase in vehicular congestion is due to the considerable rise in the number of vehicles and the inability of the transport system to keep pace with the growing demand.
10. (b) adverse
11. Citizens of Delhi/NCR have repeatedly contemplated over the possibilities of how to reduce traffic congestion.

(CBSE-2022)

Passage 1

1. (Any two)
 - ☐ Videogames need to be studied to better understand their positive effects on people.
 - ☐ The factors that could increase addiction to a game need to be understood better.
 - ☐ If videogames are understood better, steps can be taken to prevent addiction to them.
2. No, she is not addicted as there are other factors that need to be considered to determine addiction OR because the amount of time spent on a game is not the only factor to determine addiction. (Accept any other valid response.)
3. determinants
4. (c)
5. Game reviews would be easily accessible. / It is a way to get large amounts of data because interviewing several people would be time-consuming and difficult. (Accept any other valid response.)
6. (d) Word (For the Visually Impaired Candidates: Action)
7. (b) 8. ubiquity 9. (a) 10. (d)

(CBSE-2021)

Passage 1

1. (d) connect between books and films.
2. (a) (1) is the result of (2).
3. (b) A major chunk of sales happened in 2017.
4. (b) the films get the advantage of the fame of the books.
5. (d) (1), (2), and (4).
6. (a) Books

7. (a) increased the immediate sales of the book.
8. (c) gain from each other's popularity.

(CBSE-2020)

Passage 1

1. (a) Mohenjo-Daro
2. (c) terracotta animals

3. (d) She cannot be rediscovered as she's bronze.
4. (a) it appeals to us despite a passage of time.
- 5 (a) consists of bangles of shell, ivory or thin metal.
6. (b) why museums in our country are exciting.
7. Amid
8. True



Section-B

- **Grammar**
- **Writing Skills**

Grammar

1

CHAPTER

Tenses



Previous Year Questions

CBSE, 2024

- Fill in the blank by using the correct form of the word in the bracket, for the given portion of a letter.

Sir

This is in relation to the earlier discussion where it was decided that the school would _____ (organize) a summer camp for the students of grade 6 and 7.

- Read the given sentence from a recipe review article. Identify the error and supply the correction in the sentence.

The salad, prepare with fresh and crisp ingredients, is truly a summer delight.

Use the given format for your response.

Error	Correction

- Fill in the blank by choosing the correct option from the ones given below:

Great News!

Our school's basketball team _____ the district championship.

- (a) clinching (b) was clinched
(c) clinched (d) had clinched

- Fill in the blank by using the correct form of the word in the bracket:

Dear Sir,

It was agreed that the teacher would organise the science fair for the students of grade 8.

- Identify the error and supply the correction in the sentence:

The soup recipe didn't turned out as expected, it was lacking in flavour.

Error	Correction

- Choose the correct option to complete the sentence:

The residents _____ eagerly for the young ones to visit them every Sunday and bring cheer to their lonely lives.

- (a) has waited (b) has been waiting
(c) were waiting (d) waited

- Fill in the blank by using the correct form of the word in the bracket:

You will find in this email a brochure that _____ (present) the various tourist attractions in our city, aimed at boosting local tourism.

- Fill in the blank by choosing the correct option:

In a miraculous turn of events, the Sunview School hockey team _____ the championship trophy.

- (a) has been lifting (b) had lifted
(c) lifted (d) will lift

- Complete any ten of the following twelve tasks, as directed:

Fill in the blank by using the correct form of the word in the bracket, for the given portion of a letter:

Therefore, I request you to please consider this request of _____ (construct) a park in our society so that each and every person can benefit and we can enjoy a healthy environment amidst the concrete jungle.

- Read the given sentence from an article on Yoga. Identify the error and supply the correction in the sentence:

Yoga should help lower blood pressure, cholesterol, and blood sugar, all of which are not good for your heart and blood vessels.

Use the given format for your response.

Error	Correction

11. Select the option that identifies the error and supplies the correction for a line from a Research Report:

In many low and middle income countries, health coverage has improved dramatically in the last two decades, but health outcomes may not.

Option No.	Error	Correction
A	has	have
B	improved	improve
C	may	have
D	but	thus

12. Complete the given narrative by filling in the blank with the correct option:

Excited about his newly earned powers, Midas started touching all kinds of things, _____ each item into pure gold.

- (a) to turning (b) turning
(c) turned (d) turns

13. Fill in the blank by choosing the correct option to complete the part of the disclaimer given in a textbook:

The authors of the book _____ all reasonable care to ensure that the contents of the book do not violate any copyright or other intellectual property rights of any person in any manner.

- (a) has been taking (b) have taken
(c) has taken (d) have been took

14. Fill in the blank by using the correct form of the word in the bracket, for the given portion of a letter:

Since you have been found guilty of..... (deliver) poor results for six months at a stretch, we are issuing this warning letter to warn you.

15. Identify the error and supply correction for the given sentence from a speech by an employee

We live in an ever changed world and in order to keep up and become successful, continuous education is a must.

Use the given format for your response.

Error	Correction

16. Complete the given narrative by filling in the blank with the correct option:

One scorching summer, the desert became dry, and there was no water left for the plants. The rose quickly.....to wilt.

- (a) beginning (b) begin
(c) began (d) begins

17. Fill in the blank by using the correct form of the word in the bracket, for the given portion of a letter:

We hope that you continue to work with the same zeal and keep (surprise) us with such remarkable performances. We thank you and wish you good luck for your upcoming projects.

Regards.

18. Complete the given narrative by filling in the blank, with the correct option:

Finally, she went to the best doctor in town. The doctor spent months on..... her until she was finally cured.

- (a) treats (b) treated
(c) to treating (d) treating

19. Fill in the blank by using the correct form of the word in the brackets, for the given portion of a letter.

I am also enclosing documents _____ (mention) our terms and conditions with this letter. Please go through the same and if you have any doubts regarding that, please feel free to call or meet me personally.

20. Fill in the blank by using the correct form of the word in the brackets, for the given portion of a letter.

Please keep me..... (apprise) of your next step to address this matter. Thanks for your time.

21. Complete the given narrative by filling in the blank with the correct option.

I watching that programme every week since it started.

- (a) has been (b) had
(c) have been (d) was been

22. Fill in the blank by choosing the correct option to complete the weather warning given by the IMD.

IMD on Sunday.....a 'thunderstorm' alert for some districts in coastal Maharashtra in view of the extremely severe cyclonic storm Biparjoy gushing over the Arabian Sea.

- (a) will issue (b) will be issuing
(c) issued (d) is issuing

23. Fill in the blank by using the correct form of the word in the brackets, for the given portion of a letter.

Dear Sir,

I am an account holder in your branch at Jayanagar. My current ATM card is _____ (damage) and I am unable to use it for any POS transaction.

24. Complete the given narrative by filling in the blank with the correct option.

I _____ watching that programme every week since it started.

- (a) has been (b) have been
(c) were (d) was been

25. Fill in the blank by choosing the correct option to complete the Disclaimer given by a news channel.

Except for the headline, this story _____ edited by YTV staff and is published from a syndicated feed.

- (a) will be (b) has not been
(c) has not (d) have not been

26. Complete the given narrative by filling in the blank with the correct option.

My visit to the historical museum left me _____ deeply appreciative of our ancestors' struggles and achievements.

- (a) being (b) was
(c) been (d) to be

27. Fill in the blank by choosing the correct option to complete the sentence to share the latest update on the school art competition. Our talented young artists have done us proud once again as our school's art team _____ the top spot in the state-level competition.

- (a) won (b) win
(c) is winning (d) has win

28. Complete any ten of the following twelve tasks, as directed.

- (i) Fill in the blank by using the correct form of the word in the brackets, for the given portion of a letter.

Thank you for exceeding company expectations and _____

(inspire) your team with your spectacular work ethic.

29. Read the given sentence from a movie review article.

Identify the error and supply the correction in the sentence.

The movie doesn't let you rest and is packed with engaged action sequences.

Use the given format for your response.

Error	Correction

30. Identify the error and supply the correction for the given sentence from a comment posted by an admirer of a reporter.

The report was well document, so no one could claim that it was just one person's opinion.

Use the given format for your response.

Error	Correction

31. Complete the given narrative by filling in the blank with the correct option.

Now that many employees have shown high productivity working from home, will their bosses hereafter _____ them to take working vacations?

- (a) expecting (b) expected
(c) have expected (d) expect

32. Fill in the blank by choosing the correct option to complete the part of the grievance posted by a citizen on a social media platform.

Crossing this stretch at any time of the day is a challenge. Even during afternoons, there _____ ice cream vendors on the road with people crowding around their carts.

- (a) were
(b) are
(c) have been
(d) would be

33. Complete the line from a 'Save the Planet' song, by filling in the blank with the correct option.

Let's see what we can do

To save the planet for me and you

E is for environment, keep it clean

If we _____ together, we'll make the best team.

- (a) will be standing
(b) stand
(c) had stood
(d) are standing



CBSE, 2023

1. Select the option that identifies the error and supplies the correction for the following line. The sounds of laughter was echoing in the corridor.

Option No.	Error	Correction
(a)	sounds	sound
(b)	laughter	laughing
(c)	was	were
(d)	in	of

2. Identify the error in the given sentence and supply the correction.

The children were exciting when they saw the leopard.
Use the given format for your response.

Error	Correction

3. Identify the error in the statement given below and supply the correction. Use the given format for your response. (1 mark) (2023) Water was vital to human health and fitness.

Error	Correction

4. Fill in the blank by using the correct form of the word in the brackets: Last week it _____ (rain) heavily and my house was flooded with water.

5. Fill in the blank by using the correct form of the word in the bracket.

The students with the help of their teacher _____ (create) a beautiful poster.

CBSE, 2022

1. The domestic cat _____ related to the lion and the tiger.

(a) be (b) is
(c) has been (d) is being

2. Economics _____ difficult for the students of grade nine.

(a) is (b) are
(c) has (d) were

3. The doctor _____ examined the patient when the family arrived.

(a) was (b) had
(c) has (d) have

4. Sita is working hard these days. I think she _____ admission in a medical college.

(a) will get (b) might get
(c) would get (d) would be getting



Explanations

CBSE, 2024

1. organizing

2.

Error	Correction
Prepare	prepared

3. (d) had clinched

4. organise

5.

Error	Correction
turned	turn

6. (d) waited

7. presents

8. (c) lifted

9. constructing

10.

Error	Correction
are not good for	are beneficial for

11.

Option No.	Error	Correction
C	may	have

12. (b) turning

13. (b) have taken

14. delivering

15.

Error	Correction
Changed	changing

16. (c) began

17. surprising

18. (d) treating

19. mentioning

20. apprised

21. (c) have been

22. (c) issued

23. damaged

24. (b) have been

25. (b) has not been

26. (c) been

27. (a) won

28. inspiring

29.

Error	Correction
engaged	engaging

30.

Error	Correction
document	documented

31. (b) expected

32. (b) are

33. (b) stand

CBSE, 2023

1. (a) sounds sound

2. exciting excited

3. was is

4. rained

5. created

CBSE, 2022

1. (b) is

2. (a) is

3. (b) had

4. (b) might get



Previous Year Questions

CBSE, 2024

1. Read the given sentence from a research study. Identify the error and supply the correction in the sentence:

Today, researchers are trying to establish whether yoga must help relieve people from depression and arthritis.

Use the given format for your response.

Error	Correction

2. Read the given sentence from a medical journal. Identify the error and supply the correction in the sentence:

A flu vaccine's most common side effects are soreness, redness and swelling at the injection site. These ought begin six to twelve hours after vaccination and can last upto two days.

Use the given format for your response.

Error	Correction

3. Fill in the blank by choosing the correct option, to complete the part of a notice on the school notice board. Best online courses

Students who want to participate in the Annual Day _____ (could/may/should) report to the Auditorium Hall at 12.30 pm tomorrow.

4. Fill in the blank by choosing the correct option to complete the part of a notice, posted on a school notice board.

As per the given schedule, the Students Council election of the school for the current session _____ held on 23rd May at 2.30 pm.

- (a) may be (b) should be
(c) can be (d) will be

5. Read the given sentence from a science journal. Identify the error and supply the correction in the sentence.

'When nutrition therapy is provided by a qualified professional, people could learn how to make better food choices.'

Use the given format for your response.

Error	Correction

6. Complete the slogan, by filling in the blank with the correct option.

When it gets really hot, rain a blessing.

- (a) should be (b) will be
(c) must be (d) ought to be

7. Identify the error and supply the correction for the following advertisement of an antivirus software.

A properly installed and maintained antivirus program may wipe out any malware attack, be it a bot, a virus, a Trojan or even ransomware.

Use the given format for your response.

Error	Correction

8. Read the given sentence from a sports journal. Identify the error and supply the correction in the sentence.

In present times, physiologists would travel the world to conferences and meetings to present their findings to other scientists.

Use the given format for your response.

Error	Correction

9. Complete the slogan, by filling in the blank with the correct option.

Your plastic contribution _____ causing ocean pollution.

- (a) should be (b) won't be
(c) is (d) ought to be

10. Identify the error and supply the correction for the following advertisement of a software.

This product handles the basics and then goes beyond that with a collection of additional security features that must take on many security breaches and win.

Use the given format for your response.

Error	Correction

11. Read the given sentence from a recipe review article. Identify the error and supply the correction in the sentence.

The upma recipe was so delicious that I couldn't barely stop myself from having a second helping.

Use the given format for your response.

Error	Correction

12. Select the option that identifies the error and supplies the correction for a line from a Research Report:

In many low and middle income countries, health coverage has improved dramatically in the last two decades, but health outcomes may not.

Option No.	Error	Correction
A	has	have
B	improved	improve
C	may	have
D	but	thus

13. Choose the correct option to complete the sentence:
The management felt that the company_____ include corporate social responsibility as part of its mission statement and work for the betterment of society.

- (a) must (b) ought
(c) need (d) might

14. Identify the error and supply the correction for the following note in a smart watch's instruction manual.

When the watch is connected to the mobile phone, the watch may automatically calibrate and synchronize with the time of the mobile phone.

Use the given format for your response.

Error	Correction

CBSE, 2023

1. Select the option that identifies the error and supplies the correction for the following line: I can't never forget my childhood friend Bella.

Option No.	Error	Correction
(a)	can't	can
(b)	forget	forgotten
(c)	my	mine
(d)	friend	friends

CBSE, 2022

1. The train is running late we _____ for one hour.

- (a) would wait (b) should have to wait
(c) shall have to wait (d) may be waiting

2. The public _____ feed the animals in a zoo.

- (a) should not (b) ought not to
(c) must not (d) need not

3. Select the correct option to fill in the blank for the given line on 'save the environment poster' Keep the environment clean. Do not litter. You _____ follow rules.

- (a) should (b) may
(c) must (d) will

CBSE, 2021

1. The Komodo dragon _____ follow its prey till it eventually dies due to its venomous bite.

- (a) must (b) will
(c) could (d) may



Explanations

CBSE, 2024

1.

Error	Correction
must	can

2.

Error	Correction
Ought begin	Ought to begin

3. should

4. (d) will be

5.

Error	Correction
could	can

6. (b) will be

7.

Error	Correction
may	can

8.

Error	Correction
would travel	travel

9. (c) is

10.

Error	Correction
must	can

11.

Error	Correction
couldn't barely stop	could barely stop

12.

Option No.	Error	Correction
C	may	have

13. (a) must

14.

Error	Correction
may	will

CBSE, 2023

1. (a) can't can

CBSE, 2022

1. (c) shall have to wait

2. (c) must not

3. (c) must

CBSE, 2021

1. (b) will

3

CHAPTER

Subject-verb Agreement



Previous Year Questions

CBSE, 2024

- Complete the slogan, by filling in the blank with the correct option:

Planting a tree is a very noble deed and _____ the earth from global warming!

- (a) saves (b) saving
(c) had saved (d) should save

- Fill in the blank by using the correct form of the word in the bracket, for the given portion of a letter.

Sir

Attached is the invoice that _____ (detail) the expenses incurred during the team's business trip to Tribogh.

- Complete the sentence from the song, by filling in the blank with the correct option

The frosty winter mourns your absence,
The snow flakes and ice _____ your warmth.
The fireplace flickers in longing,
As the cold night awaits your returns.

- (a) crave (b) craves
(c) craved (d) shall crave

- Identify the error and supply the correction for the given sentence from an Art Exhibition invitation.

Artisan Club invite you to 'Art and Soul' an art exhibition featuring art work created by our budding artists.

Use the given format for your response.

Error	Correction

- Select the option that identifies the error and supplies

the correction for a pop-up that appeared on a webpage. These cookies are used to collect information about how you interact with our website and allows us to remember you.

Option No.	Error	Correction
(a)	interact	interacted
(b)	with	to
(c)	about	for
(d)	allows	allow

- Identify the error and supply the correction for the given pop-up appearing on a website's home page.

This site use cookies. By continuing to use our website, you are agreeing to our privacy policy.

Use the given format for your response.

Error	Correction

- Identify the error and supply correction for the following sentence taken from a course's flyer:

Our courses offer you concise training on individual growth and personal developments.

Use the given format for your response.

Error	Correction

- Fill in the blank by choosing the correct option to complete the sentence.

Enclosed are the updated project guidelines and _____ (this / these / they) need to be shared with the entire project team to ensure compliance.

- Identify the error and supply correction for the given sentence from a restaurant's promotional material.

Our restaurant serves authentic Indian foods celebrating the diversity of Indian Cuisine.

Use the given format for your response.

Error	Correction

10. Select the option that identifies the error and supplies the correction.

My pet dog are very playful.

Option No.	Error	Correction
(a)	My	Our
(b)	pet	pets
(c)	are	is
(d)	playful	playing

11. Identify the error and supply correction for the following note from a marketing report.

The current marketing goal is focused on website traffics and conversions.

Error	Correction

12. Identify the error in the given sentence and supply the correction:

The stage performance put up by the students were spectacular.

Use the given format for your response:

Error	Correction

13. Fill in the blank by choosing the correct option.

His brother along with his friends _____ leaving for the stadium.

- (a) are (b) has
(c) is (d) were

14. Identify the error in the newspaper headline.

Attractive packages for different Tourist destination - Mizoram, Kashmir, Kerala, Goa.

Use the given format for your response:

Error	Correction

15. Identify the error and supply the correction for the sentence:

The 2020 research study pay attention to the relationship between high levels of stress and employee productivity.

Error	Correction

16. Select the option that identifies the error and supplies the correction:

She wants to learns how to play the piano.

Error	Correction

17. Identify the error and supply the correction for the sentence:

"We specializes in arranging bespoke tours to exotic locations around the world."

Error	Correction

18. Complete the line from the song:

In the night, the stars _____, your dreams,
The moonlight guides your course,
The cool breeze whispers your name,
Leading you towards a new dawn.

- (a) shines (b) shine
(c) shone (d) shining

CBSE, 2023

1. Identify the error in the given sentence and supply the correction:

Playing outdoor games have benefits over being indoors. Use the given format for your response.

Error	Correction



Explanations

CBSE, 2024

1. (a) saves 2. details
3. (a) crave
- 4.

Error	Correction
invite	invites

5.

Option No.	Error	Correction
(d)	allows	allow

6.

Error	Correction
This site use cookies	This site uses cookies

7.

Error	Correction
developments	development

8. these

9.

Error	Correction
foods	food

10.

Option No.	Error	Correction
(c)	are	is

11.

Error	Correction
traffics	traffic

12.

Error	Correction
were	was

13. (c) is

14.

Error	Correction
destination	destinations

15.

Error	Correction
-------	------------

pay	pays
-----	------

16.

Error	Correction
learns	learn

17.

Error	Correction
specializes	specialize

18. (b) shine

CBSE, 2023

1. have has

4

CHAPTER

Reported Speech



Previous Year Questions

CBSE, 2024

1. Complete the sentence by filling in the blank:

Receptionist: Good to see you again, sir!

Guest: Indeed, it's always nice to be back.

The guest replied that _____

2. Select the correct option to complete the reporting of the dialogue:

Raashi asked Ratul about the most rewarding part of volunteering.

Ratul expressed that seeing the _____ is the most rewarding part.

- (a) positive impact we can make in people's lives
- (b) positive impact they can make in people's lives
- (c) positive impact they could make in people's lives
- (d) positive impact they we could make in people's lives

3. Report the dialogue between a vendor and his customer, by completing the sentence.

Vendor: Have you been busy lately?

Customer: Yes, I have been very occupied with work this week.

The vendor asked his customer if he had been busy of late. The customer confirmed this, stating that _____.

4. Complete the sentence by filling in the blank based on the conversation:

Hostess: Wonderful to see you again, sir!

Customer: Thanks, I couldn't resist your delicious food.

The customer responded that _____.

5. Select the correct option to complete the reporting of the dialogue:

Raashi asked Ratul whether he had encouraged others to volunteer. Ratul affirmed that he always encourages his friends and family to consider volunteering.

- (a) whether he is encouraging others to volunteer
- (b) whether he encouraged others to volunteer
- (c) whether he encourages others to volunteer
- (d) whether he had encouraged others to volunteer

6. Report the dialogue between the vendor and his customer:

Vendor: Are you feeling alright today?

Customer: Yes, I am doing much better than before.

The vendor asked his customer if he was feeling okay. The customer responded positively, saying that _____.

7. Read the conversation between the coach and the student.

Complete the sentence by reporting the reply correctly:

Coach: You must attend morning practice regularly.

Student: Yes, I will as I am feeling stronger now.

The coach reminded the student that he must attend morning practice regularly, to which the student replied _____.

8. Report the dialogue between two friends by completing the sentence.

Rahul: Saheb, what did you like most about your visit to the village?

Saheb: The sense of joy in the simple things of life.

In response to the question about what he liked about his visit to the village, Saheb says

9. Select the correct option to complete the narration of the dialogue between Anil and Sanjeev:

Anil: Where are you going?

Sanjeev: To the airport.

Anil: May I drop you there as I'm going in that direction?

Anil asked Sanjeev where he was going and offered to drop him as _____.

- (a) he could be going in that direction
- (b) he would be going in the direction
- (c) he is going in the direction
- (d) he was going in that direction

10. Read the conversation between a coach and his player.

Complete the sentence by reporting the player's reply correctly.

Coach: Will you be able to report for morning practice during the summer break?

Player: Sir, I will report every morning at 7 a.m. sharp.

The coach while talking to the player asked him whether he would be able to report for morning practice. The player affirmed _____.

11. Select the correct option to complete the narration of the dialogue between Ajay and his friend.

Friend: Ajay, did you buy a zoom lens with your camera?

Ajay: No, I did not. I ran out of money.

Ajay's friend asked Ajay whether he had bought a zoom lens with his camera. Ajay replied that he had not because _____.

- (a) he was running out of money
- (b) he has ran out of money
- (c) he have run out of money
- (d) he had run out of money

12. Read the conversation between Meera and her father.

Complete the sentence by reporting the reply correctly.

Meera: What did you buy?

Father: I bought a heater.

Meera asked her father what he had bought. The father replied that he _____.

13. Report the dialogue between Rashid and his father, by completing the sentence.

Father: How are you getting on with your studies?

Rashid: Fine. I have got a certificate of improvement from the school.

Father asked Rashid how he was getting on with his studies. Rashid replied that _____.

14. Raman shared some information with Seema. Report Seema's question.

Can you solve the sum?

15. Read the conversation between the Chief Guest and the student. Complete the sentence by reporting the reply correctly.

Chief guest: Who inspired you to learn classical dance.

Student: I was inspired by my grandfather who was a renowned dancer.

The Chief Guest asked the student who had inspired the student to learn classical dance. The student replied _____.

16. Report the dialogue between the receptionist and the customer by completing the sentence:

Receptionist: When would you like to check into the hotel.

Customer: I will send you an email and give the details.

In response to the question regarding when he would like to move in, the customer replied _____.

17. Samiksha shared some information with Sameer regarding the annual blood donation camp. Report Sameer's question:

How did you feel when you were donating blood?

18. Select the correct option to complete the narration of a dialogue between a passerby and a farmer.

Passerby: Can you tell me the way to Rampur.

Farmer: Drive for four kms and then turn right.

The passerby asked the farmer if he could tell him the way to Rampur. The farmer replied that _____.

- (a) he may drive for four kms and then turn right.
- (b) he should drive for four kms and then turn right.
- (c) he might drive for four kms and then turn right.
- (d) he had to drive for four kms and then turn right.

19. Read the conversation between a teacher and a student.

Complete the sentence by reporting the reply correctly:

Teacher: Would you like to take part in a debate competition?

Student: Yes, When is the competition?

The teacher asked whether the student would like

to participate in a debate competition to which the student affirmed _____.

20. Report the dialogue between the shopkeeper and customer, by completing the sentence:

Customer: Do you sell battery operated toys for children?

Shop keeper: Yes, we have a wide range of toys.

The customer asked the shopkeeper if he sold battery operated toys for children. In response, the shopkeeper replied _____.

21. Rohina shared some information with Ruchi regarding her summer internship at the bank. Report Ruchi's question.

What was the duration of your internship?

22. Select the correct option to complete the narration of a dialogue between Raj and his wife:

Raj I have invited my friends for dinner.

Wife: I'll invite my friends too.

Raj told his wife that he had invited his friends for dinner. The wife added that _____.

- (a) she will invite her friends too
- (b) she would invite her friends too
- (c) she can invite her friends too
- (d) she could invite her friends too

23. Marie and Peter had a conversation about volunteer work. Report Marie's question.

How has this volunteer work impacted your life?

24. Read the dialogue between Karen and Matt, regarding his chess club.

Karen: What led you to join the chess club?

Matt: Chess is not just a game, it's a mental battle which I enjoy.

Select the correct option to complete the reporting of the above dialogue.

Karen questioned Matt about _____ the chess club. Matt reflected and commented that chess was more than just a game to him, it was a mental battle which he enjoyed.

- (a) what led to join him.
- (b) what led him to join
- (c) what is leading him to join
- (d) what led him joining

25. Report the dialogue between a vendor and his customer, by completing the sentence:

Vendor: You seem quite refreshed today, sir?

Customer: Yes, I just returned from a vacation.

The vendor, noticing a change in his customer's demeanor, pointed out that he appeared refreshed. The customer confirmed this observation, mentioning that he _____.

26. Swati and Akshat had a conversation about the opening of Swati's Art Exhibition.

Report Akshat's question.

Did the organizers offer you any discount?

27. Read the dialogue between Manish and his father, regarding Manish's cricket coaching.

Father: Did you get a new coach in the academy to train you?

Manish: Yes, the new coach is very motivating and pushes us to perform better.

Select the correct option to complete the reporting of the above dialogue.

Manish's father asked him _____.

Manish answered in the affirmative and added that the new coach was very motivating and pushed them to perform better.

- (a) if he got a new coach in the academy to train him.
- (b) if he is getting a new coach in the academy to train him.
- (c) whether he got a new coach to train him.
- (d) whether he gets a new coach in the academy to train him.

28. Report the dialogue between two friends, Deepika and Nida, by completing the sentence:

Deepika: Are you excited about your sister's marriage?

Nida: Yes, indeed! My family has been busy with preparations for the past two months.

Deepika asked Nida if she was excited about her sister's marriage. Nida answered in the affirmative and explained that _____.

29. Tanu and Amit had a conversation about the execution of Tanu's travel plan.

Report Amit's question.

Will you be going with your family?

30. Read the dialogue between Karan and his friend, Parvaiz regarding Karan's winter vacation plans:

Karan: How is your winter vacation plan shaping up?

Parvaiz: Alas! There are no plans. We have extra classes during our winter vacation.

Select the correct option to complete the reporting of the above dialogue.



Karan asked Parvaiz how his winter vacation plan was shaping up. Parvaiz sighed and said there were no plans. He further added that _____.

- (a) they had extra classes during our winter vacation
- (b) he has extra classes during their winter vacations
- (c) they had extra classes during their winter vacation
- (d) they have extra classes during their winter vacation

31. Report the dialogue between two friends, Madhur and Priyanka, by completing the sentence:

Madhur: Do you know the importance of water for our body?

Priyanka: Yes, indeed! Water is essential for digestion and regulates body temperature.

Madhur asked Priyanka if she knew about the importance of water for their body. Priyanka answered in the affirmative and explained that _____.

32. Fill in the blank by choosing the correct option to complete the part of the "All Rights Reserved" note given in a textbook.

No part of this publication may be reproduced, transcribed, transmitted, stored or translated into any language. Any person _____ in relation to this publication may be liable to criminal prosecution and civil claims for damages.

- (a) who will be doing any unauthorized act
- (b) who is doing any unauthorized act
- (c) who does any unauthorized act
- (d) who may do any unauthorized act

33. Mihika and Nitesh had a conversation about a shopping mall they recently visited.

Report Mihika's question.

Do you remember that cafe where we had a croissant?

34. Read the dialogue between Sameer, a passenger and the flight attendant regarding delay in flight landing.

Sameer: At what time are we landing in Mumbai?

Flight Attendant: Sorry for the inconvenience, sir. The flight will be delayed by a few hours due to heavy rain.

Select the correct option to complete the reporting of the above dialogue.

Sameer asked the flight attendant about the time they would be landing in Mumbai. The flight attendant apologized for the inconvenience and replied that _____ due to heavy rains.

- (a) the flight would be delayed by a few hours
- (b) there would be a delay in flight landing
- (c) there will be a delay by a few hours
- (d) the flight could be delayed by a few hours

35. Report the following dialogue between a teacher and her student, by completing the sentence.

Teacher: Why have you not completed your homework?

Student: There was a long power cut in my locality and our inverter battery also ran out.

The teacher asked the student why he had not completed his homework. The student answered that _____.

36. Read the dialogue between Vilakshna and her physician, Dr. Sharnani, regarding the effectiveness of her medication.

Dr. Sharnani: How is your acid reflux problem now?

Vilakshna: I'd tried everything without success, but this new medicine is great.

Select the correct option to complete the reporting of the above dialogue.

Dr. Sharnani asked Vilakshna about her acid reflux problem to which Vilakshna replied that she'd tried everything without success, _____.

- (a) but she found the new medicine to be great
- (b) but she thought that this new medicine was great
- (c) but the new medicine was great
- (d) but that new medicine was great

37. Report the following dialogue between two friends who are visiting a museum, by completing the sentence.

Auronima: What are you staring at?

Soumitra: I am in awe of this beautiful painting! I have not seen anything like this before.

Auronima asked Soumitra what he was staring at. Soumitra exclaimed that he was in awe of the beautiful painting and that _____.

38. Kevin and Rohan had a conversation about their college admissions. Report Rohan's question.

Would you be interested in studying arts or medicine?

39. Read the dialogue between Yogita and Nandini, regarding the progress of a task.

Yogita: How long have you been working on this task?

Nandini: I've been working for two hours.

Select the correct option to complete the reporting of the above dialogue.

Yogita asked Nandini _____ .

Nandini replied that she had been working for two hours.

- (a) for how long was she working on the task
- (b) how long she had been working on that task
- (c) for how long had she been working on this task
- (d) how long had she been working on this task

40. Report the following dialogue between a food delivery executive and a customer, by completing the sentence.

Food delivery executive: Could you give me a 5 star rating? Customer: I can only tell after I finish eating the food.

The food delivery executive asked the customer if he/she could give him a 5 star rating. The customer replied by saying that _____ .

41. Mahi and Pankaj had a conversation about volunteer work. Report

Mahi's question.

Mahi: How do you balance your volunteer work with your personal life?

Pankaj: I set a particular time for volunteering and ensure I have enough time for my personal activities.

42. Read the dialogue between Rita and Jeetu about a hobby course.

Rita: Why did you decide to take up painting?

Jeetu: I view painting as a form of self-expression and relaxation. Select the option to complete the reporting of the above dialogue. Rita asked Jeetu why he had decided to take-up painting. Jeetu calmly explained that _____ self-expression and relaxation.

- (a) he views painting as a form of
- (b) he has viewed painting as a form of
- (c) he viewed painting as a form of
- (d) he is viewing painting as a form of

43. Report the dialogue between a vendor and his customer, by completing the sentence:

Vendor: It seems like you're in a hurry today!

Customer: Yes, I have to pick up my daughter at school soon.

The vendor noticed his customer's sense of urgency and asked about it. The customer confirmed this and

explained that _____.

44. Manthan and Sonalika had a conversation about Sonalika's job interview.

Report Manthan's question.

How are you preparing for the interview?

45. Read the dialogue between Meher and her mother, regarding

Meher's dance classes.

Mother: Are you enjoying your dance classes?

Meher: Oh Yes! I am loving it. It is so refreshing to attend them after a long day.

Select the correct option to complete the reporting of the above dialogue.

Meher's mother asked her _____. In response, Meher exclaimed and said that she was loving it. She added that it was very refreshing to attend them after a long day.

- (a) whether the dance classes were being enjoyed by her
- (b) whether she is enjoying her dance classes
- (c) whether she was enjoying her dance classes
- (d) whether the dance classes are being enjoyed by her

46. Report the dialogue between two friends, Nidhi and Neha, by completing the sentence:

Nidhi - Have you mastered the art of cooking Chinese food?

Neha - Yes, indeed! I have been cooking Chinese food for a month.

Nidhi asked Neha if she had mastered the art of cooking Chinese food.

Neha answered in the affirmative and explained that _____.

47. Akshat and Niharika had a conversation about the felicitation of Akshat's achievements.

Report Niharika's question.

What will you be wearing for tomorrow's function?

48. Read the dialogue between Karan and his teacher regarding his absence from school.

Teacher: Karan, why were you absent yesterday?

Karan: Yesterday I had cold and fever, sir. I couldn't inform you beforehand.

Teacher: That's okay. Take care of your health.

Select the correct option to complete the reporting of the above dialogue.

The teacher asked Karan _____.



Karan replied that he had cold and fever the previous day and added that he couldn't inform the teacher beforehand. The teacher advised him to take care of his health.

- (a) why did he remain absent the previous day
- (b) why he had been absent the previous day
- (c) the reason he was absent
- (d) why was he absent yesterday

49. Report the following dialogue between a hawker and his customer, by completing the sentence.

Hawker: Do you want any tomatoes?

Customer: Yes, indeed! Although they are a bit expensive, I like to add tomatoes to my diet.

The hawker asked the customer whether she wanted any tomatoes. The customer answered in the affirmative and explained that _____.

CBSE, 2023

1. Read the conversation between Meera and her father. Complete the sentence by reporting the reply correctly.
Meera: What did you buy?
Father: I bought a heater. Meera asked her father what he had bought. The father replied that he _____
2. Report the dialogue between Rashid and his father, by completing the sentence.
Father: How are you getting on with your studies?
Rashid: Fine. I have got a certificate of improvement from the school. Father asked Rashid how he was getting on with his studies. Rashid replied that, _____
3. Raman shared some information with Seema. Seema's question. Can you solve the sum?
4. Read the conversation between the Chief Guest and the student.
Complete the sentence by reporting the reply correctly.
Chief Guest: Who inspired you to learn classical dance?
Student: I was inspired by my Grandfather who was a renowned dancer. The Chief Guest asked the student who had inspired the student to learn classical dance. The student replied _____
5. Report the dialogue between the receptionist and the customer by completing the sentence.

Receptionist: When would you like to check out into the hotel. Customer: I will send you an email and give the details. In response to the question regarding when he would like to move in, the customer replied _____

6. Select the correct option to complete the narration of the dialogue between a passerby and a farmer.

Passerby: Can you tell me the way to Rampur?

Farmer: Drive for four kms and then turn right. The passerby asked the farmer if he could tell him the way to Rampur. The farmer replied that _____

- (a) he may drive for four kms and then turn right
- (b) he should drive for four kms and then turn right
- (c) he might drive for four kms and then turn right
- (d) he had to drive for four kms and then turn right

7. Samiksha shared some information with Sameer regarding the annual blood donation camp. Report Sameer's question:

How did you feel when you were donating blood?

CBSE, 2022

1. Read the conversation below and complete the passage that follows:
Sanjay told Vijay that (a). _____ and asked when he had come. Vijay replied that he had come the previous day and added that (b) _____
2. Read the conversation below and complete the passage that follows
Rahul : It is difficult to fight against peer pressure. Youth easily gets influenced by the lifestyle of its peers.
Radhika : Peer pressure has its benefits as well. Our peers also motivate and inspire us to do better and work hard. Rahul said that it was difficult to fight against peer pressure as (a) _____ Radhika replied that peer pressure had its benefits as well it (b), _____
3. Read the conversation and complete the passage that follows:
Ritika : Can I borrow your Math book for a couple of days? Mohit : Yes certainly, I have already studied for the test tomorrow. Ritika asked Mohit (a) _____ for a couple of days. Mohit agreed and said that (b) _____



Explanations

CBSE, 2024

1. The guest replied that it was always nice to be back.
2. (a) positive impact we can make in people's lives
3. he had been very occupied with work that week
4. he couldn't resist the delicious food
5. (b) whether he had encouraged others to volunteer
6. he was doing much better than before.
7. that he would as he was feeling stronger now
8. Saheb says he liked the sense of joy in the simple things of life.
9. (d) he was going in that direction
10. (b) he will report every morning at 7 a.m. sharp
11. (d) he had run out of money
12. had bought a heater
13. he was fine and that he had got a certificate of improvement from the school.
14. Seema asked Raman if he could solve the sum.
15. he was inspired by his grandfather who was a renowned dancer.
16. he would send an email and give the details.
17. Sameer asked Samiksha how she felt when she was donating blood.
18. (b) he should drive for four kms and then turn right.
19. and inquired about the date of the competition.
20. replied that they had a wide range of toys.
21. Ruchi asked Rohina what the duration of her internship was.
22. (b) she would invite her friends too
23. Marie asked Peter how that volunteer work had impacted his life.
24. (b) what led him to join
25. had just returned from a vacation.
26. Akshat asked Swati if the organizers had offered her any discount for the Art Exhibition opening.
27. (c) whether he got a new coach to train him.
28. Deepika asked Nida if she was excited about her sister's marriage. Nida answered in the affirmative

and explained that her family had been busy with preparations for the past two months.

29. Amit asked Tanu if she would be going with her family.
30. (c) they had extra classes during their winter vacation
31. Madhur asked Priyanka if she knew about the importance of water for their body. Priyanka answered in the affirmative and explained that water is essential for digestion and regulates body temperature.
32. (c) who does any unauthorized act
33. Mihika asked Nitesh if he remembered the cafe where they had a croissant.
34. (a) the flight would be delayed by a few hours
35. The teacher asked the student why he had not completed his homework. The student answered that there was a long power cut in his locality and their inverter battery also ran out.
36. (a) but she found the new medicine to be great
37. he had not seen anything like that before.
38. Rohan asked Kevin if he would be interested in studying arts or medicine.
39. (d) how long had she been working on this task
40. he/she can only tell after finishing eating the food.
41. Mahi asked Pankaj how he balances his volunteer work with his personal life.
42. (c) he viewed painting as a form of
43. he had to pick up his daughter at school soon
44. Manthan asked Sonalika how she was preparing for the interview.
45. (c) whether she was enjoying her dance classes
46. Neha answered in the affirmative and explained that she had been cooking Chinese food for a month.
47. Niharika asked Akshat what he would be wearing for the function the next day.
48. (d) why was he absent yesterday
49. although they were a bit expensive, she liked to add tomatoes to her diet.

CBSE, 2023

1. had bought a heater
2. he had got a certificate of improvement from the school
3. if he could solve the sum
4. that he was inspired by his grandfather, who was a renowned dancer
5. that he would send an email and give the details
6. (b) he should drive for four kms and then turn right

7. how she had felt when she was donating blood

CBSE, 2022

1. (a) he was happy to see him (b) he had come to meet him.
2. (a) you easily got influenced by the lifestyle of its peers.
(b) motivated and inspired them to do better and work hard.
3. (a) if she could borrow his Math book
(b) he had already studied for the test the next day.

5

CHAPTER

Determiners



Previous Year Questions

CBSE, 2024

1. Identify the error and supply the correction:

The research explores the correlation of physical activity and mental health.

Error	Correction

2. Fill in the blank by choosing the correct option:

The quarterly performance report is attached and _____ (these/that/it) requires immediate attention from the management team.

3. Fill in the blank by choosing the correct option:

Attached are the departmental performance reports and _____ (it/these/them) should be reviewed by each department head.

4. Complete the given narrative by filling in the blank with the correct option:

The attendant _____ several guests at the same time to ensure prompt service.

- (a) waited on (b) waited in
(c) waited up (d) waited

5. Select the correct option to fill in the blank for the given line from a daily newspaper:

The cars were stopped _____ going any further due to a traffic diversion.

- (a) to (b) from
(c) within (d) by

6. Complete the given narrative by filling in the blank with the correct option:

Not only did Mayank work hard to win the trophy, _____ helped the juniors to improve their skills.

- (a) he as well as (b) but he also

- (c) and he also (d) just as he

7. Complete the given narrative by filling in the blank with the correct option:

The residents promised to _____ the President of the association in his demand for proper garbage disposal systems.

- (a) stood by (b) stand by
(c) stand against (d) stood for

8. Fill in the blank with the correct option:

The number of people attending this evening's annual function is _____ than that of the previous year's.

- (a) fewer (b) few
(c) less (d) much

9. Fill in the blank by choosing the correct option.

I appreciate even _____ help given to me.

- (a) little (b) much
(c) the little (d) few

10. Fill in the blank by choosing the correct option to complete a school advisory.

Parents must _____ their children's leisure activities.

- (a) look at (b) look into
(c) look away (d) look up

11. Select the option that identifies the error and supplies the correction for the following line:

Option	Error	Correction
(a)	sounds	sound
(b)	laughter	laughing
(c)	was	were
(d)	in	of

12. Complete the given narrative by filling in the blank

with the correct option:

In times of trouble you can always _____ your parents for help.

- (a) turn in (b) turn to
(c) turn on (d) turn away

13. Fill in the blank by choosing the correct option:

After many months of research, the scientists _____ the invisible barrier.

- (a) break down (b) broke out
(c) broke in (d) broke through

14. Select the correct option to fill in the blanks for the given line:

Don't you have _____ friends in the school?

- (a) much (b) few
(c) little (d) any

15. Select the option that identifies the error and supplies the correction for the following line from a sports journal:

The captain of the team was accused with not encouraging the team members.

Option No.	Error	Correction
A	The	a
B	With	of
C	encouraging	encouragement
D	members	member

16. Complete the given narrative by filling in the blank with the correct option:

The children, _____ better safety procedures after the unexpected fire in the school.

- (a) called for (b) called in
(c) called by (d) called out

17. Fill in the blank by choosing the correct option to complete the sentence.

Enclosed are the updated project guidelines and _____ (this / these / they) need to be shared with the entire project team to ensure compliance.

18. Fill in the blank by choosing the correct option, to complete the line from a policy document of a company:

It helps anyone _____ (whom/who/which) wants to enter into a contractual relationship with the company to gain knowledge about the company.

19. Select the option that identifies the error and supplies the correction for a privacy policy document.

We process this data to supply the goods as well as services you have purchased or to keep records of such transactions.

Option No.	Error	Correction
(A)	this	these
(B)	or	and
(C)	keep	keeping
(D)	have	has

20. Fill in the blank by choosing the correct option to complete an issued circular by an organization, to its Managers.

Attached is the new company policy on remote work and _____ (it / these them) should be distributed to all employees as soon as possible.

21. Identify the error and supply correction for the given sentence from a technology company's product description.

Our latest software solution is designed for help businesses streamline their operations.

Error	Correction

22. Identify the error and supply the correction for this line from a sociological research paper.

There's a significant correlation of low income and high crime rates.

Use the given format for your response.

Error	Correction

23. Fill in the blank by choosing the correct option, to complete the disclaimer given before a documentary film.

The film has been created by taking creative liberties and dramatizing the events _____ (about/for/on) cinematic expressions.

24. Select the option that identifies the error and supplies the correction for the opening line, from a Terms and Conditions document.

Though all efforts have been made to ensure the accuracy of the content on this website, the same could not be construed as a statement of law or used for any legal purposes.



Option No.	Error	Correction
(A)	efforts	effort
(B)	ensure	ensuring
(C)	could	should
(D)	of	for

CBSE, 2022

1. The following paragraph has not been edited. There is one error in each line. Identify the error and write its correction against the correct blank number. Remember to underline the correction. The first one has been done for you.

	Error	Correction
She reminds us that it are	(e.g) are	is
important to visiting museums in	(a) _____	_____
our country to experience a impact	(b) _____	_____
that a work of rt leaves in our senses	(c) _____	_____

2. The following paragraph has not been edited. There is one error in each line. Identify the error and write its correction against the correct blank number. Remember to underline the correction. The first one

has been done for you.

	Error	Correction
While the worst for covid-19 in India	(e.g) for	of
seems to be over, one may remain	(a) _____	_____
vigilant and response quickly to	(b) _____	_____
any future spike of cases.	(c) _____	_____

3. The following paragraph has an error in each line with a blank. Write the correct and the incorrect word in the blanks provided. The first one has been done for you.

	Incorrect	Correct
A first Indian woman physician	(e.g) (a) A	The
Anandibai Joshi graduated at 1886.	(b) _____	_____
About 125 years later, Indian women had start to outnumber men in	(c) _____	_____
admissions of medical colleges.	(d) _____	_____



Explanations

CBSE, 2024

1.

Error	Correction
of	between

2. it

3. these

4. (a) waited on

5. (b) from

6. (b) but he also

7. (b) stand by

8. (a) fewer

9. (c) the little

10. (b) look into

11.

Option	Error	Correction
(d)	in	of

12. (b) turn to

13. (d) broke through

14. (d) any

15.

Option	Error	Correction
B	With	of

16. (a) called for

17.

Error	Correction
into	in

18. these

19. Who

20.

Option No.	Error	Correction
------------	-------	------------

(B)	or	and
-----	----	-----

21. it

22.

Error	Correction
for help business	to help business

23.

Error	Correction
of	between

24. for

25.

Option No.	Error	Correction
(D)	of	for

CBSE, 2022

1.

	Error	Correction
(a)	insiting	insit
(b)	a	the
(c)	in	on

2.

	Error	Correction
(a)	may	must
(b)	response	respond
(c)	of	in

3.

	Incorrect	Correct
(a)	A	The
(b)	at	in
(c)	start	started
(d)	of	to

Writing Skills

6

CHAPTER

Formal Letter



Previous Year Questions

CBSE, 2024

1. There are daily reports in the newspaper of fatal accidents due to reckless driving and road rage. Write a letter to the Commissioner of Traffic Police in about 120 words suggesting the need to take stricter action against the offenders. Recommend the use of social media to launch awareness campaigns about the implications of irresponsible driving. You are Shantanu/Savita, living at B-108 Krishi Apartments.
2. A leading communication company 'Savera' is sponsoring a half marathon run in your city to raise funds for 'Koshish' an orphanage. You are Roshini/Roshan, school captain of Adarsh Vidyalaya. You are leading a batch of hundred students in the half marathon to be held in your city.
Write a letter to the editor of a national daily emphasizing the participation of school children in such programmes as part of voluntary community service. Highlight the benefits of participation in such activities.
3. You are Soumya/Soham, living at 43-B, Blue Apartments, Prashant Lok. You wish to take up a three-week summer course in baking after finishing your class X board exams. Write a letter in about 120 words, to the Principal of Excellent Cooking, Block- D, Mahesh Enclave, seeking information about the course structure, course duration, fees, class timings, on job trainings etc.
4. You are Punit/Punita of Eric India Pvt. Ltd., Saman Chowk. You have received the reply to your letter of inquiry from Lifeway India Company. You feel confident about the company's terms and conditions. Write a letter placing an order for the furniture for your office, that you had mentioned in the previous communication. Include a reference to your previous letter. Remember to mention quantity, quality, mode of payment, delivery date and discount.
5. You are Aman/Amita, living at 45-B, Bellaview Nagar. You want information about the French language course at La-France institute, Mohan Circle. Write a letter in about 120 words to the Director, Foreign Language enquiring about the details of the courses offered by the institution. In your letter include eligibility, duration of different courses, medium of instruction, examination cycle etc.
6. The Residents of Sunshine Society had put up a weekend carnival to raise funds for 'Apeksha' a home for physically challenged. All items on sale were made by the residents themselves. As President of the society, Adil Kumar, write a letter in 120 words to the editor of the local daily, about this experience, appreciating the effort of the residents. Suggest how citizens must reach out to their communities, volunteer time and render help in any way they can.
7. As Nalini Sharda of 409, Surya Apartments, Gopalpur, you believe that pedestrian safety is very important. Footpaths on both sides of the main roads of your city need major repairs and on some stretches they need to be constructed.
Write a letter to the MLA of your city area, in about 120 words, stressing the need for footpaths for pedestrian safety. Share your concern for maintenance of existing footpaths and the need to construct new ones where they are required.
8. As Sohail Khan, the sports captain of Pinnacle Public School, you believe that fitness as a lifestyle should be promoted. Write a letter to the Editor of a national daily, in about 120 words, suggesting the introduction of "Cycle to School"

campaign for school going students. The programme aims to develop the habit of exercising through cycling to maintain fitness and keeping children active. Share the importance and credibility of such a programme and suggest a feasible way to execute it along with possible activities.

9. As Komal Gupta of 987, Dev Apartments, Rajpur, you believe that proper waste management is a must in today's times when we need to promote 'Recycling' for optimum utilization of things/products. Despite ample promotion by civic authorities about segregation of waste into 'recyclable' and non recyclable' waste the garbage collectors in your areas do not follow the rules.

Write a letter to the MLA of your city, in about 120 words, apprising him of the situation, sharing the importance of waste segregation and requesting him to take strict action against erring personnel.

10. As Anushri Jain, a resident of 52, Mount view Apartments, Abadpur, you are distressed with frequent long power cuts in your society. Despite several request letters to the concerned authority, the problem still persists. Write a letter to the editor of a local daily, in about 120 words highlighting the inconvenience faced by the residents of the locality and offering solutions.
11. As Sharman Singh of 776, Hemkunt Apartments, Arampur, you believe that as a law abiding citizen who pays regular taxes you deserve regular supply of clean drinking water in your house. However, your locality is facing acute shortage as supply is often disrupted without notice causing problems to the residents. Write a letter to the Director of Jal Board of your city area, in about 120 words, apprising him of the situation; sharing the need for regular supply of clean water and requesting him to take necessary action to improve the situation.
12. As Sonam Mehta, a resident of 14, Sunrise Apartment, Udaipur, you are distressed about the misuse and poor maintenance of the public park in your society. Write a letter to the editor of a local daily, in about 120 words, highlighting the condition, mentioning the inconvenience faced by the residents of the locality. Share the importance of public parks and suggest measures for its proper upkeep.
13. You are Kapil/Kavita, sports secretary of Ajax World School, Gurugram. You want to place an order for sports articles for the school cricket team to Rotary Sports, Janakpuri, New Delhi. Write a letter in about 120 words. Remember to include relevant information about quality and quantity of products, specific details, school discount, delivery date and mode of payment.
14. You are Rahul / Rita, a student of DRK World School, Preet Vihar, Prem Nagar. You have recently noticed that the street in front of the school is being used as a thoroughfare by vehicles because of the construction work on the main street. This has led to a number of near fatal accidents involving school students who have become vulnerable to road injuries and exposure to toxic air and noise pollution while going to school. Write a letter to the Editor of a local daily in about 120 words highlighting the problem. You may also suggest possible solutions such as road safety signages, speed breakers, traffic timings.
15. As a concerned parent, you have observed rash driving of the school bus drivers. You have also noted overcrowding of the buses, open doors and how the drivers barely stop for the students to board safely. You are Nikita/ Nikhil. Write a letter to the Principal of the Swacha School providing details of what you have noticed over the past few weeks. Express your concern and suggest recommendations to avoid any mishap. You may include recommendations such as a security guard in the bus, speed limit, increase in the number of buses.
16. In spite of repeated promises made by the authorities, potholes on the roads both internal and main streets have not been fixed. Poor, makeshift repair work was done which did not last beyond a week. This problem has led to many people having nasty falls and traffic congestion.
- Write a letter to your MLA drawing his attention to the problem. Remind him of his promise to repair the roads immediately to reduce inconvenience of the residents. You are Akshita / Aslam, Secretary RWA, Jaunasपुर.
17. The bursting of the sewage pipe in your colony has led to an overflow of sewage making it impossible to travel on A2 and A3 streets of your colony. The stench is unbearable and the colony gates have to be closed leading to traffic jams. In addition, the overflowing sewage water has become a breeding ground for mosquitoes. As secretary RWA, you have been repeatedly complaining to the civic authorities but to no avail.
- You are Shanti / Shantam of Kanchan Vihar. Write a letter to your local MLA requesting immediate action.
18. As President of the Mountaineering Club of your school, you wish to organize a weekend trek to Kempton Falls. You are Pratibha / Prateek. Write a letter to the Director, Outdoor Adventures mentioning your proposed travel

dates, number of students and teacher escorts. Find out about the mode of travel options, boarding, lodging, trekking gear, camping facilities and cost.

19. The problem of speeding traffic on colony roads causing accidents is increasing day by day. As a young citizen, who wants to minimize the accidents caused by them, write a letter to the editor of a national daily, in about 120 words, expressing your concern at the situation and suggesting measures to resolve the problem and drawing attention of the concerned authorities.

You are Samyukta Khanna/Sanjay Khanna of 567, Madhur Apartments, Amar Vihar, Aram Nagar.

20. As Kaveri Mahajan, of 543, Narmada Apartments, Jeev Nagar, you feel that during the monsoon season all the rain water goes down the drain without being utilized.

Write a letter to the RWA of your society, in about 120 words, suggesting measures to save and preserve rain water emphasizing the importance of saving every drop of water.

21. The street lights of your locality are not functioning properly leaving stretches of dark/blind spots at night. Due to this problem, chain and mobile snatching incidents have increased.

Write a letter to the editor of a local daily, in about 120 words, expressing your concern at the situation and suggesting measures to resolve the problem and drawing attention of the concerned authorities. You are Tamay Saroha/Gauri Saroha of 709, Gold Apartments, Prem Vihar, Amar Nagar.

22. As Sarla Mehta/Santosh Mehta of 983, Sterling Apartments, Vikas Nagar, you believe in the importance of staying fit and exercising. Your society does not have an open gym in the premises. Write a letter to the RWA of your society, in about 120 words, requesting them to set up an open gym in the garden area where residents can exercise, emphasizing upon the importance of staying fit and healthy.

23. In your local market, you have noticed that young children are working in a few restaurants. You were aghast to see a blatant violation of laws. Write a letter to the editor of a national daily, in about 120 words, expressing your concern at the situation and suggesting measures to resolve the problem and drawing attention of the concerned authorities.

You are Mauzam Haseeb/Nasifa Khan of 917, Platinum Apartments, Gomti Vihar, Kath Nagar.

24. As John Silva/Jane Pereira of 64, Sangam Apartments, Sunrise Hills, you feel very unhappy at the poor maintenance of the public parks in your area. As a result children have no place to play and parents find it difficult to walk on the tracks. Write a letter to the CEO of Sunrise Hills, in about 120 words, expressing your concern at the situation and suggesting measures to resolve the issue of poor maintenance.

25. The problem of open manholes and drains in your locality is posing a threat to the lives of people. As a young citizen, who cares about the upkeep of the locality and safety of the residents, write a letter to the editor of a local daily, in about 120 words, expressing your concern at the situation and suggesting measures to resolve the problem and drawing attention of the concerned authorities.

You are Sam/Karen of 67, Nagar. Mist Apartments, Gagan Vihar, Akash.

26. As Rohini Monga / Rohan Monga, of 43 Jai Apartments, Neerbagh, you feel that there should be a dedicated space in the community park for the senior citizens of the society, where they can gather.

Write a letter to the RWA of your society in about 120 words, suggesting spaces in the park and emphasizing the importance of creating such a space.

27. The household water supply in your locality is muddy and not fit for drinking. Despite several complaint letters to the civic authorities, the problem is still unresolved.

Write a letter to the editor of a local daily, in about 120 words, expressing your concern at the situation and suggesting measures to resolve the problem and drawing attention of the concerned authorities.

You are Somil / Soumya of 768, Silver Apartments, Ajitha Vihar, Karampeeth.

28. As Geetanjali Girish of 83, Star Apartments, Virbagh, you have noticed that a lot of senior citizens in your society are leading lonely lives. Write a letter in about 120 words, to the President of RWA of your society, requesting him to organize more community get-togethers and celebrations to bring cheer to their lonely lives.



29. The roads in your locality have developed big potholes after the rains and have not been repaired. Despite several complaint letters to the civic authorities, the problem is still unresolved. Write a letter to the editor of a local daily, in about 120 words, expressing your concern at the situation and suggesting measures to resolve the problem and drawing attention of the concerned authorities. You are Maasumi/Mausan of 17, Crown Apartments, Harsh Vihar, Akash Nagar.
30. As Jignesh Silva/Punkhuri Shukl of 648, Sec-19, Sadar Nagar, you feel very unhappy and annoyed with the way bikes and cars are haphazardly parked in front of residential units causing inconvenience to residents. Write a letter to the RWA of your society in about 120 words, expressing your concern at the situation and suggesting measures to remove the nuisance.



Explanations

CBSE, 2024

1. B-108

Krishi Apartments
26 February 2024
The Commissioner
Traffic Police
New Delhi

Subject: Regarding increasing road accidents

Sir,

This is to bring in your kind notice that the cases of reckless driving and road rage are accelerating each day, resulting in fatal accidents. The roads of Delhi are not safe anyways. However, the situation is worse in northern parts. During the light traffic hours after 10 p.m., it seems like some people choose the road just to release their stress by driving recklessly and giving other riders a near death experience. This eventually results into fights and even major accidents.

In the past one week, I've come across fifteen articles in the newspaper reporting more than 10 fatal accidents resulting in many casualties.

It has become vital that certain strict actions are taken against these offenders. Either by confiscating their vehicles or by cancelling their licenses, a lesson must be taught. In addition, publicizing this issue on social media will certainly bring awareness in this regard, resulting in a strong grip over these irresponsible drivers.

I request you to do something in this regard. I will be highly grateful for your consideration.

Yours sincerely
Savita

2. Adarsh Vidyalaya

Agartala
Tripura 799001
26 February 2024
The Editor
The Indian Express
8-A, Bahadurshah Zafar Marg
New Delhi

Subject: Conducting a half marathon for orphans

Dear Sir/Madam

I am pleased to announce that a hundred students from Adarsh Vidyalaya, under my leadership, will partake in a marathon sponsored by Savera, a leading communication company, in Agartala, to support Koshish orphanage.

In an era marked by apathy and detachment, the voluntary participation by school children, in community service initiatives like this one, is crucial. As it is a fund-raising event, the amount collected through this will be used in the education, growth and development of these children.

I humbly request you to consider publishing this in your esteemed column, so that more individuals find the inspiration to actively participate and contribute towards building a more compassionate and inclusive society.

Sincerely
Roshini

3. 43-B, Blue Apartments

Prashant Lok
5th October 2024
The Principal
Excellent Cooking
Block-D, Mahesh Enclave

Subject: Inquiry Regarding Summer Course in Baking

Sir/Madam,

I am Soumya, a student residing at the above address. I am keen on joining a three-week summer course in baking after completing my Class X board exams. I would like to know the structure of the course, its duration, fees, class timings, and whether there are any practical or on-job training sessions included. Additionally, please inform me about the registration process and the materials required for the course.

I would be grateful if you could provide this

information at the earliest so I can plan accordingly.

Yours faithfully,

Soumya

4. Eric India Pvt. Ltd.

Saman Chowk

5th October 2024

The Sales Manager

Lifeway India Company

Subject: Order for Office Furniture

Sir/Madam,

With reference to my previous letter dated 29th September 2024, I am pleased to place an order for the following office furniture items for our company:

- 10 executive chairs (high-back, cushioned)
- 5 office desks (wooden, ergonomic design)
- 2 large conference tables (seating 10-12 people)

Please ensure delivery by 15th October 2024. Payment will be made via bank transfer upon receipt of goods. Kindly apply the agreed 10% discount as per our earlier communication. We expect quality and timely delivery, as mentioned in your terms.

Yours faithfully,

Punit

5. 45-B, Bellaview Nagar

5th October 2024

The Director

La-France Institute

Mohan Circle

Subject: Inquiry Regarding French Language Course

Sir/Madam,

I am writing to inquire about the French language courses offered by your esteemed institute. I would appreciate it if you could provide detailed information regarding the various levels of courses available, their eligibility criteria, and the duration of each course. Additionally, I would like to know the medium of instruction, the fees for each level, and the schedule for examinations. Kindly also provide details about class timings and any specific materials required for enrolment.

I look forward to your response, as I am eager to

pursue my language studies.

Yours faithfully,

Aman

6. Sunshine Society

5th October 2024

The Editor

The Daily Post

Subject: Fundraising Carnival for 'Apeksha'

Sir/Madam,

Through the columns of your esteemed newspaper, I wish to highlight a successful fundraising carnival held at Sunshine Society last weekend. Organised to raise funds for 'Apeksha', a home for the physically challenged, the carnival showcased the tremendous effort of the residents. All items on sale were handmade by the residents, demonstrating a spirit of unity and charity.

This event emphasised the importance of community engagement, and I urge fellow citizens to volunteer their time for social causes. We can make a significant difference by extending a helping hand and contributing to the welfare of the less fortunate.

Yours sincerely,

Adil Kumar

President, Sunshine Society

7. 409, Surya Apartments

Gopalpur

[Date]

The Honourable MLA

[MLA's Office Address]

[City]

Subject: Urgent Need for Footpath Repairs and Construction

Dear Sir/Madam,

I am writing too highlight a crucial issue concerning pedestrian safety in our city. The footpaths on both sides of the main roads in Gopalpur are in a deplorable state. Many existing footpaths are severely damaged and unsafe for use, while some areas lack footpaths altogether. This situation not only jeopardises the safety of pedestrians, especially children and the elderly, but also contributes to traffic congestion as people are forced to walk on the roads.

I urge you to allocate funds for the urgent repair and maintenance of existing footpaths and to construct

where they are currently massaging. Ensuring safe and well-maintained footpaths will significantly enhance pedestrians' safety and improve the overall quality of life in our city.

Thank you for your attention to this matter.

Yours faithfully,

Nalini Sharda

409, Surya Apartments

Gopalpur

8. To the Editor,

National Daily,

Date: [_____]

Dear Sir/Madam,

As Sohail Khan, Sports Captain at Pinnacle Public School, I propose a "Cycle to School" campaign to promote fitness among school students. Encouraging children to cycle to school can still a lifelong habit of regular exercise and help maintain their fitness levels while keeping them active.

Cycling not only enhances cardiovascular health but also reduces reliance on motorised transport, contributing to a greener environment. To implement this programme, schools can set designated cycling days, organise safety workshops, and provide incentives for consistent participation. Additionally, collaboration with local authorities to ensure safe cycling routes and infrastructure is crucial.

Such initiatives will foster healthy habits and create a positive impact on students' overall well-being.

Yours sincerely,

Sohail Khan

Sports Captain

Pinnacle Public School

9. 987, Dev Apartments

Rajpur

5th October 2024

The MLA

Rajpur Constituency

Subject: Irregular Waste Collection and Segregation in Our Area

Sir,

I am writing to bring to your attention the issue of improper waste management in our area. Despite the civic authorities' campaigns promoting the segregation of recyclable and non-recyclable waste, the garbage collectors in our locality are not adhering

to the rules. This neglect is leading to improper disposal, which defeats the purpose of recycling.

I request you to take strict action against the personnel involved and ensure that proper segregation is followed. Effective waste management is essential for a cleaner environment and sustainable living. Your intervention in this matter would be greatly appreciated.

Yours sincerely,

Komal Gupta

10. 52, Mount View Apartments

Abadpur

5th October 2024

The Editor

The Daily Voice

Subject: Frequent Power Cuts in Our Locality

Sir/Madam,

Through the columns of your esteemed newspaper, I wish to highlight the distress caused by frequent long power cuts in our locality. Despite several requests to the concerned authority, the issue remains unresolved. These prolonged outages severely disrupt daily life, particularly for students, elderly residents, and those working from home.

I urge the authorities to take immediate action by either upgrading the power infrastructure or ensuring better maintenance to avoid such interruptions. Installing an alternative backup power system could help manage sudden breakdowns. A timely solution would greatly ease the burden on the residents.

Yours sincerely,

Anushri Jain

11. 776, Hemkunt Apartments

Arapur

5th October 2024

The Director

City Jal Board

Subject: Irregular Water Supply in Our Locality

Sir/Madam,

I am writing to bring to your notice the irregular water supply in our locality. For the past few weeks, the supply has been frequently disrupted without prior notice, causing significant inconvenience. As law-abiding citizens who regularly pay our taxes,



we expect a continuous and clean supply of drinking water.

I request you to take immediate action to ensure regular supply and provide prior notification in case of maintenance work or disruption. Clean water is a basic necessity, and the current situation is creating immense hardship for the residents. Your prompt attention to this matter would be highly appreciated.

Yours sincerely,

Sharman Singh

12. 14, Sunrise Apartments

Udaipur

5th October 2024

The Editor

The Udaipur Times

Subject: Poor Maintenance of Public Park

Sir/Madam,

Through the columns of your esteemed newspaper, I wish to highlight the poor condition of the public park in our locality. The park is poorly maintained, with broken benches, uncut grass, and litter scattered everywhere. This has caused inconvenience, particularly for children and elderly residents, who can no longer enjoy the park.

Public parks are essential for community well-being, providing a space for recreation and socialising. I suggest appointing a dedicated team to maintain the park and ensure cleanliness. Adequate lighting and regular upkeep would enhance its usability and restore its appeal to the residents.

Yours sincerely,

Sonam Mehta

13. Ajax World School

Gurugram

5th October 2024

The Sales Manager

Rotary Sports

Janakpuri, New Delhi

Subject: Order for Cricket Team Sports Articles

Sir/Madam,

As the sports secretary of Ajax World School, I would like to place an order for sports articles for our school cricket team. We require 10 cricket bats, 12 pairs of gloves, 15 pairs of pads, and 20 cricket

balls. Please ensure the products are of high quality, suitable for senior-level players.

Kindly confirm if a school discount is available. We request delivery by 15th October, and payment will be made via bank transfer upon delivery. Please send the invoice and order confirmation at your earliest convenience.

Yours sincerely,

Kapil

(Sports Secretary)

14. DRK World School

Preet Vihar, Prem Nagar

5th October 2024

The Editor

The Daily Herald

Subject: Hazardous Traffic Conditions in Front of School

Sir/Madam,

I wish to draw attention to a pressing issue: the street in front of our school is being used as a thoroughfare due to ongoing construction on the main road. This has resulted in several near accidents involving students, making them vulnerable to injuries. The heavy vehicular movement also exposes students to toxic air and noise pollution.

I urge the authorities to install road safety signage, speed breakers, and restrict traffic during school hours to prevent accidents. Immediate action is necessary to ensure the safety of schoolchildren.

Yours sincerely,

Rahul

15. Nikita

45, Green Park Colony

New Delhi

5th October 2024

The Principal

Swacha School

New Delhi

Subject: Concern Over Rash Driving and Overcrowding in School Buses

Sir/Madam,

I am writing to express my concern regarding the reckless driving by the school bus drivers. I have observed overcrowding, open doors during transit,

and the drivers barely stopping to allow students to board safely. These issues pose serious risks to the children's safety.

I recommend appointing a security guard on each bus, enforcing speed limits, and increasing the number of buses to reduce overcrowding. These measures would help prevent potential accidents and ensure the students' safety.

I trust you will address this matter urgently.

Yours sincerely,

Nikita

16. Akshita

Secretary, RWA

Jaunapuri

5th October 2024

The MLA

Jaunapuri Constituency

Subject: Urgent Need for Road Repairs

Sir/Madam,

I am writing to bring your attention to the deteriorating condition of the roads in Jaunapuri. Despite repeated promises, the potholes on both the internal roads and the main streets remain unrepaired. A makeshift repair was carried out recently, but it did not last for more than a week. This has caused several accidents and created traffic congestion, causing immense inconvenience to the residents.

We kindly urge you to fulfil your promise of permanent road repairs as soon as possible to alleviate the situation and prevent further incidents.

We look forward to your prompt action on this matter.

Yours sincerely,

Akshita

Secretary, RWA Jaunapuri

17. Shanti

Secretary, RWA

Kanchan Vihar

5th October 2024

The MLA

Kanchan Vihar Constituency

New Delhi

Subject: Immediate Action Required to Address

Sewage Overflow

Sir,

I am writing to draw your attention to the bursting of the sewage pipe in our colony, which has led to severe inconvenience. Streets A2 and A3 are flooded, making them impassable. The stench is unbearable, and colony gates are closed, causing traffic jams. Furthermore, the stagnant sewage has become a breeding ground for mosquitoes, creating a health hazard.

Despite multiple complaints, no action has been taken. I request you to address this issue immediately and restore normalcy in our colony.

Yours sincerely,

Shanti

Secretary, RWA

18. Prateek

President, Mountaineering Club

XYZ School

5th October 2024

The Director

Outdoor Adventures

New Delhi

Subject: Request for Information Regarding Weekend Trek to Kempty Falls

Sir,

As President of the Mountaineering Club, I am planning a weekend trek to Kempty Falls. We propose to travel on the weekend of 18th October 2024 with a group of 25 students and 3 teacher escorts.

Could you kindly provide details about the mode of travel, boarding, lodging, trekking gear, camping facilities, and the cost per participant? Your assistance will help us plan the trek smoothly.

Looking forward to your response.

Yours sincerely,

Prateek

President, Mountaineering Club

19. Sanjay Khanna

567, Madhur Apartments

Amar Vihar, Aram Nagar

5th October 2024



The Editor
The National Daily
New Delhi

Subject: Concern Over Increasing Speeding Traffic in Colony

Sir,

I wish to draw attention to the growing problem of speeding vehicles in our colony, leading to frequent accidents. This menace is particularly concerning as children and elderly residents often use the roads.

I suggest the installation of speed breakers and clear road safety signages. Additionally, assigning traffic police during peak hours can control the situation. Immediate action is necessary to prevent further accidents and ensure the safety of the residents.

I hope the concerned authorities will take swift action.

Yours sincerely,

Sanjay Khanna

20. Kaveri Mahajan

543, Narmada Apartments

Jeev Nagar

5th October 2024

The Secretary

RWA, Narmada Apartments

Jeev Nagar

Subject: Measures to Save Rainwater During Monsoon

Sir/Madam,

As a resident of the society, I am concerned that during the monsoon season, a lot of rainwater is wasted. It flows directly into the drains without being utilized.

I suggest the installation of rainwater harvesting systems, especially on rooftops, to preserve water. We could also direct the collected water to underground storage tanks for later use in gardening and cleaning. Saving every drop of water is crucial, especially during water shortages.

I hope you will consider these suggestions and take necessary action.

Yours sincerely,

Kaveri Mahajan

21. Gauri Saroha

709, Gold Apartments
Prem Vihar, Amar Nagar
5th October 2024

The Editor

The Local Daily

New Delhi

Subject: Concern Over Non-Functioning Street Lights

Sir,

I wish to highlight the issue of non-functioning street lights in our locality. Many stretches of our streets are left in darkness at night, leading to an increase in chain and mobile snatching incidents. These dark spots pose a serious threat to the safety of residents.

I suggest the immediate repair of street lights and regular maintenance to ensure they function properly. Installing CCTV cameras in vulnerable areas would also help deter criminal activities.

I urge the concerned authorities to take prompt action to resolve this issue.

Yours sincerely,

Gauri Saroha

22. Sarla Mehta

983, Sterling Apartments

Vikas Nagar

5th October 2024

The Secretary

RWA, Sterling Apartments

Vikas Nagar

Subject: Request for Setting Up an Open Gym in the Society

Sir/Madam,

I am writing to request the establishment of an open gym in the garden area of our society. As a resident who believes in the importance of staying fit and healthy, I feel that an open gym will greatly benefit all age groups by encouraging regular exercise.

Many societies are already embracing this idea to promote health and wellness, and I believe it would be a positive addition to our community. Kindly consider my request to create a space where residents can exercise and stay active.

Yours sincerely,

Sarla Mehta

23. Mauzam Haseeb
917, Platinum Apartments
Gomti Vihar, Kath Nagar
5th October 2024
The Editor
The National Daily
New Delhi

Subject: Concern Over Child Labour in Local Restaurants

Sir,

I am deeply concerned to witness young children working in restaurants in our local market, which is a clear violation of child labour laws. This exploitation of children not only denies them their right to education but also puts their safety at risk.

I urge the concerned authorities to take immediate action against this illegal practice. Additionally, awareness campaigns on the legal consequences of employing minors should be conducted to deter restaurant owners from such practices.

I hope your esteemed daily will highlight this issue and prompt the necessary action.

Yours sincerely,

Mauzam Haseeb

24. Jane Pereira
64, Sangam Apartments
Sunrise Hills
5th October 2024
The CEO
Sunrise Hills Society
New Delhi

Subject: Poor Maintenance of Public Parks in Sunrise Hills

Sir,

I wish to express my concern about the poor condition of the public parks in our locality. Due to inadequate maintenance, children have no proper place to play, and parents find it difficult to walk on the tracks. The parks are littered, and the grass

is overgrown.

I request that the maintenance team be instructed to clean the parks regularly and repair damaged infrastructure. This will ensure that the parks remain safe and enjoyable for all residents.

Yours sincerely,

Jane Pereira

25. Karen
67, Mist Apartments
Gagan Vihar, Akash Nagar
5th October 2024
The Editor
The Local Daily
New Delhi

Subject: Concern Over Open Manholes and Drains in Gagan Vihar

Sir,

I am writing to bring attention to the dangerous condition of open manholes and drains in our locality, which poses a serious threat to the safety of residents, especially at night. This problem has already caused accidents, and it is only a matter of time before something more serious happens.

I request that the authorities take immediate action to cover these manholes and repair the drains. Regular inspections should also be conducted to ensure public safety.

Yours sincerely,

Karen

26. Rohini Monga
43, Jai Apartments
Neerbagh
5th October 2024
The Secretary
RWA, Jai Apartments
Neerbagh

Subject: Request for Dedicated Space for Senior Citizens in Community Park

Sir/Madam,

I am writing to suggest the creation of a dedicated space for senior citizens in the community park. This space can serve as a place for them to gather, socialize, and relax. Senior citizens often find it



difficult to engage in physical activities, and having a designated area would help them connect with others in the society.

I hope you will consider this suggestion, as it will greatly benefit our elderly residents and contribute to their well-being.

Yours sincerely,

Rohini Monga

27. Soumya

768, Silver Apartments

Ajitha Vihar, Karampeeth

5th October 2024

The Editor

The Local Daily

New Delhi

Subject: Concern Over Muddy Water Supply in Ajitha Vihar

Sir,

I wish to highlight the issue of muddy water supply in our locality, which has persisted for several weeks. The water is not fit for drinking, and despite multiple complaints to the civic authorities, no action has been taken. This poses a serious health risk to the residents.

I request the authorities to address this issue urgently, and ensure that the water supply is clean and safe for consumption. Installing water filters at key points in the supply chain may also prevent this problem in the future.

Yours sincerely,

Soumya

28. Geetanjali

83, Star Apartments

Virbagh

5th October 2024

The President

RWA, Star Apartments

Virbagh

Subject: Request to Organize Community Get-Togethers for Senior Citizens

Sir,

I have observed that many senior citizens in our society are leading lonely lives. To bring some joy to their lives, I suggest organizing regular community get-togethers and celebrations where

they can interact with others. Such events will not only foster a sense of belonging but also help reduce their feelings of isolation.

I hope you will consider my request and plan events that will bring happiness to our elderly residents.

Yours sincerely,

Geetanjali

29. Maasumi

17, Crown Apartments

Harsh Vihar, Akash Nagar

5th October 2024

The Editor

The Local Daily

New Delhi

Subject: Concern Over Potholes on Roads in Harsh Vihar

Sir,

I am writing to highlight the deteriorating condition of roads in our locality. After the rains, large potholes have developed, making travel unsafe for vehicles and pedestrians. Despite multiple complaints to the civic authorities, no proper repairs have been made.

I urge the authorities to take immediate action and repair the roads before further accidents occur. Proper maintenance of roads is essential for the safety of residents and the smooth flow of traffic.

Yours sincerely,

Maasumi

30. Punkhuri Shukl

648, Sector 19

Sadar Nagar

5th October 2024

The Secretary

RWA, Sector 19

Sadar Nagar

Subject: Concern Over Haphazard Parking in Front of Residences

Sir/Madam,

I am writing to express my concern about the haphazard parking of bikes and cars in front of residential units, which is causing significant inconvenience to residents. Vehicles are often

parked in a disorderly manner, blocking entrances and obstructing the movement of pedestrians.

I suggest the RWA mark proper parking spaces and enforce parking rules to prevent this nuisance. Additionally, designating a specific parking area could resolve the issue.

Yours sincerely,

Punkhuri Shukl



7

CHAPTER

Analytical Paragraph

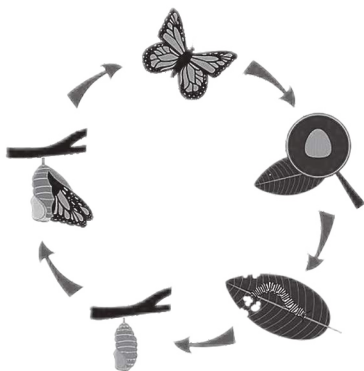


Previous Year Questions

CBSE, 2024

- The visual given shows the life cycle of a butterfly. Study the information carefully and then summarise it in the form of an analytical paragraph. Make comparisons and draw conclusions wherever applicable.

Life Cycle of Butterfly

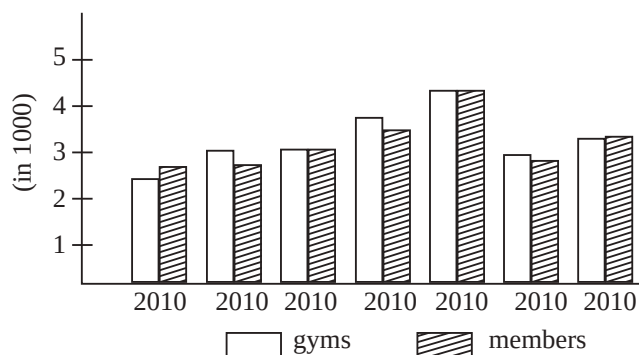


- Study the table given below which shows the data on the hobbies of students during summer vacations. Write an analytical paragraph in about 120 words analyzing what hobbies do boys and girls choose in their summer vacations:

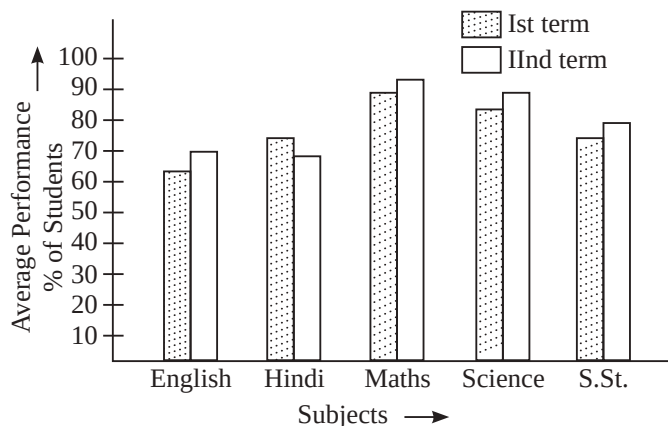
Hobbies	Boys	Girls
Singing	7%	25%
Photography	35%	5%
Playing	30%	16%
Dancing	13%	40%
Yoga	19%	15%

- The chart given below displays data about the number of gyms and the number of members in your city over the past decade. Write a paragraph analyzing the given data:

Number of gyms opening up in the past decade



- You are a teacher in New City Global School. The given bar graph shows a comparative analysis of students' performance in different subjects in the terminal exam. Write an analytical paragraph on the variation in the performances of students in about 120 words:



- Teenagers have different tastes in spending their free time. The following data shows how teenagers spend their free time. Write an analytical paragraph in about 120 words analyzing how boys and girls spend their free time:

S. No.	Hobbies	Boys (%)	Girls (%)
--------	---------	----------	-----------

1.	Reading books and comics	12%	25%
2.	Watching movies and songs	15%	35%
3.	Talking to their friends	10%	20%
4.	Watching sports	16%	4%
5.	Playing outdoor and indoor games	40%	20%

6. Read the following excerpt taken from an article that appeared in the magazine section of a local daily:

"A recent study has revealed that the prevalence of obesity among school children is on a steady rise. Consumption of food with high glycaemic index, change in sleep patterns, reduced physical activity and the increased screen time has been linked to obesity in children. This is an emerging public health problem in the country."

Taking help from the above, write an analytical paragraph for your school magazine in about 120 words. You are Sonika/Sahil.

7. An area is believed to be water stressed when annual water supplies

drop below 1700 cubic metres per person per year. As per an analysis, we are already surviving with around 1700-1800 cubic metres per year. As our demand for water has increased drastically over the years, per capita water availability has taken a beating. Based on the given table, write an analytical paragraph, in about 120 words, analyzing the possible causes of water scarcity in the future.

Table on water availability

Year	Population (Million)	Per capita water availability (m ³ /year)
1951	361	5177
1955	395	4732
1991	846	2209
2001	1027	1820
2025	1394	1341
2050	1640	1140

8. There are many types of bottles available in the market. This chart compares the disadvantages and advantages of various types of bottles, Based on the chart, write an analytical paragraph, in about 120 words, analyzing the pros and cons of each and selecting a suitable one.

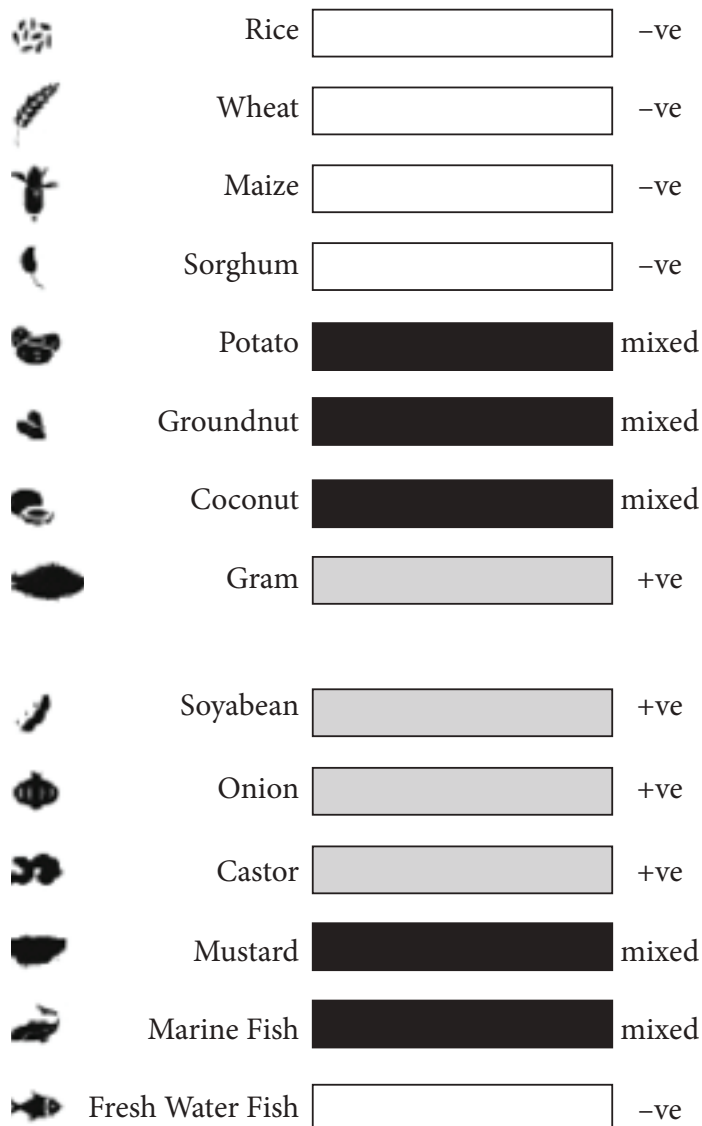
	Chemical Free?	Environmentally Friendly?	Recyclable?	Durable?	Light weight?	Easy to clean?	Dishwasher safe?	Affordable?
Glass Bottles	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	Yes	Yes	No
Silicone Bottles	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	–	Yes	Yes	No
Stainless and Bottles	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	Yes	Yes	No
Plastic Bottles	No	No	Yes	–	Yes	–	–	Yes

(Adapted for academic purpose.)

9. A climate change impact on agriculture is a point of concern. It affects all three aspects of food security.

Availability, Access and Absorption. Different crops react to climate change in different ways. The chart given below highlights the impact of climate change on various crops. Based on the given data, write an analytical paragraph, in about 120 words, analyzing the impact of climate change on various crops and discussing possible cause.

Negative
 Mixed
 Positive



10. Students dropping out of school is a universal fact. However, reasons for dropping out vary from country to country. According to a study conducted by an NGO, students gave various reasons for dropping out of school. Based on the figures given below, write an analytical paragraph, in about 120 words, analyzing and assessing the reasons.

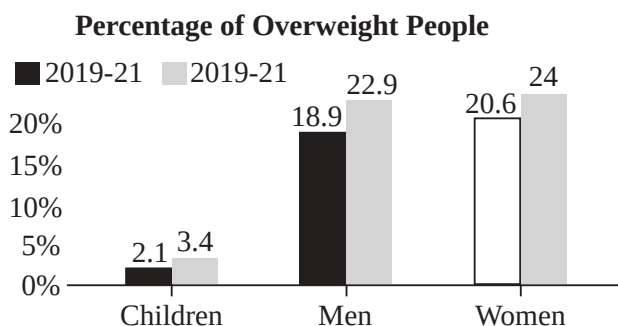
Reasons for Dropping Out of School

Students who considered dropping out of high school gave these reasons for considering this option:

- ✦ I didn't like the school ... 73%
- ✦ I didn't like the teachers ... 61%
- ✦ I didn't see value in the work I was being asked to do ... 60%

- ✦ I had family issues ... 42%
- ✦ I need to work for money ... 35%
- ✦ I was bullied ... 28%
- ✦ The work was too difficult ... 54%
- ✦ The work was too easy ... 19%

11. Cases of obesity, are on the rise. Experts fear a health emergency unless the growing obesity problem is tackled on a war footing. We can say that we are in an obesity epidemic in India. Based on the graph given below, write an analytical paragraph, in about 120 words, analyzing the percentage of overweight Indians and suggest possible solutions.



12. Life expectancy is defined as the average number of additional years a person could expect to live if current mortality trends were to continue for the rest of that person's life. It is a standard indicator for the level of socio-economic development. Based on the data given below, write an analytical paragraph, in about 120 words, analyzing the projected life expectancy of men and women over a period of time and assessing the possible causes.

Projected Life Expectancy 2001-2025

Year	Age of Men	Age of Women
2001-2005	63.8	66.1
2006-2010	65.8	68.1
2011-2015	67.3	69.8
2016-2020	68.8	71.1
2021-2025	69.8	72.3

13. Read the following excerpt from a newspaper on the problem of car parking and its impact.

A survey conducted on the residents showed that car parking in colonies has risen due to an increase in the number of cars per family. This has resulted in ugly incidents of road rage. Most of the families revealed that they are facing multiple issues due to this situation. There is no place for visitors to park

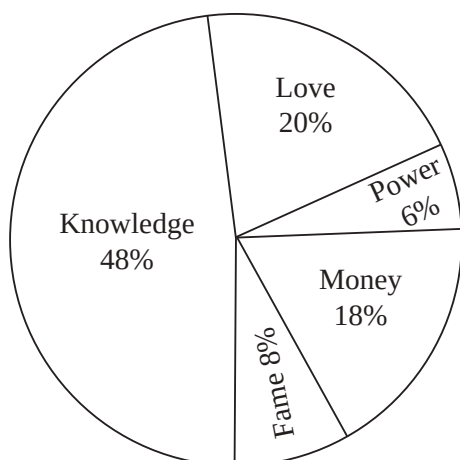
and residents themselves park their cars haphazardly. In addition there is an increase in commercial vehicles parked outside colony gates, thus blocking exits.

Write a paragraph in about 120 words to analyze the news clipping.....

14. The following data shows global literacy rates of different age groups and gender in a particular year. Write an analytical paragraph describing and analyzing the given data.

Global literacy rate %	People of different age-groups			
	12-15 years	15-24 years	25-64 years	65 years and older
Men	88	90	88	80
Women	80	88	79	75

15. Riti/Ritik has to write a paragraph on the qualities required for success. He notices the chart given below and decides to use it as the basis of his writing. Using the pie chart along with your own ideas, write a paragraph for him in about 120 words on 'The Most Important Thing in Life'.



16. Read the following excerpt from a newspaper and write an analytical paragraph in about 120 words based on it.

Plastics are not easy to dispose of as they are non-biodegradable. Over a period of time, the chemicals accumulate in the soil, and are eventually absorbed which contaminate the underground water. Even more frightening is the fact that there is currently no known technology for removing BPA and other leachates from the soil and water once they're there.

17. The data given below represents the percentage of some of the electronic devices used in India.

Summarize and analyse the data in about 120 words. Give all necessary details and compare the segments where relevant.

S. No.	Devices	Percentage
1.	Television	86%
2.	Electronic toys	40%
3.	Mobile phones	96%
4.	Laptops	38%
5.	Refrigerators	69%
6.	Kitchen appliances	84%

18. Based on the following extract, write an analytical paragraph in about 120 words:

"One of the biggest changes in our lives over the past decade is the ability to order items online and have them delivered to our doorstep. The prevalence of this raises an important question of how it affects our environment. Though buyers conserve fuel and reduce emissions from their vehicles, it is replaced by additional mileage of truck routes. Also a large amount of wastage is generated from packaging such as cardboard boxes, bubble wraps, plastic bags etc."

You may begin like this:

As a responsible citizen, I believe

You may end like this:

For these reasons, I believe, we need to limit the wastage associated with online shopping.

19. Co-curricular activities help to enhance holistic development and assist in inculcating critical skills and abilities to be successful and happy in the 11th century life and workplace.

Based on the table given below, write an analytical paragraph, in about 120 words, on how co-curricular activities supplement the theoretical curriculum

ESSENTIAL SKILLS AND VALUES THAT CAN BE DEVELOPED THROUGH CO-CURRICULAR ACTIVITIES

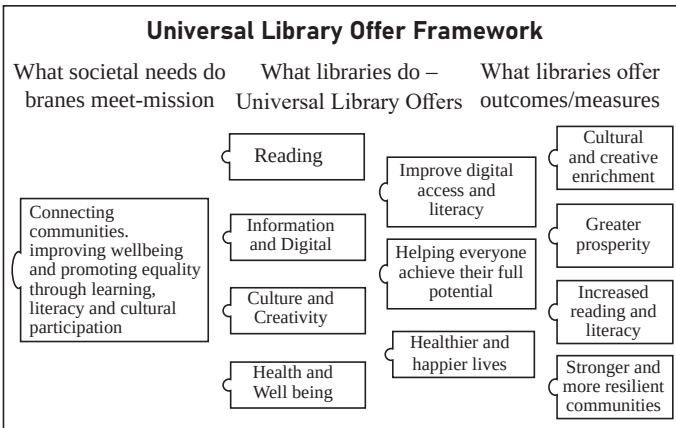
- ✦ Logical and analytical thinking
- ✦ Creative and critical thinking
- ✦ Problem-solving skills
- ✦ Leadership skills
- ✦ Social, emotional and communication skills
- ✦ Environmental value
- ✦ Enhanced technology skills

20. Tourism stands as a cornerstone of the nation's development. The following table provides an insight into the multifaceted impact and positive contributions of tourism. Write an analytical paragraph in about 120 words assessing the significance of tourism.

IMPACT OF TOURISM

- ✦ contributes to GDP and foreign exchange
- ✦ boosts local markets and businesses
- ✦ creates employment
- ✦ preserves culture
- ✦ promotes infrastructural development

21. Libraries provide access to resources and materials that might not be available or affordable otherwise, allowing students to further their learning, understanding and research. The following chart shows the library framework and the importance of libraries. Based on the given information, write an analytical paragraph, in about 120 words, assessing the importance of libraries for us.



22. Energy drinks are drinks containing stimulant compounds, usually caffeine, which is marketed as providing mental and physical stimulation (marketed as energy, but distinct from food energy)

The following table shows some of the potential risks of energy drinks. Based on the given information, write an analytical paragraph, in about 120 words, assessing the short-term benefits versus common risks of energy drinks.

POTENTIAL RISKS OF ENERGY DRINKS

Recent studies have shown that whilst there are undoubtedly some short-term benefits of energy drinks, over-consumption does present some common risks and symptoms including:

- palpitations
- dizziness
- tremors
- tingling or numbing of skin

- agitation
- insomnia
- gastrointestinal problems
- respiratory distress
- chest pain
- headache

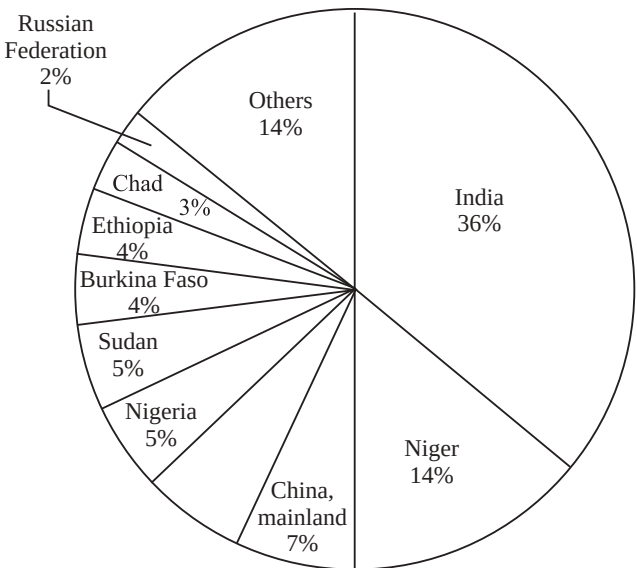
23. Ecotourism means responsible travel to natural areas, that minimises the negative impact on the environment, making it an appealing choice for environmentally conscious travellers.

The table given below lists the pros and cons of Ecotourism. Based on the information provided, write an analytical paragraph, in about 120 words, assessing the pros and cons of Ecotourism.

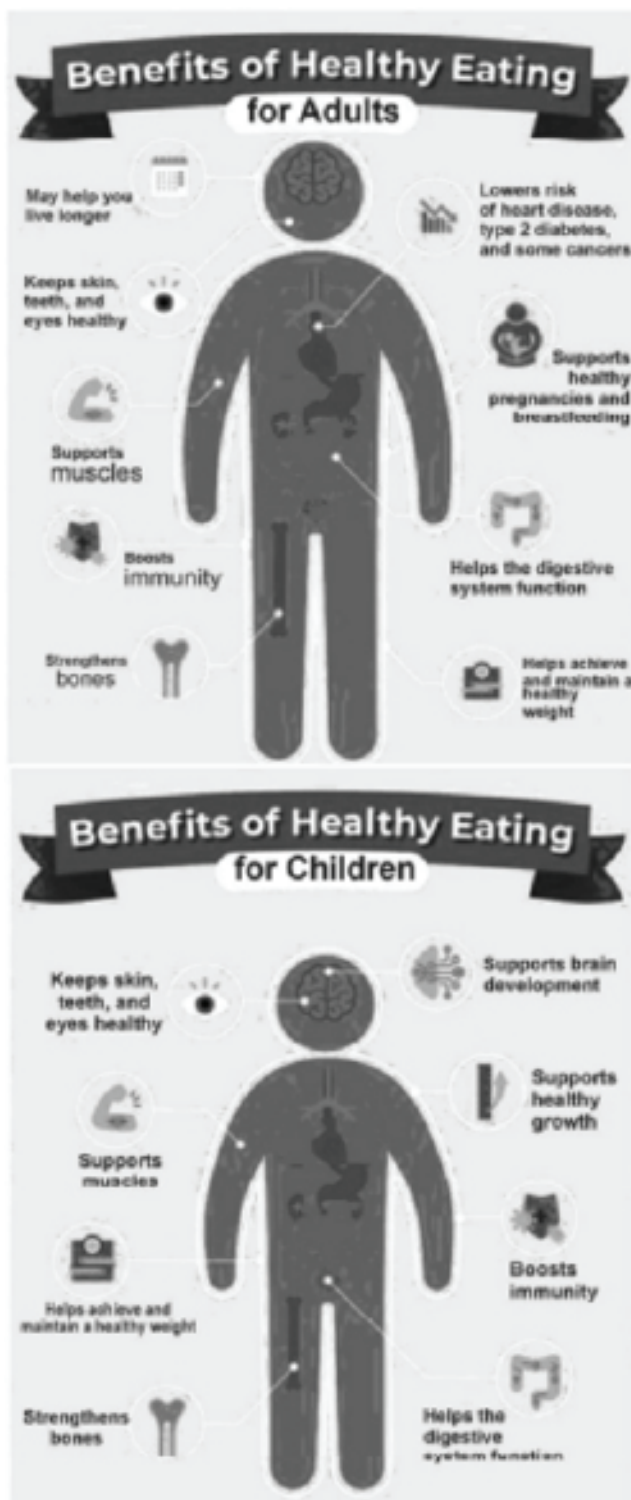
THE ADVANTAGES AND DISADVANTAGES OF ECOTOURISM

Pros	Cons
–promotes conservation	–cultural disruption
–provides economic benefits to local communities	–destruction of natural resources
–fosters environmental awareness	–habitat disturbance

24. The detailed global millets production data from different countries is depicted in the pie chart given below. Analyze this chart and write an analytical paragraph in about 120 words, by selecting features that support your analysis and suggesting possible reasons for the variation in production by different countries.



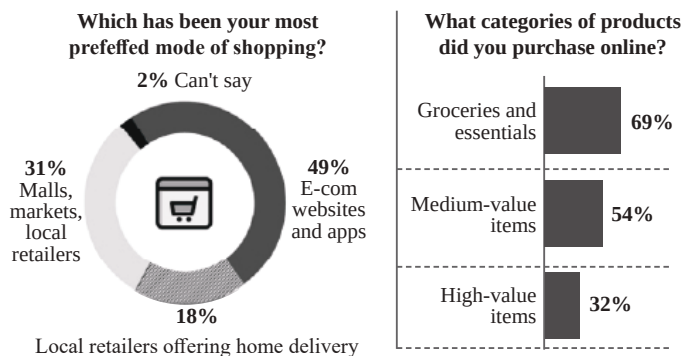
25. There are many benefits of healthy eating for adults as well as children. The following charta reflect the same. Based on the information given in the charts, write an analytical paragraph in about 120 words, assessing the importance of healthy eating for adults as well as children.



26. (a) E-commerce business for shopping picked up manifold during the pandemic year and consumers have continued to shop online. Given below is a chart that depicts the various trends associated with E-commerce shopping. Analyze this chart and write an analytical paragraph in about 120 words, by selecting features that support your analysis.

The proliferation of e-commerce in India

Consumers who took to e-commerce during the pandemic year are continuing to use them, a Local Circles survey shows



27. There are two types of bottles available in the market glass and plastic. Based on the information given in the chart below, write an analytical paragraph, in about 120 words, assessing the pros and cons of using glass and plastic bottles.

Glass vs. Plastic Bottles

Pros and Cons

GLASS BOTTLES

PROS

- Non toxic, no chemicals
- Environmentally friendly
- Easy to clean and sanitize
- Durable, last forever
- Do not absorb odours
- Dishwasher safe

CONS

- Heavy
- More expensive
- Breakable
- Fewer options

PLASTIC BOTTLES

PROS

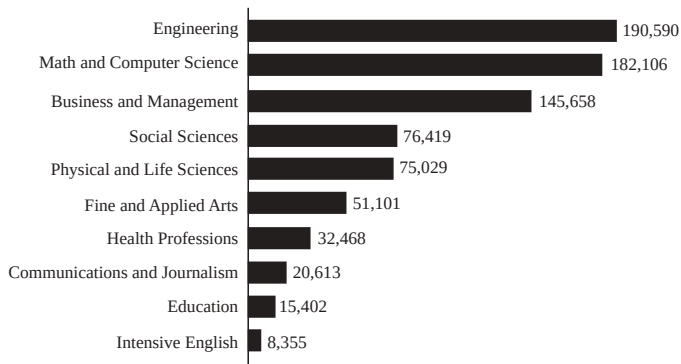
- Easy to use, lightweight
- Unbreakable
- Widely available
- Wide variety of options
- More affordable

CONS

- More chemicals
- Shorter life span
- Harder to clean
- Cannot completely sanitize
- Can absorb odours

28. Many Indian students go abroad for higher studies. The following graph shows the most popular fields of study for Indian students studying abroad in the academic year 2020-21.

Analyze the graph and write an analytical paragraph, in about 120 words, by selecting features that support your analysis.



30. Many out-of-school children are employed in various odd jobs in India. Child labour deprives children of their right to go to school and reinforces intergenerational cycles of poverty. Based on the data given below in the pie chart, write an analytical paragraph, in about 120 words, analyzing the situation and probable reasons that lead children to become a part of the child labour force.





Explanations

CBSE, 2024

1. Life Cycle of Butterfly

- ❑ The process of a caterpillar turning into a butterfly is called metamorphosis.
- ❑ Four stages – egg, caterpillar, pupa, adult butterfly
- ❑ Description of each stage
 - ✦ A butterfly starts its life as an egg. The female butterfly lays eggs on a plant. After few days eggs hatch into larva, commonly known as caterpillar.
 - ✦ Caterpillar feeds on the leaves of the plant on which it was hatched. In this stage, the caterpillar sheds its skin several times and develops a body.
 - ✦ After reaching to its full size, the caterpillar in this stage becomes pupa which is also known as Chrysalis.
 - ✦ The pupa breaks open, eventually emerging as a butterfly.

2. The given table shows the preferences on the hobbies of the students during summer vacations.

The table indicates that the highest number of girls are interested in dancing, i.e. 40% whereas the percentage of boys preferring dancing as a hobby is only 13%. We can clearly see that a smaller number of boys opt for singing i.e. 7%, whereas one-fourth of the girls are interested in singing. The data depicts a significant hike in photography as 35% of the boys prefers it against 5% of the girls. The data shows that the preference of students in Yoga is fairly similar, with 19% percent in boys and 15% in girls. Playing got a slight jump of interest in boys over girls which is 30% and 16%, respectively. If we observe the table carefully, we can see that the preference of boys to Photography is much more as compared to girls.

In a nutshell, we can conclude that the interest of the boys is least in singing as compared to the girls while maximum percentage of the girls choose dancing over boys as their hobby during summer vacations.

3. The chart provided shows the number of gyms opening

and the number of members in the city over the past decade from 2010 to 2022.

From 2010 to 2014, both gyms and membership numbers increased steadily. However, in 2016, a significant jump in gym openings was observed, reaching around 4.5 thousand gyms, and membership numbers peaked as well. 2018 saw the highest number of gym openings (around 5 thousand), but membership showed only a slight increase compared to 2016.

In 2020, the number of gyms dropped sharply to around 2.5 thousand, possibly due to the pandemic, though membership remained stable. By 2022, gym numbers recovered slightly to about 3 thousand, with a corresponding rise in membership.

This data suggests that the city's interest in fitness has remained strong, despite fluctuations in gym openings.

4. The bar graph illustrates the comparative analysis of students' performance in various subjects during the terminal exams for two terms: the first and the second. In the first term, students excelled in Mathematics, achieving the highest average performance of around 90%, while Science and English followed closely, with scores around 80% each. However, in the second term, performance in Mathematics saw a slight decline to approximately 85%.

Interestingly, students demonstrated remarkable improvement in Hindi, with average scores increasing from about 70% in the first term to around 85% in the second term. Conversely, performance in Social Studies remained the lowest across both terms, but there was a marginal improvement from 60% to 65%. This data indicates varying strengths in subjects and highlights the need for targeted interventions in areas where students struggle.

5. The data illustrates the differing preferences of boys and girls in spending their free time. A significant 40% of boys engage in outdoor and indoor games, highlighting their inclination towards physical activities. In contrast, only 20% of girls participate in these sports, suggesting a preference for other leisure activities.

Girls tend to favour watching movies and listening to songs, with 35% indicating this as their choice,

compared to 15% of boys. Additionally, 25% of girls enjoy reading books and comics, surpassing the 12% of boys who share this interest. Notably, both genders equally value social interaction, with 10% of boys and 20% of girls opting to spend their free time talking to friends. This analysis reveals distinct hobbies shaped by gender preferences among teenagers.

6. The prevalence of obesity among school children has become a growing public health concern. A recent study points out that unhealthy eating habits, such as the consumption of food with a high glycaemic index, are significant contributors to this trend. Additionally, reduced physical activity and increased screen time have further exacerbated the problem. Changes in sleep patterns, often due to excessive gadget use, also play a role in the rising obesity levels among children. These factors collectively contribute to an unhealthy lifestyle, leading to weight gain and associated health risks. To address this issue, parents, schools, and policymakers need to promote balanced diets, regular exercise, and healthy screen habits among children for a better future.
7. As the population increases, per capita water advisability has decreased significantly from 5177 m³ in 1951 to a projected 1140 m³ by 2050. This drop is due to higher demand, urbanisation, and inefficient water management. The increasing population puts more pressure on existing water resources, leading to potential water stress and scarcity in the future. Effective water conservation and management strategies are essential to address this issue.
8. Various bottles have distinct advantages and disadvantages. Plastic bottles are lightweight and inexpensive but contribute to environmental pollution. Glass bottles are durable and recyclable but are heavier and more fragile. Metal bottles are durable and eco-friendly but can be costly. Selecting a bottle depends on balancing durability, cost, and environmental impact.
9. The chart provides data on the impact of climate change on various crops, highlighting negative, positive, and mixed effects. Key crops like rice, wheat, maize, and sorghum experience negative effects, possibly due to altered rainfall patterns and temperature shifts that disrupt growth cycles. Groundnut, potato, and gram show mixed reactions, indicating some resilience but also vulnerability to extreme weather events. Positive impacts are observed in crops like coconut and mustard, likely benefiting from changing climates in certain regions.

These patterns suggest that climate change can reduce food availability, complicate access, and affect absorption due to variable crop yields. Factors such as temperature increase, unpredictable rainfall, and rising carbon levels contribute to these varied responses across crops.

10. The data highlights the key reasons students consider dropping out of school. The top reason, at 73%, is students disliking the school environment, which may indicate a failure to engage or support them effectively. Dislike for teachers follows closely at 61%, suggesting that student-teacher relationships greatly affect retention. Additionally, 60% felt their work lacked value, pointing to a need for more relevant and meaningful curriculums.

Family issues (42%) and the need to work for money (35%) reflect external pressures that affect students' ability to continue schooling. Challenges related to the difficulty of work (54%) and bullying (28%) also play significant roles, while a smaller percentage (19%) cited the work being too easy. Addressing these factors is crucial for improving retention rates.

11. The graph illustrates the rising obesity rates in India from 2015-17 to 2019-21. Overweight prevalence has increased across all groups, with men showing a rise from 18.9% to 22.9%, and women from 20.6% to 24%. Children's obesity rates, though lower, have grown from 2.1% to 3.4%, signalling a worrying trend even among younger populations.

The rise in obesity may be attributed to sedentary lifestyles, unhealthy diets, and increased urbanisation. To combat this epidemic, awareness campaigns promoting balanced diets and regular physical activity are crucial. Additionally, policymakers should focus on improving access to nutritious food and creating public spaces for exercise. Implementing these measures can help reduce obesity rates and prevent associated health risks.

12. Based on the data provided, the life expectancy of both men and women has shown a steady increase from 2001 to 2025. In 2001-2005, men had a life expectancy of 63.8 years, which rose to 69.8 years by 2021-2025. Similarly, women's life expectancy increased from 66.1 years to 72.3 years during the same period. Women consistently outlive men, with a noticeable gap that widens over time, from 2.3 years in 2001-2005 to 2.5 years in 2021-2025. This rise in life expectancy can be attributed to improvements in healthcare, better living conditions, and increased



awareness of health-related issues. It also reflects advancements in medical technology and social development.

13. The newspaper excerpt highlights the growing issue of car parking in residential colonies due to an increase in the number of vehicles per family. As a result, road rage incidents have escalated, reflecting rising frustration among residents. Many families report facing multiple problems, such as a lack of designated parking for visitors, which forces residents to park haphazardly. This chaotic situation is further aggravated by commercial vehicles parking near colony gates, blocking exits and creating inconvenience. The surge in vehicles, without a corresponding rise in infrastructure, has led to disorderly parking and heightened tensions. The need for better parking management and urban planning is evident to address this pressing problem efficiently.
14. The data reveals global literacy rates among different age groups and genders. In the 12-15 age group, men have a literacy rate of 88%, while women are slightly lower at 80%. For the 15-24 age group, the rates increase, with men at 90% and women at 88%, showing a narrowing gap between genders. In the 25-64 age group, men maintain an 88% literacy rate, but women's rate drops to 79%. Among those 65 and older, both genders show a decline, with men at 80% and women at 75%. Overall, men exhibit higher literacy rates in all age groups, while women's rates decline more noticeably in older age groups, reflecting historical disparities in educational access.
15. The most important thing in life is often a subject of debate. According to the pie chart, knowledge is considered the most significant, accounting for 48%. It is the foundation for personal and professional success, enabling informed decision-making and problem-solving. Love follows at 20%, as it brings emotional fulfilment and strengthens relationships. Money, comprising 18%, is essential for a comfortable life, providing basic needs and opportunities. Fame and power, though less important, represent 8% and 6% respectively, and can bring influence and recognition. However, the pursuit of these should not overshadow values like empathy and integrity. Ultimately, a balanced approach, prioritising knowledge, love, and the right use of resources, is key to a successful and meaningful life.
16. Plastic waste poses a significant environmental threat due to its non-biodegradable nature. Over time, harmful chemicals from plastics accumulate in the soil, leading to contamination of underground water. This

chemical absorption into the soil and water bodies is a growing concern, especially since there is currently no known technology to remove substances like BPA and other leachates once they have infiltrated these natural resources. The persistence of these pollutants in the environment poses a risk to both ecosystems and human health. Therefore, reducing plastic usage and opting for environmentally friendly alternatives are crucial measures to mitigate this problem. Urgent action is needed to prevent further damage and protect our natural resources for future generations.

17. The data illustrates the percentage of various electronic devices used in India. Mobile phones lead with the highest usage at 96%, highlighting their significance in everyday life. Televisions follow at 86%, indicating widespread consumption of visual media. Kitchen appliances are also commonly used, with 84% of households depending on them for convenience. Refrigerators are used by 69%, emphasising the need for food preservation. Electronic toys account for 40%, showing moderate usage, likely in households with children. Laptops have the lowest percentage at 38%, possibly due to the cost factor and the popularity of mobile devices. Overall, mobile phones dominate the electronic landscape in India, while devices like laptops and electronic toys are comparatively less prevalent.
18. As a responsible citizen, I believe that the increasing trend of online shopping has significant environmental consequences. While it helps save fuel and reduces emissions from individual vehicles, it adds to the overall carbon footprint due to the increased mileage of delivery trucks. Moreover, online shopping generates substantial packaging waste, including cardboard boxes, bubble wraps, and plastic bags. This excess packaging not only contributes to pollution but also strains our waste management systems. To mitigate these effects, we must adopt sustainable practices, such as reducing unnecessary orders, opting for eco-friendly packaging, and supporting companies that prioritise environmental responsibility. For these reasons, I believe we need to limit the wastage associated with online shopping.
19. Co-curricular activities play a crucial role in supplementing the theoretical curriculum by providing students with essential skills and values. They enhance logical and analytical thinking, allowing students to apply classroom knowledge in real-world situations. Activities like debates foster creative and critical thinking, while participation in group projects builds problem-solving and leadership

skills. Co-curricular activities also improve social, emotional, and communication abilities, preparing students for future professional environments. They offer recreational value, helping students maintain a healthy balance between academics and leisure. Additionally, exposure to technology through such activities develops enhanced technological skills. Thus, co-curricular activities contribute significantly to a holistic education, equipping students with the skills needed for success in the 21st century.

20. Tourism plays a significant role in the nation's development, contributing immensely to the economy and society. It enhances GDP and generates foreign exchange, providing a substantial financial boost. Additionally, tourism supports local markets and businesses, leading to the growth of small-scale industries and artisans. It also creates employment opportunities across various sectors, including hospitality, transport, and retail. Moreover, tourism helps preserve culture by promoting local traditions, art, and heritage. Infrastructural development, such as better roads, airports, and public amenities, is also driven by tourism, benefitting both tourists and local residents. Thus, the multifaceted impact of tourism underscores its importance as a key driver of economic growth, cultural preservation, and infrastructural advancement.
21. Here's an analytical paragraph based on the given prompt:
- Libraries play a vital role in meeting societal needs by providing resources that promote learning, cultural engagement, and community well-being. They offer access to reading materials, information, digital resources, and opportunities for cultural and creative expression. Libraries contribute to improving digital access and literacy, empowering individuals to reach their full potential. They also support health and well-being initiatives, fostering happier and healthier lives. Furthermore, libraries enhance cultural and creative engagement, leading to greater prosperity and increased participation in community life. By connecting communities and promoting learning, libraries strengthen community bonds and support the creation of stronger, more resilient societies. Hence, libraries are indispensable institutions that foster personal growth, community cohesion, and overall societal development.
22. Energy drinks are often promoted for their short-term benefits, such as increased alertness, mental focus, and physical stimulation, largely due to their caffeine content. However, their potential risks outweigh these

temporary advantages, particularly when consumed in excess. Studies indicate that over-consumption can lead to serious health issues, including palpitations, chest pain, and gastrointestinal problems. Other common symptoms include dizziness, headaches, and insomnia, which can negatively affect overall well-being. Moreover, prolonged use may result in agitation, respiratory distress, and tingling or numbness of the skin. Given these risks, it is essential to exercise caution when consuming energy drinks and to consider healthier alternatives for sustained energy and mental clarity. Moderation is key to avoiding the harmful side effects associated with these beverages.

23. Ecotourism offers both advantages and disadvantages, making it a subject of debate. On the positive side, ecotourism promotes conservation efforts by encouraging responsible travel to natural areas. It provides economic benefits to local communities, as tourists contribute to the local economy, helping improve living standards. Additionally, ecotourism fosters environmental awareness among travellers, encouraging sustainable behaviour. However, there are drawbacks to consider. Cultural disruption is a common issue, as an influx of tourists can alter the traditions and way of life of indigenous communities. Ecotourism may also lead to the destruction of natural resources and the disturbance of habitats, contradicting its intended goals. Therefore, while ecotourism has the potential for positive impact, careful management is essential to mitigate its negative consequences.
24. The pie chart shows global millet production in 2018, highlighting notable variations among different countries. India leads with 36% of the total production, reflecting its suitable climate, large agricultural areas, and millet's role as a staple crop. Niger follows with 14%, benefiting from favourable semi-arid conditions ideal for millet cultivation. Other significant contributors include China (7%) and Nigeria (6%), where millet is grown as an important food source in arid regions. Countries like Burkina Faso, Ethiopia, and Chad produce 4% each, demonstrating their reliance on millet for food security. The Russian Federation contributes 2%, possibly due to limited suitable growing areas. These variations are influenced by factors like climate, soil conditions, agricultural practices, and the role of millet in local diets.
25. Healthy eating offers numerous benefits for both adults and children. For adults, it helps maintain a healthy weight, boosts immunity, and supports heart health by lowering cholesterol. It also promotes strong bones, reduces the risk of chronic diseases,



and improves overall mental well-being. For children, healthy eating is essential for growth and development, as it strengthens bones, keeps the skin healthy, and boosts immunity. It also supports brain development, providing the necessary nutrients for cognitive growth. Additionally, healthy eating habits in childhood can prevent future health issues and encourage lifelong good habits. Therefore, a balanced diet rich in essential nutrients is crucial for both adults and children, contributing to physical health, mental wellness, and overall quality of life.

26. The chart highlights the growing trend of e-commerce in India, particularly during and after the pandemic year. According to the survey, 49% of consumers now prefer e-commerce websites and apps as their main mode of shopping, showcasing the convenience and accessibility offered by online platforms. Local retailers providing home delivery account for 18%, reflecting their efforts to adapt to changing consumer needs. On the other hand, 31% of shoppers still favour malls and local markets, indicating a partial reliance on traditional shopping experiences. Regarding product categories, groceries and essentials dominate at 69%, followed by medium-value items at 54%, and high-value items at 32%. This suggests that consumers trust online shopping mainly for necessities while being cautious with expensive purchases.
27. Glass and plastic bottles both have distinct advantages and disadvantages. Glass bottles are non-toxic, environmentally friendly, and easy to clean, making them a healthier option. They are also durable and dishwasher safe, which adds to their practicality. However, glass bottles are heavier, more expensive, and prone to breakage, which can limit their usage. On the other hand, plastic bottles are lightweight, unbreakable, and more affordable, making them a convenient choice. They are widely available in various options but come with drawbacks, such as containing more chemicals and being harder to clean. Plastic bottles have a shorter lifespan, and they can absorb odours, reducing their appeal. Ultimately, the choice between glass and plastic bottles depends on the user's priorities, such as health, convenience, or sustainability.
28. The graph illustrates the most popular fields of study for Indian students studying abroad in the academic year 2020–21. Engineering tops the list with 190,590 students, highlighting its continued preference for many aspiring professionals. Math and Computer Science follow closely with 182,106 students, reflecting the increasing demand for technology-

based skills. Business and Management is also a popular choice, with 145,658 students, indicating its global career prospects. Social Sciences and Physical and Life Sciences attract 76,419 and 75,029 students, respectively, showing moderate interest in diverse disciplines. Fields like Health Professions (32,468) and Communications and Journalism (20,613) have fewer students, while Intensive English is the least popular. These trends suggest a strong focus on technical and business education among Indian students pursuing international studies.

30. The pie chart shows the different types of work in which out-of-school children are engaged as part of child labour in India. The largest segment, 46%, is involved in bottle collection, likely due to its low skill requirement and easy accessibility. Shoes polishing accounts for 20%, followed by car washing at 12%, indicating the types of informal jobs available to children. Cleaning and selling wood collection each represent 7%, while dishwashing and begging account for 4% and 1%, respectively. Poverty, lack of access to education, and familial responsibilities are major factors driving children into these labour-intensive jobs. Addressing child labour requires improving access to education and providing financial support to vulnerable families to break the cycle of poverty and exploitation.

Section-C

- **First Flight**
 - ✦ **Prose**
 - ✦ **Poems**
- **Footprints Without Feet**

Prose

1

CHAPTER

A Letter to God

Author: G.L. Fuentes



Previous Year Questions

CBSE, 2024

1. Grief or sadness is an emotion natural to all types of loss or significant change. You have been asked to present an analysis of the approaches of Lencho and Kisa Gotami in dealing with their respective losses. Write this presentation draft including your insights, and comparing the approaches of both.

You may begin like this: One acknowledges that Lencho had unwavering faith in God whereas Kisa Gotami in her grief, believed that her son _____ however _____.

(Reference - A Letter to God and The Sermon at Benares)

2. What idea does the Postmaster come up with? What did he do to stick to his resolution? (A Letter to God) (Answer in 40-50 words each)
3. Explain the irony in the chapter, A Letter to God. (Answer in 40-50 words each)

CBSE, 2023

1. Why did the night after the rains turn sorrowful for Lencho?
2. The postmaster had mixed emotions while opening the letter. Explain.

CBSE, 2022

Read the passage given below and answer the questions that follow:

All through the night, Lencho thought only of his one hope: the help of God, whose eyes, as he had been instructed, see everything, even what is deep in one's conscience. Lencho was an ox of a man, working like an animal in the fields, but still he knew how to write. The following Sunday, at daybreak, he began to write a letter which he himself

would carry to town and place in the mail. It was nothing less than a letter to God.

1. Study the following statements:
 - (1) Lencho decided to write a letter to God
 - (2) All through the night he thought of his only one hope. Choose the correct option:
 - (a) (1) is the cause and (2) is the effect.
 - (b) (2) is the cause of (1).
 - (c) (2) preceded (1).
 - (d) Both (1) and (2) happened at the same time.
2. 'Lencho was an ox of a man means:
 - (a) He was very hard-working.
 - (b) He owned an ox.
 - (c) He ploughed his field with an ox.
 - (d) His ox could work like a man.
3. 'But still he knew how to write' implies that:
 - (a) Lencho could write as he was a farmer.
 - (b) Ordinarily, a farmer did not know how to write.
 - (c) All farmers knew how to write.
 - (d) A farmer cannot know how to write.
4. Why did he write the letter on Sunday?
 - (a) Sunday is a holy day for the Christians.
 - (b) God listens to people only on Sunday.
 - (c) Lencho was busy rest of the week.
 - (d) The Post office would open on Monday.
5. Find a suitable word from the passage to complete the following: Loss: Gain :: Despair: _____
 - (a) Help
 - (b) Hope
 - (c) Deep
 - (d) Carry

Read the extract given below and answer the questions / complete the statements that follow:

The moment the letter fell into the mailbox the postmaster went to open it. It said: "God of the money that I asked for, only seventy pesos reached me. Send me the rest, since I need it very much. But don't send it to me through the mail because the post office employees are a bunch of crooks. Lencho."

1. Lencho wrote the second letter as he was:
 - (1) unhappy
 - (2) curious
 - (3) hopeful
 - (4) thoughtful
 - (5) confident

(a) (1), (3) and (5) (b) (1), (2) and (3)
 (c) (2), (5) and (1) (d) (3), (4) and (5)
2. The postmaster opened the letter expecting it to:
 - (1) be full of thanks to God
 - (2) show his happiness

- (3) be full of anguish for getting less money
- (4) be accusing God of being miserly

- (a) (3) and (4) (b) (1) and (2)
 (c) (1) and (4) (d) (4) and (2)

3. On reading the letter the postmaster was
 - (a) surprised (b) dismayed
 - (c) pleased (d) puzzled
4. 'the post office employees are a bunch of crooks'
 The statement is:
 - (a) thoughtful (b) sad
 - (c) dismissive (d) ironic
5. Find the suitable word from the extract to complete the following:
 sanctioned: approved:: demanded:
 (a) fell (b) reached
 (c) went (d) asked

4. Did the letter reach to God? Why did the postmaster send a reply to Lencho?



Explanations

CBSE, 2024

1. One acknowledges that Lencho had unwavering faith in God, whereas Kisa Gotami, in her grief, believed that her son could be brought back to life if she found a mustard seed from a house untouched by death. Lencho's faith led him to write a letter to God, asking for help after his crops were destroyed. He trusted that God would provide for his loss.

However, Kisa Gotami, devastated by her son's death, went on a quest that ultimately taught her the inevitability of death and the importance of accepting it. While Lencho's approach was rooted in faith and hope, Kisa Gotami's journey led her to enlightenment and acceptance of life's impermanence.

Both approaches highlight different paths to coping with loss: one through faith and the other through understanding and acceptance.

2. The Postmaster comes up with the idea to answer Lencho's letter to God in order to maintain Lencho's faith. To stick to his resolution, the Postmaster gathers money from his employees, contributes part of his own salary, and persuades several friends to donate as well, pooling together what they can. Despite not being able to gather the full amount Lencho requested, the Postmaster sends Lencho a little more than half of it in an envelope, accompanied by a letter signed with the single word "God". This act reflects the Postmaster's attempt to uphold Lencho's belief in divine assistance, even though the response falls short of Lencho's expectations.
3. The irony in "A Letter to God" lies in Lencho's unwavering faith in God contrasted with the practical response of the postmaster and the outcome of his letter. Lencho, believing in God's direct intervention, writes a letter asking for financial help after a hailstorm destroys his crops. The letter reaches the postmaster, who, moved by Lencho's faith, collects money from himself and others to help. However, when Lencho receives

the money and finds it insufficient, he accuses the postal workers of dishonesty, showing a lack of faith in their good intentions despite his initial trust in God's intervention.

CBSE, 2023

1. The night after the rains turned sorrowful for Lencho because a devastating hailstorm destroyed his entire crop. Initially, he was happy to see the rain as it was beneficial for his fields, but soon the hailstones began to fall, completely ruining his harvest. This loss left him and his family in despair, as they depended entirely on the crops for their livelihood.
2. The postmaster had mixed emotions while opening Lencho's second letter. Initially, he was curious and hopeful, expecting Lencho to express gratitude for the money he had received. However, upon reading the letter, he was surprised and dismayed to find that Lencho accused the post office employees of stealing part of the money. Despite this accusation, the postmaster may have also felt some amusement and admiration for Lencho's unwavering faith in God.

CBSE, 2022

1. (b) (ii) is the cause of (i).
2. (a) He was very hard-working.
3. (b) Ordinarily, a farmer did not know how to write.
4. (a) Sunday is a holy day for the Christians.
5. (b) Hope

CBSE, 2021

1. (a) (A), (C), and (E) → Unhappy, Hopeful, and Confident
2. (a) (C) and (D) → Be full of anguish for getting less money & Be accusing God of being miserly
3. (a) Surprised
4. (d) Ironic
5. (d) Asked

1. No, the letter did not reach God and it was naive on Lencho's part to think of addressing a letter in the name of God.

The postmaster however was a sympathetic man who was amazed by Lencho's faith in God. He didn't want Lencho's faith to be broken, hence he decided to send a reply to Lencho along with a partial amount to help him with his situation. He also signed the letter-God to keep Lencho's faith intact.

2

CHAPTER

Nelson Mandela: Long Walk to Freedom

Author: Nelson Mandela



Previous Year Questions

CBSE, 2024

1. Nelson Mandela in his inauguration speech says, "We, who were outlaws not so long ago, have today been given the rare privilege to be host to the nations of the world on our own soil."

What is the significance of this statement with reference to the political system that prevailed before this? (Nelson Mandela - Long Walk to Freedom) (Answer in 40-50 words each)

2. Read the following extracts and answer the questions:

We have, at last, achieved our political emancipation. We pledge ourselves to liberate all our people from the continuing bondage of poverty, deprivation, suffering, gender and other discrimination.

Never, never, and never again shall it be that this beautiful land will again experience the oppression of one by another.

The sun shall never set on so glorious a human achievement.

Let freedom reign. God bless Africa!

(Nelson Mandela - Long Walk to Freedom)

- (i) State any one inference about Nelson Mandela from the given context:

"We have, at last, achieved our political emancipation."

- (ii) State True or False:

When Mandela says, "God bless Africa", he intends to mean well-being and welfare of only black people in South Africa.

- (iii) Nelson Mandela's speech is full of optimism." Elaborate in about 40 words with reference to the extract.

- (iv) Which phrase would correctly substitute 'so glorious', in the given sentence from the extract. "The sun shall never set on so glorious a human achievement."

3. Read the following extracts and answer the questions for any ONE of the given two.

- (a) Tenth May dawned bright and clear. For the past few days, I had been pleasantly besieged by dignitaries and world leaders who were coming to pay their respects before the inauguration. The inauguration would be the largest gathering ever of international leaders on South African soil. The ceremonies took place in the lovely sandstone amphitheatre formed by the Union buildings in Pretoria. For decades this had been the seat of white supremacy, and now it was the site of rainbow gathering of different colours and nations for the installation of South Africa's first democratic non- racial government. (Nelson Mandela - Long Walk to Freedom)

- (i) What do you infer from the following statement? "The inauguration would be the largest gathering ever of international leaders on South African Soil."

- (ii) Explain in about 40 words the effective shift from white supremacy to a rainbow gathering.

- (iii) Which phrase would correctly substitute 'pleasantly besieged' in the given sentence from that extract?

- (iv) State true or false with reference to the given extract.

In the past the amphitheatre' had been a seat for theatrical performances.

CBSE, 2023

1. Mandela said, "People must learn to hate, and if they can learn to hate, they can be taught to love." Discuss.

2. 'No one is born hating another person because of the colour of his skin, or his background or his religion. Do you agree? Elaborate on the basis of the chapter "Nelson Mandela - Long Walk to Freedom".

CBSE, 2021

1. Mandela refers to liberty as "newborn" because it:
- (a) was dependent on others for growth and guidance.
 - (b) had recently been attained with lots of struggle.

- (c) made people experience infant-like excitement.
- (d) arrived unexpectedly for everyone.

2. Who, according to Nelson Mandela, is a courageous man?

CBSE, 2020

1. What did Nelson Mandela remember on the day of the inaugural ceremony? **(CBSE, 2020, Set 4)**



Explanations

CBSE, 2024

1. Nelson Mandela's statement highlights the profound shift from apartheid, where non-white South Africans faced systemic discrimination and were denied basic rights. By hosting global leaders at his inauguration, Mandela symbolizes the end of white minority rule and the beginning of inclusive governance. This event signifies a new era of equality and recognition for all South Africans, regardless of race, marking a historic departure from the oppressive political system of apartheid.
2. (i) One inference about Nelson Mandela from the given context is that he was committed to achieving political freedom for all people in South Africa, not just for a specific group or community.
(ii) False
(iii) Nelson Mandela's speech exudes optimism as he celebrates achieving political emancipation for South Africa. He expresses confidence that the country will overcome past oppressions, emphasizing the dawn of a new era free from discrimination and suffering.
(iv) "The sun shall never set on such a glorious human achievement."
3. Read the following extracts and answer the questions for any ONE of the given two.
(a)(i) This statement suggests that the inauguration event for South Africa's first democratic non-racial government was historically significant and attracted the highest number of international leaders ever seen in South Africa. It indicates the global importance and attention drawn to the transition from apartheid to democracy in South Africa.
(ii) The shift from "seat of white supremacy" to a "rainbow gathering" symbolizes a profound transformation. Formerly a symbol of racial segregation, the Union buildings in Pretoria became a site where leaders of diverse nationalities and races assembled to celebrate the installation of South Africa's first democratic and non-racial government, marking a new era of inclusivity and equality.

(iii) The alternative phrase that could substitute 'pleasantly besieged' in the given sentence is 'happily overwhelmed'.

(iv) False

CBSE, 2023

1. Nelson Mandela's statement highlights the idea that hatred is not natural but is taught by society. People are not born with prejudice; rather, they develop biases through upbringing, environment, and societal influences. Since hatred is learned, it can also be unlearned, and love and compassion can be instilled in people through education and positive experiences.

Mandela's life serves as a powerful example of this belief. Despite suffering under apartheid for decades, he chose reconciliation over revenge. Instead of promoting hatred against his oppressors, he encouraged peace, forgiveness, and unity. His leadership in ending apartheid and fostering democracy in South Africa proved that love can be a guiding force in overcoming deep divisions.

By teaching people to respect and accept one another, societies can eliminate discrimination and create a more just world. Mandela's vision serves as a reminder that love and tolerance can be cultivated to replace hatred and division.

2. Yes, I completely agree with this statement. In "Nelson Mandela - Long Walk to Freedom," Mandela expresses that hatred is not innate but is ingrained by society. From birth, no child discriminates against another based on race, religion, or background. However, societal structures and teachings shape people's beliefs and attitudes, sometimes leading to prejudice and division.

Mandela himself experienced the effects of institutionalized racism under apartheid. The oppressive system created divisions among people based on skin color. However, he believed that just as hatred is learned, people can also be taught love, acceptance, and unity.

Despite being imprisoned for 27 years, Mandela did not harbor hatred for his oppressors. Instead, he advocated for peace and reconciliation, proving that understanding and compassion can be cultivated. His leadership in abolishing apartheid and building a democratic South Africa was a testament to the power of forgiveness and the belief that people can learn to coexist harmoniously.

By embracing Mandela's vision, societies can work towards eliminating discrimination and ensuring equality for all, proving that love is stronger than hate.

CBSE, 2021

1. (b) had recently been attained with lots of struggle.
2. According to Nelson Mandela, a courageous man is not one who is fearless, but one who overcomes his fear. He believed that true courage is demonstrated

when a person faces challenges and hardships with determination, despite being afraid. Mandela himself experienced fear during his struggle against apartheid but chose to stand firm for justice and equality.

CBSE, 2020

1. On the day of the inaugural ceremony, Mandela remembered the history of his nation, the birth of apartheid, its effect on his people and the long fight for freedom.

He remembered the first decade when the whites ruled over South Africa and how they discriminated against the blacks. They behaved cruelly and inhumanly. They treated blacks like slaves. He also remembered the freedom fighters who sacrificed their lives for freedom.

3

CHAPTER

Two Stories about Flying

I. **His First Flight** — Author: *Liam O'Flaherty*

II. **Black Aeroplane** — Author: *Frederick Forsyth*



Previous Year Questions

CBSE, 2024

1. Flying is a natural act in birds. Then why was the young seagull exhausted by the strange exercise? Justify the given statement with reference to baby seagulls fear. (His First Flight) (Answer in 40-50 words each)
2. Briefly bring out the contrast between the young seagulls initial attempts to fly and his first successful flight. (His First Flight) (Answer in 40-50 words each)

CBSE, 2023

1. "I'll take the risk." What is the risk? Why does the narrator take it?
2. The young seagull was afraid to fly because he feared that his wings would not support him. His family tried to encourage him, but he refused to take the leap. Eventually, hunger forced him to act when he saw

his mother holding a fish. As she came near, he dived towards the food but found himself in the air. His fear turned into excitement, and he started flapping his wings, realizing that he could fly. He soared joyfully, experiencing the thrill of flying for the first time.

3. Validate the given statement with reference to baby seagull's fear. 'Fear doesn't exist anywhere else other than one's mind.'

CBSE, 2022

1. The purpose of the treatment, given to the young seagull by his parents, was to _____
 - (a) teach him a lesson about the importance of food.
 - (b) inculcate obedience towards them.
 - (c) let him overcome his fear.
 - (d) improve his relationship with his siblings.



Explanations

CBSE, 2024

1. Flying is natural for birds, yet the young seagull struggled initially due to fear. Fear held him back from attempting flight like his siblings. When he finally overcame this fear and took flight, he became exhausted from the unfamiliar exertion, compounded by hunger. This shows fear can hinder even innate abilities until courage is found.
2. Initially, the young seagull hesitates and fears flying, feeling too scared to take off from his ledge. He watches others soar effortlessly while he stays grounded due to fear. However, driven by hunger, he eventually leaps into flight, initially terrified but soon experiencing the exhilaration of flying freely with confidence and joy.

CBSE, 2023

1. The risk refers to the narrator deciding to fly his old Dakota plane through a storm instead of turning back. He takes this risk because he is eager to reach home and have a good English breakfast. However, he soon realizes that he is in danger as his compass and

radio stop working. Fortunately, a mysterious black aeroplane appears and guides him safely to an airport, but when he looks for it later, it is nowhere to be seen.

2. Describe the young seagull's first flight.
3. The statement **"Fear doesn't exist anywhere else other than one's mind"** is validated by the young seagull's experience in ***His First Flight***.

The baby seagull was physically capable of flying, just like his siblings, but he was held back by fear. His mind convinced him that his wings would not support him, making him hesitant to take the first step. Despite encouragement from his family, he remained paralyzed by self-doubt.

However, when hunger pushed him to act, he instinctively took flight and realized that his fear was baseless. This proves that fear is often a mental barrier rather than a real limitation. Once he overcame it, he felt joy and confidence, soaring effortlessly in the sky. Thus, the story reinforces that fear exists only in one's mind and can be conquered with courage.

CBSE, 2022

1. (c) let him overcome his fear.



Previous Year Questions

CBSE, 2024

1. You have been asked to present an evaluation of the approaches of both, the Baby Seagull and the Pilot who was lost in the clouds, towards achieving their dreams of conquering the skies.

Write this presentation draft including your insights, comparing the approaches of both.

You may begin this way: One acknowledges that both, the Seagull and the Pilot, wanted to _____ however, _____ (Reference: Two Stories About Flying)

2. Motivation plays an important role in taking risks in life and in succeeding. Do you agree? Discuss with reference to the pilot of the old Dakota and the young seagull.

CBSE, 2020

4. Why and when did the narrator say that 'everything' was going well, it was an easy flight? (CBSE, 2020)



Explanations

CBSE, 2024

1. One acknowledges that both the Baby Seagull and the Pilot wanted to conquer the skies, aspiring to fly freely and achieve their dreams. However, their approaches differed significantly. The Baby Seagull, from "Jonathan Livingston Seagull," pursued his dream through relentless practice and a quest for perfection in flight, driven by a passion to explore beyond the ordinary.

In contrast, the Pilot, from "The Little Prince," initially sought to conquer the skies for recognition and status. However, his journey through encounters with the Little Prince taught him the deeper meanings of love, friendship, and responsibility, ultimately leading him to rediscover the joy and wonder of flying.

Both stories illustrate that while the goal of flight is universal, the paths taken and the lessons learned along the way shape one's understanding of true fulfillment and purpose in life.

2. Yes, I agree that motivation is crucial for taking risks and achieving success in life. In "The Black Aeroplane," the pilot's strong desire to return home motivates him to fly through a dangerous storm despite losing vital navigation tools. His determination leads him to trust a mysterious guide, eventually landing safely. Similarly, in "His First Flight," the young seagull's motivation shifts from fear to hunger, compelling him

to overcome his fear of flying. With encouragement from family and instinct driving him, he takes his first flight successfully. Both stories demonstrate that motivation, whether driven by necessity, desire, or courage, can empower individuals to face risks and achieve their goals, underscoring the importance of inner drive in overcoming challenges and achieving success.

CBSE, 2020

4. The story 'Black Aeroplane' is about a pilot who feels happy and content to fly over a city at night. He is flying from Paris to London. He is looking forward to enjoying his holiday with his family. As soon as he crosses Paris, he gets a look at dark clouds indicating an upcoming storm.

But still, his desire to reach his family and have a delicious breakfast with them made him risk his and his passenger's life. Then the pilot thought of informing the Paris Control Personnel about its presence and for instructions.

After receiving the instructions, the pilot geared up and followed them while putting the last fuel tank into operation. He was calm as everything was going as planned. So, he says that 'Everything' was going well; it was an easy flight. – Postmaster raises money and sends it to him. – He asks for help – the source of his aid is clearly revealed – not satisfied.

4

CHAPTER

From the Diary of Anne Frank

Author: Anne Frank



Previous Year Questions

CBSE, 2024

1. You have been chosen to address the school assembly on the occasion of Women's Day. You choose to speak on the resilience and indomitable spirit of the young girls : Best online courses

Anne Frank and Valli. Prepare the speech draft, with reference to the commonality and contrast in the situations and circumstances of both the girls.

(Madam Rides the Bus and From the Diary of Anne Frank)

You may begin like this: Good morning everyone. Today, I'd like to express my insights on the resilience of two young girls.....

You may end this way: To conclude I'd like to say that.....

Thank you.

2. Read the following extracts and answer the questions.

Anyone could ramble on and leave big spaces between the words, but the trick was to come up with convincing arguments to prove the necessity of talking. I thought and suddenly I had an idea. I wrote the three pages, Mr. Keesing had assigned me and was satisfied. I argued that talking is a students' trait and that I would do my best to keep it under control, but that I would never be able to cure myself of the habit since my mother talked as much as I did if not more, and that there's not much you can do about inherited traits. (From the Diary of Annie Frank)

- (i) State any one inference about Anne from the given context.

"Anyone could ramble on and leave big spaces

between the words, but the trick was to come up with convincing arguments to prove the necessity of talking."

- (ii) In about 40 words, elaborate on the justification Anne gives for her talkative nature.
- (iii) Which one of the following best describes the tone of the given extract?
- (a) derogatory (b) persuasive
(c) nostalgic (d) cautionary
- (iv) Which phrase would correctly substitute ramble on' in the given sentence from the extract?

CBSE, 2023

Read the following extract and answer the questions that follow:

I wrote the three pages Mr. Keesing had assigned me and was satisfied. I argued that talking is a student's trait and that I would do my best to keep it under control, but that I would never be able to cure myself of the habit since my mother talked as much as I did, if not more, and that there's not much one can do about inherited traits.

1. Who was Mr. Keesing?
- (a) English teacher
(b) Social Science teacher
(c) Warden
(d) Principal
2. According to the extract, the incorrigible habit possessed by the speaker was
- (1) making noise in class
(2) talking too much
(3) procrastinating
(4) coming late to class
(5) asking irritating questions
- Select the correct option:

- (a) 1 and 3 (b) Only 2
(c) 1, 4 and 5 (d) Only 3
3. Complete the analogy by electing the suitable word from the extract routine: habit:: characteristic: _____
4. Select the reason why the narrator is unable to control her trait.
- (a) She had deliberately practised it
(b) She wanted to be different from her brother.
(c) Her teacher had encouraged her to continue as she was.
(d) She had inherited it.
5. Which of the following most nearly means the opposite of the phrase 'under control'?
- (a) to spend less
(b) unable to take on the challenge
(c) find it difficult to manage

(d) being very stubborn

CBSE, 2022

1. This is why I started the diary". Anne started her diary
- (a) as she could not confide in any one.
(b) as she was good at writing compositions.
(c) as she wanted to record her feelings for future generations.
(d) as she was secretive by nature.
2. Anne decided to let only _____ to read her diary.
- (a) a real friend (b) her father
(c) her grandmother (d) her mother

CBSE, 2021

1. Anne writes that it was fortunate that Mr. Keesing took the joke the right way. Why does she feel so?



Explanations

CBSE, 2024

1. Good morning everyone,

Today, I'd like to express my insights on the resilience of two young girls, Anne Frank and Valli. Both displayed incredible courage and determination despite facing very different circumstances.

Anne Frank, a Jewish girl during World War II, showed remarkable strength while hiding from the Nazis. Through her diary, she expressed her hopes and fears, inspiring millions with her indomitable spirit.

Valli, from the story "Madam Rides the Bus," was a young girl with a strong desire to explore the world. Despite her limited means, she saved money and faced challenges to fulfill her dream of riding a bus and seeing the world beyond her village.

While Anne faced the horrors of war, Valli tackled the challenges of her everyday life. Both girls, however, shared a common trait: resilience. They demonstrated that no matter the situation, determination and courage can help us overcome difficulties.

To conclude, I'd like to say that Anne Frank and Valli teach us that resilience and a strong spirit can guide us through even the toughest times. Their stories inspire us to be brave and never give up on our dreams.

Thank you.

2.

- (i) From the context, it can be inferred that Anne

Frank is articulate and understands the importance of making coherent arguments rather than simply filling space with words. She values communication but recognizes the need for meaningful discourse.

- (ii) Anne justifies her talkative nature by arguing that talking is a trait she inherited from her mother. She acknowledges that while she will try to control it, she cannot completely eliminate it. This justification highlights her self-awareness and acceptance of her inherited traits.
- (iii) (b) persuasive
- (iv) The alternative phrase that could substitute 'ramble on' in the given sentence is 'talk aimlessly'.

CBSE, 2023

1. (a) English teacher
2. (b) Only II (talking too much)
3. trait
4. (d) She had inherited it.
5. (c) find it difficult to manage

CBSE, 2022

1. (a) as she could not confide in anyone.
2. (a) a real friend.

CBSE, 2021

1. Anne felt fortunate that Mr. Keesing took the joke the right way because instead of punishing her for talking too much, he appreciated her humorous take on the essays he assigned as punishment. His reaction showed that he had a sense of humor and could laugh at himself, making the classroom atmosphere more lighthearted rather than strict and intimidating.

5

CHAPTER

Glimpses of India

- I. A Baker from Goa — Author: Lucio Rodrigues
II. Coorg — Author: Lokesh Abrol
III. Tea from Assam — Author: Arup Kumar Datta



Previous Year Questions

Part-I: A Baker from Goa

CBSE, 2024

Glimpses of India – Bakers from Goa

1. The author says - During our childhood in Goa, the baker used to be our friend, companion and guide. Elaborate. (Glimpses of India) (Answer in 40-50 words each)
2. Why does the author say that the presence of the Bakers furnace in the village is absolutely essential? Justify with reference to A Baker from Goa. (Answer in 40-50 words each)
3. The baker and his family never starved. Elaborate. (Glimpses of India) (Answer in 40-50 words each)
4. During our childhood in Goa, the baker used to be our friend, companion and guide. What does this statement imply in relation to the character of the baker? (Glimpses of India) (Answer in 40-50 words each)

each)

5. How is the Goan baker still an important part of the life of a Goan village?

CBSE, 2023

1. A Baker from Goa' is a nostalgic saga of childhood memories. Comment.
2. Who are paders and why are they friends of children?

CBSE, 2022

1. How did the baker become synonymous with celebrations and occasions in Goa?
2. Why is Coorg called the land of the rolling hills?
3. What attracts visitors to Coorg?

CBSE, 2021

1. In Coorg, which is the season of joy? Why?



Explanations

CBSE, 2024

Glimpses of India – Bakers from Goa

1. During the author's childhood in Goa, the baker was more than just a bread-seller. He was seen as a friendly figure who visited twice daily, bringing joy with the sound of his bamboo staff. Children eagerly awaited him, not just for bread, but also for the special bond they shared, making him a cherished friend and guide in their daily lives.
2. The author says the presence of the baker's furnace in the village is essential because it provides bread and other baked goods that are integral to daily life and celebrations in Goa. The baker, known as pader, delivers fresh bread daily, including special items like bolinhas for Christmas and sandwiches for celebrations. This tradition not only fulfills practical needs but also holds cultural significance, making the baker a vital part of village life, ensuring that important occasions and daily routines are properly observed with freshly baked goods.
3. The baker and his family always had enough to eat because baking bread was a profitable profession in the old days. They were prosperous, evidenced by their plump physique. Even their servants were well-fed, reflecting the economic stability and importance of the baker in the village community.
4. This statement implies that the baker played a significant role in the lives of children in Goa. He was not just a bread-seller but someone who was friendly, supportive, and perhaps even influential in their upbringing, symbolizing a close and trusted figure in the community.
5. The Goan baker remains crucial in village life by providing essential bread and treats like bolinhas and cakes for celebrations. Their traditional methods and familiar presence symbolize continuity and community. They embody cultural heritage and ensure that important occasions, from daily meals to festivals, are complete with their baked goods, maintaining their integral role in Goan village life.

CBSE, 2023

1. 'A Baker from Goa' evokes nostalgia as it reminisces about the Portuguese influence on Goan culture, particularly the tradition of bread-making. The author fondly recalls childhood memories of bakers, their unique dress, and the jingling sound of their bamboo. The arrival of the baker was a joyful event, symbolizing festivity and daily delight, making it an integral part of Goan life.
2. 'Paders' are traditional Goan bakers who continue the age-old practice of baking bread. They are considered friends of children because they bring freshly baked bread, often offering kids sweet buns and biscuits. Their arrival is eagerly awaited, and their presence is associated with joy and delicious treats.

CBSE, 2022

1. The baker became synonymous with celebrations and occasions in Goa because bread was an essential part of every festival, marriage, and special event. Traditional Goan feasts and daily meals included bread, making bakers an integral part of Goan culture and life.
2. Coorg is called the "land of the rolling hills" because of its undulating landscape, covered with lush green hills and coffee plantations. The Western Ghats surrounding Coorg are full of mist-covered peaks, giving the region a picturesque, rolling appearance.
3. Visitors are attracted to Coorg for its natural beauty, coffee plantations, misty hills, adventurous activities (like trekking and river rafting), rich wildlife, and unique Kodava culture. The peaceful environment and scenic landscapes make it a popular tourist destination.

CBSE, 2021

1. The season of joy in Coorg is from **September to March**. During this period, the weather is pleasant, with mild temperatures and a refreshing atmosphere. The natural beauty of Coorg is at its peak, making it an ideal time for outdoor activities like trekking, bird-watching, and river rafting. The lush greenery, coffee plantations, and mist-covered hills add to the charm, making it a joyful season for visitors.

Part-II: Coorg



Previous Year Questions

CBSE, 2024

Glimpses of India – Coorg

1. Coorg has been defined as a piece of heaven by the writer. Justify. (Glimpses of India) (Answer in 40-50 words each) [3m]
2. The most laid back individuals become converts to

the life of high-energy adventure. Elaborate with reference to Coorg. (Glimpses of India) (Answer in 40-50 words each)

CBSE, 2020

2. Why is Coorg called the land of rolling hills?
(CBSE, 2020)



Explanations

CBSE, 2024

Glimpses of India – Coorg

1. Coorg is likened to heaven by the writer due to its picturesque landscapes, serene coffee plantations, and the blend of tranquil beauty with thrilling adventure activities like trekking and river rafting. Its natural charm and peaceful atmosphere make it a paradise for visitors.
2. In Coorg, known for its serene landscapes and coffee plantations, even the most laid-back individuals find themselves drawn into a life of high-energy adventure. Activities like trekking through dense forests, river

rafting in wild waters, and exploring rugged terrains offer thrilling experiences amidst the region's tranquil beauty, transforming leisurely tourists into avid adventurers.

CBSE, 2020

2. Coorg is called the land of rolling hills because it has a lot of hills; the city is situated on sloping hills. Brahmagiri hills have a panoramic view. Coorg is a coffee-growing region in Karnataka. It is midway between Mysore and Mangalore.

This country's jungles and spices are well-known. Coorg is nicknamed the "Land of Rolling Hills" because the city is constructed on gradually sloping hills.

Part-III: Tea From Assam



Previous Year Questions

CBSE, 2024

Glimpses of India - Tea from Assam

1. Read the given extracts and answer the questions:

The train pulled out of the station - Pranjol buried his nose in his detective book again. Rajvir too was an ardent fan of detective stories but, at the moment he was keener on looking at the beautiful scenery. It was green, green everywhere. Rajvir had never seen so much greenery before. Then the soft green paddy fields gave way to tea bushes. It was a magnificent view. Against the backdrop of densely wooded hills a sea of tea bushes stretched as far as the eye could see. Dwarfing the tiny tea plants were tall, sturdy, shade-trees and amidst the orderly rows of bushes busily moved doll-like figures. (Glimpses of India - Tea from Assam)

- (i) State any one inference about Rajvir from the given context:

"Rajvir too was an ardent fan of detective stories, but at the moment he was keen on looking at the beautiful scenery."

- (ii) State True or False:

The reason Rajvir was interested in looking at the beautiful scenery was that the detective book he was reading, was not interesting.

- (iii) People who live in big cities are always fascinated by the natural beauty and abundant greenery. Elaborate in about 40 words, with reference to the extract.

- (iv) Which phrase would correctly substitute 'doll-like figures', in the given sentence from the extract?

"Dwarfing the tiny tea plants were tall sturdy shade-trees and amidst the orderly rows of bushes busily moved doll-like figures."



Explanations

CBSE, 2024

Glimpses of India - Tea from Assam

1.

- (i) One inference about Rajvir from the given context is that he has a deep appreciation for natural beauty and is captivated by the scenery around him, indicating his curiosity and enthusiasm for new experiences.

- (ii) False
- (iii) People who live in big cities often find natural beauty and abundant greenery fascinating because they are usually surrounded by concrete structures and urban landscapes. The sight of vast green fields and scenic views provides a refreshing contrast to their usual environment, evoking a sense of peace and wonder.
- (iv) The phrase "miniature people" would correctly substitute "doll-like figures" in the given sentence from the extract.

Mijbil the Otter

Author: Gavin Maxwell



Previous Year Questions

CBSE, 2024

1. Mijbil turned out to be a playful pet. Elaborate. (Answer in 40-50 words each)
2. Maxwell decides to keep an otter as a pet. Elucidate with reference to the fact that owning a pet is a life of commitment. (Mijbil the Otter) (Answer in 40-50 words each)
3. Read the following extracts and answer the questions for the given :

For the first twenty-four hours, Mijbil was neither hostile nor friendly; he was simply aloof and indifferent, choosing to sleep on the floor as far from my bed as possible. The second night Mijbil came on to my bed in the small hours and remained asleep in the crook of my knees until the servant brought tea in the morning, and during the day he began to lose his apathy and take a keen, much too keen, interest in his surroundings. I made a body-belt for him and took him on a lead to the bathroom, where for half an hour he went wild with joy in the water. (Mijbil the Otter)

- (i) Which of the following is not a reason why Mijbil came on to Maxwell's bed in the small hours?
 - (a) He had started taking interest in his surroundings.
 - (b) He was becoming friendly with Maxwell.
 - (c) He wanted to play with Maxwell on his bed.

- (d) He wanted to feel safe and not remain indifferent.
- (ii) Maxwell says that Mijbil was neither hostile nor friendly, he was simply aloof and indifferent for the first twenty-four hours. Give reasons in not more than 40 words.
- (iii) Read the following descriptions (A) - (D) and identify which one correctly corresponds to the extract.
 - (a) Owning a pet is tedious and needs commitment.
 - (b) A pet needs his own space and time to get adjusted to his owner's environment.
 - (c) Maxwell decided to bring Mijbil because he was very sad to lose his dog.
 - (d) Maxwell and Mijbil loved travelling.
- (iv) Which characteristic trait of otters is revealed when Mijbil is taken to the bathroom?

CBSE, 2023

1. Mijbil and the Tiger, both were looked after by humans. Assume they both meet each other in the zoo and have a conversation about their lifestyle and feelings. Write this conversation as per your understanding of Mijbil the Otter and A Tiger in the Zoo. You may begin like this

Tiger: Thanks for visiting me, though I don't usually like visitors. **Mijbil:** Oh? I would love visitors, I think.



Explanations

CBSE, 2024

1. Mijbil, the otter, became known for his playful nature. He enjoyed games with toys like ping-pong balls and marbles, showing creativity in play. Maxwell exercised him on a lead like a dog, and Mijbil developed unique habits, such as running along walls, captivating those around him with his lively and engaging behaviour.
2. Maxwell chose to keep an otter, Mijbil, as a pet despite the commitment it entails. This decision shows his readiness to care for Mijbil's needs, like providing a suitable environment and companionship. Maxwell's dedication reflects the responsibility involved in pet ownership, ensuring Mijbil's well-being and adapting his home for the otter's comfort. This commitment is crucial for any pet owner, as it involves long-term care and consideration of the animal's habits and health.
3.
 - (i) (c) He wanted to play with Maxwell on his bed.
 - (ii) Mijbil was in a new environment and needed time to adjust. He chose to sleep far from Maxwell, displaying neither aggression nor affection. His initial behavior showed his uncertainty and need for space to acclimate.
 - (iii) (b) A pet needs his own space and time to get adjusted to his owner's environment.
 - (iv) The characteristic trait of otters revealed when Mijbil is taken to the bathroom is their love for water and playful nature. Mijbil goes wild with

joy in the water, showcasing his natural affinity for aquatic environments and playful behaviour.

CBSE, 2023

1. Tiger & Mijbil's Conversation

Tiger: Thanks for visiting me, though I don't usually like visitors.

Mijbil: Oh? I would love visitors, I think. They bring excitement!

Tiger: Excitement? I wouldn't call it that. I used to roam free in the jungle, but now I'm stuck behind these iron bars, pacing all day. It's frustrating.

Mijbil: That sounds terrible. I was raised by a kind human, and I got to travel and explore. I even played in the water freely!

Tiger: Lucky you. Here, I can't even stretch properly. People stare at me, but no one understands how much I long for my old life.

Mijbil: That's sad. I enjoyed the company of my human, but I also loved swimming in the river, chasing fish, and playing. It was a balance of freedom and care.

Tiger: You had the best of both worlds. I wish humans understood that a wild animal belongs in the wild, not in a cage for their entertainment.

Mijbil: I agree. Every creature deserves a life that suits them best. I hope one day, you get to feel the freedom again.

Tiger: I hope so too, my little friend.

Madam Rides the Bus

Author: Vallikkannan



Previous Year Questions

CBSE-2024

1. Valli was sensitive, but at the same time, she was fearless and quite determined. Think of another character from your text book, who displayed similar character traits.

Compare and contrast the lives of Valli and the other character, that you have chosen from the text of Two Stories about Flying.

You may begin this way.

The characters who are fearless and determined from two texts are Valli and _____.

(Reference: Madam Rides a Bus & Two Stories about Flying)

CBSE, 2023

1. How did Valli save money to travel by bus?
2. Why did Valli spend her time all alone and what became her favourite pastime?
3. What stopped Valli from going to the stall to have a drink? What do we learn about Valli from this?

CBSE, 2022

1. Valli was sensitive, but at the same time she was fearless and quite determined. Explain with reference to the text.
2. Valli was a mature girl and ahead of her age. Justify the statement with evidence from the text.
3. As Valli, make a diary entry about your experience of riding the bus alone for the first time.

CBSE, 2021

1. During her journey, Valli absorbed the natural beauty and clapped her hands in happiness on seeing a young cow running very fast. What does this reveal about Valli?
(CBSE, 2021)
2. Valli didn't like the way adults treated her during her bus journey. Describe how you would feel and react if you were to find yourself in a similar situation.
(CBSE, 2021)

CBSE, 2020

3. How did Valli fulfill her desire to ride a bus to the town and back?
(CBSE, 2020)



Explanations

CBSE, 2024

1. The characters who are fearless and determined from two texts are Valli and Grandmother from "Madam Rides the Bus." Valli, from "A Bicycle in Good Repair," displays sensitivity alongside fearlessness and determination, as she embarks on a daring journey to the fair. Similarly, Grandmother in "Madam Rides the Bus" exhibits these traits when she confidently takes charge of her bus trip despite initial apprehensions. Valli's determination is fueled by her curiosity and adventurous spirit, while Grandmother's fearlessness stems from her practical wisdom and resilience. Both characters navigate challenges with courage, albeit in different contexts—one in a rural setting driven by youthful curiosity, the other in a bustling city driven by experience and necessity. Their stories highlight diverse forms of bravery and determination in the face of life's uncertainties.

CBSE, 2023

1. Valli saved money for her bus ride by resisting temptations. She avoided buying toys, balloons, peppermints, and sweets. She also did not take rides at the village fair. Every coin she got, she saved meticulously until she had enough for the bus fare.
2. Valli spent her time all alone because she had no playmates of her age in the neighborhood. Her favorite pastime became watching the hustle and bustle of the street outside her house. She would keenly observe everything happening outside and dream about traveling on the bus.
3. Valli did not go to the stall to have a drink because she had no extra money left. The bus conductor offered to buy her a drink, but she refused as she took pride in being independent. This shows that Valli was self-respecting, determined, and did not want to take favors from anyone.

CBSE, 2022

1. Valli was sensitive, fearless, and determined, as seen in her strong desire to ride the bus. She saved money with great effort, resisting temptations, and planned her journey meticulously. Despite being alone, she confidently boarded the bus and refused help from strangers. However, her sensitivity is revealed when

she sees the dead cow on the road, which deeply affects her. This contrast in her character highlights her maturity and determination.

2. Valli's maturity is evident in her well-planned trip. She saves money wisely, resists distractions, and handles the journey alone with confidence. She behaves sensibly, refusing to take favors and showing independence. Her keen observation and ability to make decisions beyond her age prove that she is ahead of her peers in terms of responsibility and understanding of the world.

3. Diary Entry

Date: [Insert Date]

Dear Diary,

Today was the most exciting day of my life! I finally took the bus ride I had been dreaming of for so long. Sitting by the window, I watched the fields, trees, and little houses pass by. The conductor was kind, and I felt so grown-up traveling alone. But on the way back, I saw a dead cow on the road. It made me sad and reminded me of life's harsh realities. Still, I am proud of myself for being brave and making my dream come true!

– Valli

CBSE, 2021

1. Valli's dream of riding the bus was finally coming true, and she thoroughly enjoyed her ride to the town. She was looking out of the window at the green landscape and the trees going by. Suddenly she laughed and clapped when a young cow ran in the middle of the road in front of their bus.

Overall, it was a joyful experience for Valli to look at the world outside of her village. She can be described as a curious, joyful, smart and brave girl.

2. If I were taking a journey on my own and wished to enjoy the surroundings, I would not have liked it if people were constantly ordering me. In the same way, Valli felt and reacted to the comments and advice of the conductor, the older man, and the older woman, I would have probably done the same.

She showed that she was a responsible girl with self-respect when she politely refused to accept a free drink from the conductor.

3. Valli made elaborate plans for her bus ride. She started listening to people's conversations and collected information about the distance the bus travelled, the time it took, and the fare by listening to the conversations of others and asking discreet questions.

She planned the timing of when she would board the bus and when she would return. She saved money for the trip by resisting the temptation of buying peppermints, balloons, toys and the merry-go-round. She took the bold step to fulfil her desire by planning everything smartly and getting out of the house when her mother took the afternoon nap.

8

CHAPTER

The Sermon at Benares

[Source: Betty Renshaw Values and Voices: A College Reader (1975)]



Previous Year Questions

CBSE, 2024

1. What did Kisa Gotami do after the death of her only son?

CBSE, 2023

1. What did Siddhartha Gautama come across by chance when he was about twenty-five years old?
2. 'As ripe fruits are in danger of falling early, so mortals when born are always in danger of death. With this statement of the Buddha, find out the moral values that Kisa Gotami learnt after the death of her child.
3. Why did Kisa Gotami meet the Buddha? How did Buddha change her life?

CBSE, 2022

1. Grief is often seen as a measure of love. Justify your response to Buddha's sermon.
2. How, according to Buddha, can one obtain peace of mind?

3. How does Buddha bring about a different perspective in Kisa Gotami's understanding of life?
4. What is the significance of the Buddha's request for a handful of mustard seeds and the addition of a condition to it?

CBSE, 2021

1. Kisa Gotami lost her only son, so grief overwhelmed her. How did she learn that death is as normal in life as birth is?

CBSE, 2020

1. Describe the journey of Siddhartha Gautama becoming the Buddha. **(CBSE, 2020)**
2. Through the story of Kisa Gotami, what did the Buddha try to preach to common man?
3. What lesson did Kisa Gotami learn the second time that she had failed to learn the first time?
4. What lesson on death and suffering did the Buddha teach Kisa Gotami in the chapter. 'The Sermon At Benares'?



Explanations

CBSE, 2024

1. After her only son died, Kisa Gotami went from house to house seeking medicine to bring him back to life. Eventually, she sought help from the Buddha. He asked her to bring mustard seed from a house untouched by death. Through this journey, she realized the universality of death and accepted her son's passing. This led her to embrace the Buddha's teachings on impermanence and find peace within herself.

CBSE, 2023

1. When Siddhartha Gautama was about twenty-five years old, he came across four sights by chance: an old man, a sick man, a dead body, and an ascetic. These sights deeply impacted him, making him realize the reality of suffering and inspiring him to seek enlightenment.
2. Through Buddha's teachings, Kisa Gotami learned the moral values of acceptance, impermanence, and detachment. She realized that death is inevitable and universal, just like ripe fruits eventually fall. Her grief transformed into wisdom, helping her understand that suffering is a part of life, and clinging to worldly attachments only brings sorrow.
3. Kisa Gotami met the Buddha in deep sorrow after losing her only child. She sought a way to bring him back to life. The Buddha, instead of giving her false hope, asked her to bring a handful of mustard seeds from a house where no one had ever lost a loved one. She soon realized that death spares no one. This experience changed her life, making her understand the transient nature of life, leading her to renounce worldly attachments and follow the path of wisdom.

CBSE, 2022

1. Buddha's sermon teaches that grief stems from attachment, but it does not necessarily measure love. Kisa Gotami's intense sorrow for her dead child showed her deep love, but her suffering was prolonged by her inability to accept death as a natural part of life. The Buddha guided her to understand that true wisdom lies in acceptance and detachment, emphasizing that love should not lead to endless suffering but to compassion

and understanding.

2. According to Buddha, one can obtain peace of mind by overcoming desires and attachments. He preached that suffering is inevitable, but by understanding the transient nature of life, one can free oneself from grief. Letting go of worldly attachments and practicing detachment from material and emotional bonds lead to inner peace and enlightenment.
3. Initially, Kisa Gotami viewed death as a personal tragedy, believing she alone had suffered such a loss. However, Buddha's request for mustard seeds from a house untouched by death made her realize that grief is universal. This shifted her perspective, helping her accept the impermanence of life and embrace wisdom over sorrow.
4. The Buddha's request for a handful of mustard seeds, with the condition that they must come from a house where no one had ever died, was a profound lesson in the universality of death. It forced Kisa Gotami to seek out others who had suffered similar losses, making her realize that death is an inevitable part of life. This experience helped her move from personal grief to a broader understanding of human suffering, leading her toward wisdom and acceptance.

CBSE, 2021

1. Kisa Gotami, overwhelmed by the loss of her only son, initially refused to accept his death. She desperately sought a way to bring him back to life. In her quest, she approached the Buddha, who asked her to collect mustard seeds from a house where no one had ever died. As she went from house to house, she realized that every family had experienced death and loss. This profound realization helped her understand that death is a natural and inevitable part of life, just like birth. Through this experience, she gained wisdom and accepted the impermanence of human existence.

CBSE, 2020

1. Gautam Buddha was born a prince in Northern India as Siddhartha Gautama. Till the age of about twenty-five, he had been shielded from the sufferings of the world.

One day, while hunting, he saw a sick man, an aged

man, a funeral and a monk asking for help. These sights moved him so much that he went out into the world to seek enlightenment concerning the sorrows he had witnessed.

He wandered for seven years, finally sat down under a peepal tree, and received enlightenment after seven days. He renamed the tree the Bodhi Tree (Tree of Wisdom). He then came to be known as the Buddha. The Buddha preached his first sermon in the city of Benares, which is still preserved.

2. Through the story of Kisa Gotami, the Buddha tried to preach that death is an inevitable part of life, and everyone experiences loss. He emphasized that attachment to worldly things causes suffering, and true peace can be attained by accepting the impermanence of life and letting go of grief.

3. The second time, Kisa Gotami learned that death is a universal truth, and no one can escape it. Initially, she believed her son's death was an exception and sought a way to bring him back. However, after failing to find a house where no one had lost a loved one, she understood that death spares no one and that grieving excessively only leads to suffering.

4. The Buddha taught Kisa Gotami that death and suffering are unavoidable, just as ripe fruits must eventually fall from the tree. He conveyed that mourning does not bring back the dead, and clinging to grief only prolongs pain. Instead, one should accept the cycle of life and death with wisdom and seek inner peace by detaching from worldly attachments.

The Proposal

Author: Anton Chekhov



Previous Year Questions

CBSE, 2024

1. What argument do Lomov and Natalya give over the superiority of their dogs, Guess and Squeezer? (The Proposal) (Answer in 40-50 words each)
2. Oh, what a burden, Lord, to be the father of a grown-up daughter! Explain what this line conveys about Chubukov as a father. (The Proposal) (Answer in 40-50 words each)
3. Justify the title of the play The Proposal with reference to the characters and plot. (Answer in 40-50 words each)
4. Based on your understanding of the Play "The Proposal", what do you think of relationships?

Prepare a speech draft on relationships based on Natalya's and Anne Frank's characters.

You may begin this way.

Good morning everyone.

Relationships are the bond between two people based on mutual likes, understanding, need or love. I'd like to discuss relationships as portrayed in the two texts.....

You may end this way

To conclude, I'd like to say that

Thank you,

(Reference: The Proposal & from the Diary of Anne Frank)

CBSE, 2023

Read the extract given below and attempt the questions that follow.

Lomov But you can see from the documents, honoured Natalya Stepanovna. Oxen Meadows, its true were once the subject of dispute, but now everybody knows they

are mine. There's nothing to argue about. You see my aunts grandmother gave the free use of these Meadows in perpetuity to the peasants or your father's grandfather, in return for which they are to make bricks for her. The peasants belonging to your father's grandfather had the free use of Meadows for forty years, and had got into the habit of regarding them as their own, when it happened that Natalya : No, it isn't at all like that! Both grandfather and great grandfather reckoned that their land extended to Burnt Marsh - which means Oxen Meadows were ours. I don't see what there is to argue about, its simply silly.

1. The subject of dispute was regarding
 - (a) free use of Meadows
 - (b) making of bricks
 - (c) peasants using Meadows
 - (d) ownership of Meadows
2. Find the word from the extract which means 'continuance':
 - (a) disoute
 - (b) perpetuity
 - (c) belonging
 - (d) reckoned
3. Lemov's aunt's grandmother gave Oxen Meadows to Natalya's father's grandfather in lieu of
4. According to Natalya why did Oxen Meadows belong to them?
5. Fill in the blank with ONE WORD only. The peasants had free use of Meadows for years.
6. How can we say that Natalya was continuously successful in maintaining an upper hand during her arguments with Lomov?

CBSE, 2022

1. What was the objective of Lomov's visit to Chubukov's house?
2. Write a brief character sketch of Lomov.

3. Which two issues about himself convinced Lomov of his decision to get married?
4. Farce is a kind of comedy that includes situations and dialogues that are ridiculous, exaggerated, and even absurd. Evaluate the play, *The Proposal*, as a farce.

CBSE, 2021

1. Natalya and Ivan argued about the ownership of Oxen Meadows and the superiority of their respective dogs in the play, *'The Proposal'*. Imagine yourself as the playwright of the play. Based on your understanding of the personality traits of Natalya and Ivan, write a dialogue based on an imaginary event, show-casing another argument between them.





Explanations

CBSE, 2024

1. Lomov and Natalya argue over the superiority of their dogs, Guess and Squeezer, citing traits like strength, hunting skills, and lineage. They try to prove which dog is better based on these qualities, showing their competitive nature and pride in their pets.
2. The line "Oh, what a burden, Lord, to be the father of a grown-up daughter!" from "The Proposal" reveals Chubukov's exasperation and perhaps a touch of humor regarding his daughter's maturity. It suggests he finds the responsibility of a father to an adult daughter challenging, possibly due to her independence or the complexities of their relationship. This highlights Chubukov's feelings of parental duty mixed with the inevitable difficulties of seeing his daughter grow up.
3. The title "The Proposal" is apt because the play revolves around a marriage proposal that sets off a chain of comedic events. The characters—Chubukov, Lomov, and Natalya—are involved in a humorous misunderstanding over property boundaries and Lomov's hesitant proposal to Natalya. The title captures the central theme of courtship and the absurdity that ensues when emotions and egos clash.
4. Good morning everyone.

Relationships are the bond between two people based on mutual likes, understanding, need, or love. I'd like to discuss relationships as portrayed in the two texts "The Proposal" and "The Diary of Anne Frank."

In "The Proposal," Natalya and her potential suitor, Lomov, illustrate the complexities of relationships driven by societal expectations and personal ambitions. Their comedic misunderstandings and arguments over trivial matters reflect how ego and pride can often overshadow genuine affection.

On the other hand, Anne Frank's diary entries reveal a profound connection between Anne and her family, as they endure the harrowing realities of hiding during World War II. Their love and support for each other in the face of adversity highlight the strength and resilience that relationships can

provide.

To conclude, I'd like to say that relationships are a cornerstone of human experience, encompassing a spectrum of emotions from joy to challenge. They teach us about ourselves, our values, and the importance of empathy and understanding.

CBSE, 2023

1. (d) ownership of Meadows
2. (b) perpetuity
3. making bricks for her
4. Because her grandfather and great-grandfather believed their land extended to Burnt Marsh, including Oxen Meadows.
5. forty
6. Natalya was continuously successful in maintaining an upper hand during her arguments with Lomov because she was assertive, confident, and relentless in her claims. She refused to accept Lomov's arguments and countered them with strong statements, refusing to back down. She forcefully asserted that Oxen Meadows belonged to her family and dismissed Lomov's claims as baseless. Even when Lomov presented historical justifications, she interrupted him and insisted on her version of the truth. Her persistence and emotional intensity ensured that she dominated the argument, making Lomov flustered and defensive.

CBSE, 2022

1. Lomov visited Chubukov's house with the objective of proposing marriage to Natalya. He believed that she was an excellent match for him and that marriage would bring stability to his life. However, his nervousness and quarrelsome nature led to arguments instead of a smooth proposal.
2. Lomov is a hypochondriac, nervous, and insecure man who overthinks every situation. He is highly conscious of his health and frequently complains about ailments. Despite his intention to propose to Natalya, he gets easily distracted by petty arguments. His lack of confidence and short temper often lead to absurd conflicts, making him both comical and pitiable.
3. Lomov was convinced to get married because of his poor health and advancing age. He believed that

marriage would bring stability to his life and provide him with a partner to take care of him. Additionally, he thought Natalya was a suitable match due to her family background and domestic skills.

4. The Proposal is a perfect example of farce as it presents exaggerated conflicts, ridiculous situations, and absurd dialogues. Instead of a smooth marriage proposal, Lomov and Natalya engage in heated arguments over trivial issues like land ownership and dog superiority. The over-the-top reactions of the characters, their exaggerated emotions, and the constant misunderstandings create a comical atmosphere that keeps the audience entertained.

CBSE, 2021

1. Natalya and Lomov's New Argument

Natalya: Lomov, you always exaggerate! Our barn is the biggest in the village!

Lomov: (offended) Nonsense! My barn is twice as strong as yours!

Natalya: (scoffs) Strong? Your roof leaks when it rains! Even your cows must be unhappy!

Lomov: (defensive) My cows? They give more milk than yours!

Natalya: (angrily) That's a lie! Our cows produce the creamiest milk. Even your cook buys our butter!

Lomov: (mocking) Your butter is as hard as a rock!

Natalya: You are impossible!

Chubukov: (entering) Are you two arguing again? This is worse than the Oxen Meadows fight!

(Curtain falls as they continue bickering.)

Poems

1

CHAPTER

Dust of Snow

Author: Robert Frost



Previous Year Questions

CBSE, 2024

1. What mood of the poet is reflected in the poem 'Dust of Snow' initially? What images are used by the poet to bring about the effect? Comment.
2. It is our attitude towards a situation that makes it positive or negative. Do you agree with it? Express your views with reference to the poem, 'Dust of Snow'.

CBSE, 2022

1. "The dust of snow From a hemlock tree." The dust of snow has made the poet:
 - (a) appreciative of nature
 - (b) thoughtful
 - (c) happy
 - (d) cold.



Explanations

CBSE, 2024

1. In *Dust of Snow*, the poet's initial mood is gloomy and dejected, reflected through the imagery of snow and the crow, which evoke coldness and darkness. However, the simple, unexpected act of snow falling from a tree uplifts his mood, symbolising nature's ability to bring positive change.
2. Whatever situation life throws at us, it evokes both positive and negative responses. The poet, in the poem, "*Dust of Snow*" was in a sorrowful mood. However, when a crow shook down the 'dust of snow' on him, his bitter mood changed into a more optimistic one.

Now, being in a sorrowful or bad mood already, the poet could have got angry at the crow also.

However, the dust of snow becomes a positive medium of change for him. It made him cheerful to some extent and helped him forget his sadness, at least for a few moments. Thus, we see that instead of seeing the negative aspect of a happening, one should see the positive aspect, and one's response may greatly affect the outcome of incidents

CBSE, 2022

1. (c) happy

2

CHAPTER

Fire and Ice

Poet: *Robert Frost*



Previous Year Questions

CBSE, 2022

1. Which word from the poem, Fire and Ice will complete the following? Cruelty: Fire :: Insensitivity: _____

- (a) Ice
- (c) Desire

- (b) Hate
- (d) Destruction



Explanations

1. (a) Ice

|

⁶**Avarice:** Extreme greed for wealth or material gain

A Tiger in the Zoo

Poet: Leslie Norris



Previous Year Questions

CBSE, 2024

1. Read the extract and answer the questions that follow

(A) He stalks in his vivid stripes The few steps of his cage,
On pads of velvet quiet, In his quiet rage.

He should be lurking in shadow, Sliding through long grass
Near the water pole Where plump deer pass.

He should be snarling around houses At the jungle's edge,
Baring his white fangs, his claws, Terrorising the village!

(i) State any one point of contrast between the tiger in the zoo and in its natural habitat.

(ii) When the speaker suggests that the tiger should be "Snarling around houses at the jungle's edge"? What does he insinuate about the tiger's natural behaviour and habitat?

(iii) The poet's skillful use of imagery effectively depicts the confinement and frustration of the tiger. Elaborate in about 40 words.

(iv) Which phrase would correctly substitute 'quiet rage' in the given sentence from the extract?

The few steps of his cage on pads of velvet quiet in his 'quiet rage'.

2. (a) He stalks in his vivid stripes The few steps of his cage,
On pads of velvet quiet, In his quiet rage

(1) Explain the contrast created by the words, 'stalks' and 'few steps of his cage'.

(ii) Which of the following best describes the tiger's feelings in the context?

- (A) anger
- (B) conflicted
- (C) pessimism

(D) apprehension

(iii) Comment in about 40 words on the poet's use of imagery in the above extract.

(iv) Which word in the stanza means the same as 'clear and bright'?

3. But he's locked in a concrete cell, His strength behind bars,
Stalking the length of his cage. Ignoring visitors.
A Tiger in the Zoo

(1) Why is the tiger 'stalking the length of his cage'?

(H) What is the significance of the use of the word "locked" to describe the concrete cell where the tiger is kept and how does it contrast with the tiger's presence in its natural habitat? Answer in about 40 words.

(ii) Complete the sentence with the appropriate option:
The lines from the poem tell us that the tiger is

- (A) enjoying his time in the cell
- (B) being indifferent to visitors because it is a daily routine for him

(C) not as strong as his counterpart in the jungle

(D) wanting to be free from the cage

(iv) Identify the type of literary device used in the line:
"But he's locked in a concrete cell"

4. The poem, "A Tiger in the Zoo" moves from the zoo to the jungle; and back again to the zoo. What effect does the poet want to bring out with this? Elaborate.

CBSE, 2023

Read the following extract and answer the questions that follow.

(A) He hears the last voice at night. The patrolling cars,
And stares with his brilliant eyes At the brilliant stars.
He stalks in his vivid stripes A few steps of his cage.

- Whose is the last voice heard by the tiger?
(a) police jeep (c) watchmen
(b) patrolling cars (d) roar of lion
 - Complete the sentence appropriately It is clear that 'Repetition' is the poetic device used for 'his brilliant eyes at the brilliant stars' because _____. (Clue: explain how repetition applies here)
 - The main contrasting ideas in this extract are
(a) tiger and deer
(b) cruelty and sympathy
(c) confinement and freedom
(d) master and slave
 - The use of the word 'stalks' creates an image of
(a) cowardice
(b) frustration
(c) lethargy
(d) purposefulness
 - State whether the following statement is true or False
The poem uses 'staring at the sky' to symbolize the freedom 'he' yearns for.
- (B)** He stalks in his vivid stripes The few steps of his cage,
On pads of velvet quiet, In his quiet rage. He should
be lurking in shadow, Sliding through long grass Near
the water hole Where plump deer pass.
- 'Quiet rage' refers to the tigers _____
(a) helplessness
(b) has not been able to hunt
(c) his prey has not come to the water hole
(d) he is not free
 - He is lurking in shadows because _____
 - Complete the sentence appropriately. It is clear that metaphor is the poetic device used for 'pads of velvet' because _____ (clue - explain how metaphor applies here).
 - Find a word from the extract which means - to walk with measured, stiff or haughty strides:
(a) steps (b) lurking
(c) pads (d) stalk

- State whether the following statement is True or False:
The tiger is stealthily waiting for the deer to come to the water hole.

CBSE, 2022

- (A)** He stalks in his vivid stripes The few steps of his cage,
On pads of velvet quiet, In his quiet rage. He should
be lurking in shadow, Sliding through long grass Near
the water hole Where plump deer pass.
- How does the tiger show his helplessness?
(a) Through his beautiful stripes
(b) Through his brief walk
(c) Through his controlled anger
(d) By walking quietly
 - Study the following statements:
(i) Even in the zoo the tiger has retained his majesty.
(ii) He is walking softly in the cage as he is looking for his prey. Choose the correct option:
(a) (i) is right and (ii) is wrong.
(b) (ii) is right and (i) is wrong.
(c) (i) and (ii) are both right.
(d) (i) and (ii) are both wrong.
 - Looking at the caged tiger we :
(a) admire his majestic looks.
(b) get scared of him.
(c) feel sympathetic towards him.
(d) feel safe that he is caged.
 - The tiger in the zoo does not have to hunt for his food:
(a) so he feels happy.
(b) yet he is angry.
(c) so he feels secure.
(d) yet he feels lonely.
 - He likes the water hole as:
(a) the deer visits it
(b) there is tall grass around it
(c) it is a shady place
(d) he can hide behind the grass.



Explanations

CBSE, 2024

1. (i) In the zoo, the tiger is confined and paces restlessly within the limited space of its cage, whereas in its natural habitat, it enjoys the freedom to hunt, roam, and terrorise its surroundings.
(ii) By suggesting that the tiger should be "snarling around houses at the jungle's edge," the speaker hints at the tiger's instinctive behaviour as a predator. It suggests that in its natural habitat, the tiger is fierce and dominant, and its presence can instill fear in nearby villages.
(iii) The poet uses imagery such as "pads of velvet quiet" and "quiet rage" to depict the tiger's suppressed power and frustration. The contrast between the tiger's stealthy movements and its caged environment effectively conveys its inner turmoil and confinement.
(iv) A correct substitute for 'quiet rage' would be 'suppressed anger,' as it captures the tiger's restrained yet intense frustration.
2. (i) The contrast between 'stalks' and 'few steps of his cage' highlights the tiger's restrained power and frustration. "Stalks" suggests the tiger's natural behaviour as a predator, symbolising its strength and grace, but "few steps of his cage" reflects its confinement and limited movement, reducing the tiger to a mere shadow of its true self.
(ii) (A) anger
(iii) The poet uses powerful imagery in this extract to depict the tiger's frustration and confinement. The phrases "pads of velvet quiet" and "quiet rage" evoke the tiger's stealth and power, but also its helplessness in captivity.
(iv) The word "vivid" in the stanza means 'clear and bright'.
3. (i) The tiger is 'stalking the length of his cage' because it is restless and pacing, which is a common behavior seen in captive animals indicating boredom, frustration, or a longing for freedom.
(ii) The use of the word 'locked' emphasizes the tiger's confinement and captivity in a concrete cell. It signifies that the tiger is restricted from its

natural habitat and its freedom is constrained by man-made barriers. This contrasts starkly with the tiger's presence in the wild where it would roam freely without such confinement, highlighting the loss of its natural environment and freedom.

- (iii) (D) wanting to be free from the cage
 - (iv) The type of literary device used in the line "But he's locked in a concrete cell" is symbolism. The concrete cell symbolizes captivity and confinement, contrasting with the tiger's natural habitat in the wild.
4. In *A Tiger in the Zoo*, Leslie Norris creates a stark contrast between the tiger's life in the zoo and its natural habitat. By moving from the zoo to the jungle and back again, the poet highlights the profound difference between the tiger's current confined existence and its natural state of freedom. In the zoo, the tiger is trapped in a small cage, expressing "quiet rage" as it paces restlessly. In the wild, it would roam freely, lurk in shadows, and hunt near waterholes. The back-and-forth movement emphasises the tiger's longing for freedom and the unnaturalness of captivity, evoking sympathy for the tiger's plight and criticising the human practice of imprisoning such majestic creatures.

CBSE, 2023

(A)

1. (b) patrolling cars
2. The word brilliant is repeated to emphasize both the tiger's gaze and the stars he is staring at.
3. (c) confinement and freedom
4. (b) frustration
5. True

(B)

1. (d) he is not free
2. He is waiting for his prey near the water hole.
3. The tiger's soft paws are indirectly compared to velvet.
4. (d) stalk
5. True



(A)

1. (c) Through his controlled anger

2. (a) (i) is right and (ii) is wrong.
3. (c) feel sympathetic towards him.
4. (b) yet he is angry.
5. (a) the deer visits it.



4

CHAPTER

How to Tell Wild Animals

Poet: Carolyn Wells



Previous Year Questions

CBSE, 2024

1. Answer the following questions based on the extract:

- (a) The true Chameleon is small A lizard sort of thing;
He hasn't any ears at all.
And not a single wing.
If there is nothing on the tree,
Tis the Chameleon you see.

(How To Tell Wild Animals)

- (i) Fill in the blank with one word
When the speaker says "If there is nothing on the tree, Tis the Chameleon you see", he refers to a true Chameleon. as characteristic trait of
- (ii) What does the speaker mean when he says, "A lizard sort of thing"?
- (iii) Which of the following best describes the speaker's disposition while describing the Chameleon?
(a) indifferent (b) playful
(c) dismissive (d) respectful
- (iv) Comment on the poet's use of language in these lines. Answer in about 40 words.

CBSE, 2023

Read the following extract and answer the questions that follow.

(A) Or if some time when roaming round, A noble wild beast greets you, With balck stripes on a yellow ground, Just notice if he eats you. This simple rule may help you lean The Bengal Tiger to discern.

1. Who is the 'noble wild beast' in the above lines?
(a) zebra (b) Asian Tiger
(c) Asian Lion (d) Bengal Tiger
2. Complete the sentence appropriately. It is clear that 'Alliteration' is the poetic devise used for 'roaming round' because _____ (Clue: explain how alliteration applies here)
3. State whether the following statements is True or False: The extract helps to identify a Royal Bengal Tiger.
4. In the given lines, what effect does the poet create? 'Just notice if he eats you. This simple rule may help you learn The Bengal Tiger to discern.'
(a) irony (b) terror
(c) sympathy (d) criticism
5. Which word in the extract tells you that you have recognised the 'noble beast'?
(a) rule (b) discern
(c) roaming (d) notice



Explanations

CBSE, 2024

1. (i) camouflage
- (ii) When the speaker says, "A lizard sort of thing," he means that a Chameleon is similar in appearance to a lizard. This comparison helps to describe the Chameleon's physical form in a simple and relatable way.
- (iii) (b) playful
- (iv) The poet's use of language in these lines is playful and light-hearted. By describing the Chameleon in simple, whimsical terms and using rhymes, the poet makes the

description engaging and memorable. This approach captures the reader's imagination while effectively conveying the Chameleon's distinctive traits, such as its ability to camouflage.

CBSE, 2023

1. (d) Bengal Tiger
2. It is clear that 'Alliteration' is the poetic device used for 'roaming round' because the consonant sound 'r' is repeated at the beginning of closely connected words.
3. True
4. (a) irony
5. (b) discern

The Ball Poem

Poet: John Berryman



Previous Year Questions

CBSE, 2024

1. Read the extract and answer the questions that follow.

No use to say O there are other balls An ultimate shaking grief fixes the boy As he stands rigid, trembling, staring down All his young days into the harbour where his ball went.

I would not intrude on him, A dime, another ball, is worthless. Now He senses first responsibility In a world of possessions. People will take Balls, balls will be lost always, little boy And no one buys a ball back. Money is external He is learning.

- (i) Which of the following best describes the speaker's attitude towards the boy's reaction to losing his ball?
 - (A) indifferent as the ball is inexpensive
 - (B) sympathetic, understanding the depth of the boy's loss
 - (C) mocking, finding the boy's reaction exaggerated and unnecessary.
 - (D) panicked, sharing the boy's distress over the lost ball.
- (ii) Comment on the use of metaphor in the above extract.
- (iii) Explain the phrase 'all his young days into the harbour' with reference to the extract.
- (iv) Briefly state in about 40 words the boy's journey from 'shaking grief to 'he is learning' in the above extract.

2. And no one buys a ball back, Money is external

He is learning, well behind his desperate eyes

The epistemology of loss, how to standup.

- (i) When the poet says that "no one buys a ball back", what does he refer to in the context of the poem?
 - (ii) Complete the sentence with an appropriate option:
The lines from the poem tell us that the boy is experiencing
 - (A) distress
 - (B) terror
 - (C) realisation
 - (D) elation
 - (iii) What is the significance of the term "desperate" used to describe the boy's eyes in the poem, and how does it contribute to the overall mood and tone of the poem?
 - (iv) Identify and discuss the poet's use of metaphor in the poem "The Ball Poem".
3. In a world of possessions. People will take Balls, balls will be lost always, little boy. And no one buys a ball back. Money is external. He is learning, well behind his desperate eyes, The epistemology of loss, how to stand up Knowing what every man must one day know And most know many days, how to stand up. (The Ball Poem)
- (i) Fill in the blank with one word. When the speaker says "People will take balls, Balls will be lost always, little boy", his tone is,

(ii) The poet says that money is external. What inference can be drawn from this statement? Answer in about 40 words.

(iii) Which of the following best describes the speaker's attitude towards material possessions?

(A) indifferent

(B) emotional

(C) casual

(D) respectful

(iv) Identify the poetic device used in "And no one buys a ball back".

CBSE, 2023

Read the extract and answer the questions that follow.

(A) What is the boy now, who has lost his ball, What, what is he to do? I saw it go Merrily bouncing, down the street and then Merrily over-there it is in the water! No use to say 'O there are other balls': (The Ball Poem).

1. What does the expression 'what, what is he to do' denote?

(a) loss of the ball

(b) ask the poet for another ball

(c) boy's grief over the loss of the ball

(d) go down the street

2. State whether the following statement is True or False: The poet was delighted to watch the ball bouncing down the street into the water.

3. The poet repeats the word 'what' in order to _____

4. There is no use to say 'O there are other balls' indicates that the poet feels that it would be _____ to console the boy

(a) helpful (b) futile

(c) easy (d) shameful

5. 'What is the boy now, who has lost his ball. Which feeling is expressed in this line?

(a) regret (b) cheer

(c) despair (d) thrill

(B) "Not from weeping nor from grieving will anyone obtain peace of mind". If you had to use the message of the given quote from the Buddha's sermon (The Sermon at Benares) to help the boy cope with the loss of his ball and what it signifies (The Ball Poem), what would you include in your advice? Also, evaluate why it might be difficult for him to understand the notion.

CBSE, 2022

1. After losing his ball, the boy :

(a) become sad

(b) felt angry

(c) learnt a lesson

(d) went for another ball.

2. Read the given extract to attempt the questions that follow:

Money is external. He is learning, well behind his desperate eyes, The epistemology of loss, how to stand up

Knowing what every man must one day know And most know many days, how to stand up

(i) The poet says money is external. What does it mean in this extract?

(a) Money helps us purchase materials that make life worth living.

(b) Money promotes materialism and hunger for power among youngsters.

(c) Money only impacts a person's external environment.

(d) Money buys materialistic things and can be earned again, when lost.

(ii) What does the boy learn by losing the ball, according to the extract?

(1) Loss is the unavoidable truth of life.

(2) Material objects can be replaced.

(3) Money buys happiness.

(4) Losses in life can be prevented with care.

(5) Life continues despite losses.

(a) (1), (2) and (5)

(b) (2) and (4)

(c) Only (1)

(d) (3) and (5)

3. The boy is learning how to stand up... This means that he is learning to be _____ in the face of difficulties.

(a) patient (b) resilient

(c) defensive (d) judgemental

4. Which option lists who is speaking these lines?

(a) An observer (b) The boy's parent

(c) The ball salesman (d) A friend

5. According to the poet, from whom do we mostly learn about loss?

- (a) Elders (b) Experiences
(c) Books (d) Teachers

CBSE, 2021

(A) I would not intrude on him; A dime, another ball, is worthless. Now He senses first responsibility In a world of possessions. People will take Balls, balls will be lost always, little boy. And no one buys a ball back.

1. Who is 'him'?
2. Why won't 'I' intrude on 'him'?
3. 'I' seems to be

4. Why does no one buy a ball back?

5. Which word is opposite in meaning to the word 'worthless'?

CBSE, 2020

(A) 'His ball went. I would not intrude on him; A dime, another ball, is worthless. Now He senses first responsibility In a world of possessions.

1. The loss of the ball will help the child to understand his _____
2. Giving another ball to the child is _____
3. The boy is sad because _____
4. The ball is called worthless because it costs only



Explanations

CBSE, 2024

1. (i) (B) sympathetic, understanding the depth of the boy's loss.
 - (ii) The metaphor of the ball symbolises the boy's lost innocence and childhood. The ball represents something precious, and its loss is a metaphor for growing up and realising that material possessions and childhood joys cannot always be recovered.
 - (iii) The phrase "all his young days into the harbour" signifies that the boy sees his childhood memories and joys being lost along with the ball. It suggests that the ball's loss represents a significant emotional moment for the boy, linked to his youth.
 - (iv) The boy's journey moves from intense sadness and "shaking grief" to a growing understanding of life's realities. He learns that loss is an inevitable part of life and that material things, like the ball, cannot be retrieved, fostering personal growth and responsibility.
2. (i) When the poet says "no one buys a ball back," he is referring to the irreversibility of loss and the harsh realities of life. In the context of the poem, a ball symbolizes innocence, childhood, and the joy associated with simple pleasures. Once the ball is lost (metaphorically or literally), it cannot be bought back. The phrase "Money is external" suggests that some losses cannot be compensated for or undone by material wealth or external means. It underscores a deeper theme of growing up and facing inevitable losses that cannot be recovered.
 - (ii) (A) distress
 - (iii) The term "desperate" used to describe the boy's eyes is significant as it intensifies the emotional depth of the poem. It implies that the boy is deeply affected by the loss of his ball, feeling hopeless and distraught. This contributes to the overall mood of melancholy and emphasizes the theme of loss and its emotional aftermath. The tone becomes poignant and reflective, evoking empathy from the reader towards the boy's plight.
 - (iv) The poet uses metaphor in "The Ball Poem" to convey deeper meanings and emotions. One prominent metaphor is the ball itself, which symbolizes childhood, innocence, and the fleeting nature of joy. The loss of the ball represents the

loss of innocence and the inevitable experiences of disappointment and sorrow that accompany growing up. The metaphorical significance invites readers to contemplate broader themes of life's transience and the challenges of accepting loss.

In conclusion, "The Ball Poem" by John Berryman delicately explores themes of loss, childhood, and the transition to adulthood through vivid imagery and poignant metaphors, making it a profound reflection on the human experience.

3. Answer:

- (i) philosophical
- (ii) The statement "money is external" suggests that money is a material possession that exists outside of the emotional and personal realm. It implies that while money can buy things, it cannot replace sentimental or personal losses.
- (iii) (A) indifferent
- (iv) The poetic device used in the given line is alliteration

CBSE, 2023

(A)

1. (c) boy's grief over the loss of the ball
2. False
3. Emphasize the boy's confusion and grief
4. (b) futile
5. (c) despair

- (B) If I had to use the message from Buddha's sermon to help the boy cope with his loss in *The Ball Poem*, I would advise him that grief is a natural response to loss, but it does not bring back what is gone. Just like Kisa Gotami learned that death is inevitable, the boy must understand that losses in life—whether of people or possessions—are unavoidable. Instead of dwelling on sorrow, he should accept loss as a part of growing up and move forward with resilience.

However, it might be difficult for the boy to understand this notion because he is still young and emotionally attached to his ball. Unlike an adult who has experienced multiple losses, this might be one of his first encounters with grief. He is still learning

about impermanence, and letting go of something significant to him feels overwhelming. With time, however, he will realize that life moves on despite losses, just as Buddha taught.

CBSE, 2022

1. (c) learnt a lesson.
2. (i) (d) Money buys materialistic things and can be earned again, when lost.
(ii) (a) (1), (2) and (5)
3. (b) resilient
4. (a) An observer
5. (b) Experiences

CBSE, 2021

(A)

1. 'Him' refers to the little boy who lost his ball.
2. 'I' won't intrude on him because the boy is learning an important life lesson about loss and responsibility.
3. 'I' seems to be a thoughtful observer or the poet.
4. No one buys a ball back because some losses, like the experiences of life, cannot be replaced.
5. The word opposite in meaning to 'worthless' is 'valuable'.

CBSE, 2020

1. first sense of responsibility
2. worthless
3. he has lost something valuable to him and realizes that some things cannot be replaced
4. a dime

6

CHAPTER

Amanda

Poet: Robin Klein



Previous Year Questions

CBSE, 2024

1. Amanda from the poem 'Amanda' is a teenager like Anne Frank and lives in her fantasy world whereas Anne is a chatter box. What conversation will Anne Frank have with Amanda about different perspectives of life? Write your answer in about 120 words.
2. In every alternate stanza, Amanda drifts into fantasy and yearns for more freedom and silence. Justify and elaborate the reason. (Amanda)
3. In the poem 'Amanda', why does the poet use the famous fairy tale character, Rapunzel? Explain. (Amanda)
4. In one instance, Amanda considers herself to be an orphan. What connotation does it entail? (Amanda)
5. Don't eat that chocolate, Amanda!
Remember your acne, Amanda! Will you please look at me when I'm speaking to you, Amanda!
(I am Rapunzel, I have not a care; life in a tower is tranquil and rare:)
(Amanda)
 - (i) What is the central idea of the poem as reflected in the lines above? Answer in about 40 words.
 - (ii) Complete the sentence with the appropriate option. "Will you please look at me when I'm speaking to you, Amanda!" tells us that the mother's attitude is
 - (A) loving
 - (B) relaxed
 - (C) authoritative
 - (D) thoughtful
 - (iii) Identify any one poetic device used in the above extract.
 - (iv) For what reason does Amanda imagine herself to

be Rapunzel?

CBSE, 2023

1. What impression do you form about Amanda in the poem?
2. Read the extract given below and answer the questions that follow: Don't eat that chocolate Amanda! Remember your acne, Amanda! Will you please look at me when I'm speaking to you Amanda!
(I am Rapunzel, I have not a care; life in tower is tranquil and rare, I'll certainly never let down my bright hair)
 - (i) The Speaker's tone is
 - (a) loving
 - (b) hopeful
 - (c) instructive
 - (d) indifferent
 - (ii) Complete the analogy with a word from the extract: rare: uncommon:: peace: _____
 - (iii) State whether the following statement is true or false. Amanda did not want anyone to invade her privacy and silence.
 - (iv) Select the appropriate option: Amanda's mother is continuously _____ Amanda.
 - (a) encouraging
 - (b) reprimanding
 - (c) motivating
 - (d) disappointing
 - (v) Which word in the extract is opposite in meaning to the word 'dull'?
 - (a) dreary
 - (b) shady
 - (c) bright
 - (d) angry

CBSE, 2022

1. "Don't bite your nails Amanda! Don't hunch your shoulders Amanda!" What does this reflect about Amanda's mother and Amanda?

2. Amanda was blamed for a number of things. Mention any two.

CBSE, 2021

1. Don't eat that chocolate, Amanda! Remember your acne, Amanda! Will you please look at me when I'm speaking to you, Amanda! (I am Rapunzel, I have not a care; life in a tower is tranquil and rare; I'll certainly

never let down my bright hair!)

- (i) The speaker does not want Amanda to eat chocolate because _____
- (ii) The speaker's attitude is _____
- (iii) Where was Rapunzel kept?
- (iv) How is Amanda different from Rapunzel?
- (v) Which word is opposite in meaning to the word, 'tranquil'?





Explanations

CBSE, 2024

1. In a conversation, Anne Frank might encourage Amanda to see life with curiosity and optimism, despite its challenges. Anne, a chatterbox, would likely advise Amanda to embrace communication and express her thoughts freely, as she did through her diary. Anne could suggest that although life's circumstances may feel confining, like Amanda's overbearing upbringing, there's beauty in understanding people and forming meaningful connections. Amanda, living in her fantasy world, might counter Anne's perspective, preferring solitude and imagination as an escape from constant control. Anne could share how her confinement during the war made her value every moment, urging Amanda to balance imagination with the realities of life. Their conversation would explore contrasting yet complementary ways of coping with difficulties.

2. In Amanda, the poet Robin Klein alternates between Amanda's real-life experiences of being constantly reprimanded and her fantasies, where she seeks freedom and peace. This structure emphasises Amanda's deep desire for escape. In every alternate stanza, Amanda withdraws into her imagination as a response to her mother's controlling and critical attitude. The constant nagging leaves Amanda feeling trapped, restricted, and misunderstood, causing her to long for a world where she is free from authority.

Her fantasies, whether imagining herself as a mermaid, an orphan, or Rapunzel, all represent a life of solitude, tranquility, and independence. These imaginative escapes highlight her yearning for silence and space, a stark contrast to the suffocating environment created by her mother's demands and expectations.

3. The poet uses the character of Rapunzel to symbolise Amanda's desire for peace and isolation. Rapunzel lived alone in a tranquil tower, untouched by the outside world's demands. For Amanda, Rapunzel represents an escape from her mother's constant nagging and a life

free from restrictions and responsibilities. By imagining herself as Rapunzel, Amanda envisions a world where she has control and can live in serenity, without anyone dictating her actions.

4. Amanda considering herself an orphan conveys her deep sense of isolation and emotional neglect. She feels as if no one understands or cares for her desires and emotions. Her yearning to be an orphan suggests that, in her mind, life without parental control would be more peaceful, as she would be free from the constant instructions and reprimands she faces at home.
5. (i) The central idea of the poem in these lines reflects Amanda's intense desire for freedom from her mother's constant criticism. She retreats into her fantasy world as Rapunzel, longing for peace and solitude, away from the demands and expectations placed on her.
(ii) (C) authoritative. The mother's tone reflects control and command, expecting Amanda to behave as per her instructions.
(iii) One poetic device used in the extract is alliteration, in "Stop that slouching, Amanda!" where the 's' sound is repeated.
(iv) Amanda imagines herself as Rapunzel to escape into a world of tranquility and solitude, away from her mother's continuous nagging. The idea of living in a quiet, peaceful tower appeals to her, as it represents freedom from authority.

CBSE, 2023

1. Amanda is a little girl in her teens who is constantly nagged by her mother about how to behave and what to do. Amanda feels her freedom is curtailed but she is helpless, so she imagines herself as a mermaid, an orphan and Rapunzel sets herself free in the imaginary world.
2. (i) (c) instructive
(ii) tranquil
(iii) True
(iv) (b) reprimanding
(v) (c) bright

CBSE, 2022

1. In the two lines of the poem given, Amanda's mother's voice is more like an order rather than an instruction. This shows that she is a nagging mother who constantly nags and instructs Amanda for something or the other. Amanda is just a small child who will obviously do things differently. But at the same time, her mother's restricting and authoritative voice seems to loom over her desire to be free and have her own space to learn/grow.
2. The poem 'Amanda' is about a girl being told what to

do or not do. Being blamed for a number of things. Amanda had to listen to her mother's instructions. 'Two things she was blamed for were that she shouldn't bite her nails and eat chocolates.'

CBSE, 2021

1. (i) (b) it may affect her face
(ii) (a) full of annoyance
(iii) (c) In a tower
(iv) (a) Rapunzel lived away from her parents/guardian.
(v) (b) peaceful

7

CHAPTER

The Trees

Poet: Adrienne Rich



Previous Year Questions

CBSE, 2024

1. My head is full of whispers

Which tomorrow will be silent. Listen. The glass is breaking. The trees are stumbling forward into the night. Winds rush to meet them. The moon is broken like a mirror, its pieces flash now in the crown of the tallest Oak.

(The Trees)

(i) Identify the figure of speech used in the line: "The Trees are stumbling forward into the night".

(ii) Explain the significance of the line:

"The moon is broken like a mirror, its pieces flash now in the crown of the tallest Oak, Answer in about 40 words.

(iii) Complete the sentence with the appropriate option. In the third line, the word 'Listen' is used to _____ .

- (a) serve no purpose but to complete the sentence.
- (b) emphasize listening carefully to the sound of glass breaking.
- (c) emphasize listening carefully as a change is about to take place.
- (d) make the reader more attentive.

(iv) What does the line "My head is full of whispers which tomorrow will be silent tell us about the poet's state of mind?

CBSE, 2020

1. _____ Winds rush to meet them. The moon is broken like a mirror, Its piece flash now in the crown of the tallest oak.

(a) The above lines were written by

- (i) Robert Frost (ii) John Berryman
- (iii) Robin Klein (iv) Adrienne Rich

(b) The crown of the oak lies in its

- (i) top most branch (ii) roots
- (iii) rich and tasty fruit (iv) broad leaves

(c) The winds are rushing to meet the _____

(d) Find the word from the extract which means the same as 'shine.

2. The trees inside are moving out into the forest, the forest that was empty all these days where no bird could sit no insect hide no sun bury its feet in shadow the forest that was empty all these nights will be full of trees by morning.

(a) What are the trees trying to do?

(b) Why was the forest empty?

(c) All these days, the forest referred to here was _____.

- (i) filled (ii) empty
- (iii) hidden (iv) separated

(d) The figure of speech used in these lines is.

- (i) Simile (ii) Alliteration
- (iii) Personification (iv) Metonymy



Explanations

CBSE, 2024

1. (i) The figure of speech used in the line "The trees are stumbling forward into the night" is personification. Trees are given human characteristics of "stumbling" and moving "forward into the night."
- (ii) The significance of the line "The moon is broken like a mirror, its pieces flash now in the crown of the tallest Oak" lies in its vivid imagery and metaphor. It suggests a dramatic and fragmented scene where the moonlight reflects off the leaves, creating an image of broken mirror pieces. This emphasizes the chaos and transformation in nature, hinting at a larger upheaval or change.
- (iii) (c) emphasize listening carefully as a change is about to take place.
- (iv) The line "My head is full of whispers which

tomorrow will be silent" indicates the poet's state of mind is preoccupied with thoughts and anxieties that are transient. It suggests a sense of urgency and the fleeting nature of concerns that seem significant now but may fade away by tomorrow.

CBSE, 2020

1. (a) (iv) Adrienne Rich
(b) (i) top most branch
(c) trees
(d) flash
1. (a) The trees are trying to move out into the forest.
(b) The forest was empty because there were no trees, birds or insects and it is because humans have destroyed the forest for building cities and other uses.
(c) (ii) empty
(d) (iii) personification

8

CHAPTER

Fog

Poet: *Carl Sandburg*



Previous Year Questions

No questions from this poem in last 5 years

|





Explanations

No questions from this poem in last 5 years

|

9

CHAPTER

The Tale of Custard the Dragon

Poet: Ogden Nash



Previous Year Questions

CBSE, 2024

1. What makes Custard, the dragon look fearsome? Explain.
 2. Belinda and other animals have been described as brave. But on seeing the pirate they behaved in a cowardly way. How did they react? (The Tale of Custard the Dragon)
 3. Belinda was as brave as a barrel full of bears, And Ink and Blink chased lions down the stairs, Mustard was as brave as a tiger in a rage. But Custard cried for a nice safe cage.
(The Tale of Custard the Dragon)
- (i) Comment upon the contrast that is reflected in the last two lines of the extract.
- (ii) Fill in the blank with one word.
While describing Ink and Blink, the speaker says that they could chase lions down the stairs. By saying so, he is revealing the characteristic of their personality.
- (iii) Comment on the poet's use of language in these

lines in about 40 words.

- (iv) Which of the following best describes the theme of the poem?
- (a) Bravery and heroism
 - (b) Humility leads to bravery
 - (c) Valour and diligence
 - (d) Crisis reveals character
4. The Tale of Custard the Dragon is a humorous ballad. How does Ogden Nash create humour and entertainment in the poem ?

CBSE, 2023

1. What character trait is revealed of Custard when he accepts that the other animals are braver than him.

CBSE, 2022

1. Why did everyone laugh at the 'realio, trulio' dragon?
2. How was Belinda's behavior with the dragon?
Why was the dragon called Percival by the other pets?



Explanations

CBSE, 2024

1. Custard the dragon appears fearsome due to his vivid description, including his "big sharp teeth" and "spikes on his back." However, despite this intimidating appearance, he is ironically timid, highlighting the contrast between his looks and his gentle nature, which adds depth to his character.
2. In "The Tale of Custard the Dragon," Belinda and her pets initially show bravery in everyday adventures. However, when confronted by the pirate, they react with fear: Mustard flees, Ink hides, and Blink strategically finds safety. Only Custard, usually timid, surprises everyone by bravely confronting the pirate and ultimately saving the day, contrasting with the others' frightened reactions.
- 3.(i) The contrast reflected in the last two lines of the extract is between bravery and fear. While Mustard and his friends (Belinda, Ink, and Blink) are depicted as brave and fearless in facing dangerous situations (like bears and lions), Custard stands out as the opposite. Custard cries for a "nice safe cage," indicating his fearfulness and desire for safety rather than bravery.
- (ii) imaginary
- (iii) The poet uses vivid and imaginative language to create a whimsical and playful atmosphere in the poem. The comparisons such as "brave as a barrel full of bears" and "brave as a tiger in a rage" evoke strong visual imagery, while the contrasting portrayal of Custard adds humor and depth to the theme of bravery.
- (iv) (a) Bravery and heroism
4. Ogden Nash creates humor in "The Tale of Custard the Dragon" through playful language, unexpected rhymes, and whimsical descriptions of the characters. He contrasts Belinda's bravery with Custard's initial cowardice, using exaggerated

details about Custard's fears and the pirate's comical encounter with the dragon. The poem's light-hearted tone and imaginative storytelling entertain readers with its blend of bravery, cowardice, and unexpected heroism.

CBSE, 2023

1. Custard was a true hero of the poem. Custard is never seen to boast about his bravery and courage like other inmates of the house. When he accepts that the other animals are braver than him, it shows its humbleness. When the real situation arises and everybody leaves Belinda, Custard takes over the situation like a true hero.

CBSE, 2022

1. Even though Custard looked ferocious on the outside, he was a cowardly dragon on the inside. He didn't intimidate⁷ Belinda or her little pets, rather he had deep love for Belinda and his other animal friends.

Because Custard always cried and wanted to rest in a 'nice safe cage' the other animals would tease him and call him a crybaby. His cowardice made him the laughing stock⁸ of the house.

2. Belinda was fond of Custard, the dragon. She would play with him, laugh and tickle him. Custard would also enjoy the games. She loved Custard but would join her pets in laughing and making fun of the cowardly dragon.

Percival was one of the most innocent but also brave knights in King Arthur's court. The other knights were envious of Percival's popularity with King Arthur.

The other pets call the dragon Percival because they feel that Belinda loves Custard the dragon more than them, and they are jealous of the love he gets from Belinda.

10

CHAPTER

For Anne Gregory

Poet: William Butler Yeats



Previous Year Questions

CBSE, 2024

1. Answer in 40-50 words:
Explain, why the speaker mentions God in the poem "For Anne Gregory".
2. Do you think you can love a person for his/her inner beauty alone and not care about the physical appearance?
Justify with reference to the theme of the poem 'For Anne Gregory'.
3. You have been chosen to address the school assembly, to speak on the epistemology of loss and the resilience of the human spirit during times of crisis. Prepare the speech draft, with reference to the commonality of themes in 'The Ball Poem' by John Berryman and 'From the Diary of Anne Frank'.
You may begin this way:
Good morning everyone.
Today, I'd like to discuss two pieces of literature that offer a powerful insight into how to deal with loss and the resilience of the human spirit required during times of crisis.
You may end this way:

To conclude, I'd like to say that
Thank you.

CBSE, 2020

- (A) Read the extract given below and answer the questions that follow: "Never shall a young man,
Thrown into despair
By those great honey-coloured
Ramparts at your ear,
Love you for yourself alone
And not your yellow hair."
1. The lady's hair is compared to
(i) ramparts (ii) ears
(iii) honey (iv) despair
 2. The young man has fallen in love with the lady for her:
(i) wealth (ii) social position
(iii) looks (iv) mind
 3. Name the poem and the poet.
 4. According to the poet, the lady wants the young man to love her for _____.



Explanations

CBSE, 2024

1. In *For Anne Gregory*, the speaker mentions God to emphasise that only God can love a person for their inner qualities, beyond physical appearance. The speaker contrasts human nature, which tends to value beauty, with divine love, which transcends external looks and appreciates true inner worth.
2. The poem "*For Anne Gregory*" by W.B. Yeats suggests that true love should value inner qualities over physical appearance. The speaker doubts if anyone can love solely based on inner beauty, as even changing hair color could alter others' feelings. An old religious man in the poem implies that only God can love unconditionally, focusing on the person inside rather than outward traits like "yellow hair." Yeats thus questions if humans can truly love beyond superficial appearances, highlighting the poem's theme of deeper, spiritual love.
3. Good morning everyone.

Today, I'd like to discuss two pieces of literature that offer a powerful insight into how to deal with loss and the resilience of the human spirit required during times of crisis: "*The Ball Poem*" by John Berryman and "*From the Diary of Anne Frank*".

In "*The Ball Poem*", the boy learns about loss when his ball is lost forever. This poem reflects on how we must face and accept loss as a part of life, teaching us resilience through hardship.

Similarly, Anne Frank's diary captures her resilience while hiding from the Nazis during World War II. Her words illustrate how hope, courage, and the strength to endure adversity can sustain us through even the darkest times.

To conclude, I'd like to say that both pieces remind us that while loss is inevitable, our ability to endure and grow from it defines our resilience as individuals.

Today, I'd like to discuss two pieces of literature that offer a powerful insight into how to deal with loss and the resilience of the human spirit required

during times of crisis. These works, "*The Ball Poem*" by John Berryman and "*From the Diary of Anne Frank*," though distinct in their contexts and forms, converge on profound themes of loss and the indomitable human spirit.

In "*The Ball Poem*," Berryman narrates a seemingly simple event: a young boy loses his ball. At first glance, this may appear trivial, but Berryman delves deeper into the boy's psyche, exploring the significance of this loss. The ball represents more than a mere toy; it symbolizes the boy's innocence and the irrevocable passage of time. As the ball bounces away, so too does a part of his childhood, teaching him an early lesson in the inevitability of loss. Berryman writes, "Balls will be lost always, little boy, / And no one buys a ball back." This poignant statement underscores the permanence of loss and the necessity of acceptance.

Similarly, Anne Frank's diary entries reflect profound experiences of loss and the remarkable resilience of the human spirit. Living in hiding during the horrors of World War II, Anne confronts the loss of normalcy, freedom, and ultimately, her life. Yet, amidst these harrowing circumstances, she exhibits extraordinary strength and hope. Anne's reflections reveal a young girl grappling with fear and uncertainty, yet she remains resilient. In one of her famous lines, she writes, "In spite of everything, I still believe that people are really good at heart." This optimism, in the face of unimaginable adversity, highlights the resilience of the human spirit.

Both pieces of literature teach us that loss is an inherent part of life. Berryman's young boy learns to cope with the loss of his ball, an allegory for all losses we experience as we grow older. Anne Frank's writings remind us of the resilience required to endure more profound and traumatic losses. Despite the magnitude of their respective losses, both the boy and Anne demonstrate a capacity to confront and transcend their pain.

Moreover, these works emphasize the importance of internal strength and hope. The boy in "*The Ball Poem*" learns to accept his loss and move

forward, while Anne Frank, even in the direst of circumstances, finds hope and maintains her belief in human goodness. This resilience is a testament to the strength that lies within each of us.

To conclude, I'd like to say that loss, in its many forms, is an inevitable part of our human experience. However, as we learn from "The Ball Poem" and Anne Frank's diary, it is our resilience, our ability to hope, and our inner strength that enable us to endure and rise above the challenges we face. These

qualities are what define the human spirit and make it truly remarkable. Thank you.

CBSE, 2020

- (A)**
- 1.(i) ramparts
 2. (iii) looks
 3. The name of the poem is 'For Anne Gregory' and the poet is W.B. Yeats.
 4. herself and not just her outlook

Footprints Without Feet

1

CHAPTER

A Triumph of Surgery

Author: James Herriot



Previous Year Questions

CBSE, 2024

1. Answer any two out of the following three questions, in 40-50 words each:

- (i) What does Mr. Herriot mean by “happy period” for himself and his partners? Explain. (A Triumph of Surgery)
- (ii) “We are often over-indulgent towards people we care about.” Explain with reference to the context of the story “A Triumph of Surgery”.

2. The expected call came within a few days. Mrs. Pumphrey was distraught. Tricki would eat nothing. Refused even his favourite dishes; and besides he had bouts of vomiting. He spent all his time lying on a rug, panting. Didn't want to go for walks, didn't want to do anything.

I had made my plans in advance. The only way was to get Tricki out of the house for a period. I suggested that he be hospitalised for about a fortnight to be kept under observation.

(A Triumph of Surgery)

- (i) Which of the following is not a reason why Mr. Herriot thinks Tricki needs to be taken out of the house for a period?
 - (a) He wanted to keep Tricki away from Mrs. Pumphrey.
 - (b) He wanted to keep Tricki under observation.
 - (c) He wanted to do an experiment on Tricki.
 - (d) He wanted to improve Tricki's health.
- (ii) What was the main reason for Mrs. Pumphrey to be distraught? Answer in about 40 words.

- (iii) State True or False:

When Mr. Herriot says, "I had made my plans in advance"- what he actually means is, he had already seen this trauma. coming for Tricki.

- (iv) Which of the following best describes Mrs. Pumphrey?
 - (a) unkind and inconsiderate
 - (b) impractical but compassionate
 - (c) anxious and ambitious
 - (d) fearful but confident

CBSE, 2023

- 1. Why was Mr. Herriot shocked at Tricki's appearance?
- 2. How did Mrs. Pumphrey treat Tricki?
- 3. Dr. Herriot knew his patients as well as their owners really well. Discuss.

CBSE, 2022

1. Mrs Pumphrey as a pet owner was :

- (i) indulgent (ii) carefree
- (iii) rich (iv) foolish

Choose the correct option:

- (a) (i) and (ii) (b) (ii) and (iii)
- (c) (ii) and (iv) (d) (i) and (iv)

CBSE, 2021

1. Why does Mrs. Pumphrey not deserve to keep a pet?

CBSE, 2020

1. What was the major flaw in Tricki?



Explanations

CBSE, 2024

1. In *A Triumph of Surgery*, Mr. Herriot refers to the "happy period" as the time when Tricki, the pampered dog, was staying at his clinic. During this time, Tricki improved in health, and Herriot and his partners enjoyed a relaxed atmosphere as Tricki's presence brought joy and no extra workload.

Answer in 40-50 words.

- (i) In *A Triumph of Surgery*, Mrs. Pumphrey's overindulgence towards Tricki, her pet dog, highlights how care can sometimes be excessive. She feeds him rich foods and pampers him to the point where Tricki becomes seriously ill. Her overindulgence, stemming from affection, ultimately harms Tricki, requiring Mr. Herriot's intervention.
2. (c) He wanted to do an experiment on Tricki.
- (ii) Mrs. Pumphrey was distraught because Tricki had stopped eating, even refusing his favourite dishes. He had become lethargic, spent all his time lying down, panting, and showed no interest in his usual activities, like going for walks.
- (iii) True. When Mr. Herriot says, "I had made my plans in advance," he means he had anticipated Tricki's condition worsening due to overindulgence and was ready to suggest hospitalisation to improve his health.
- (iv) The correct answer is:
(b) impractical but compassionate.

CBSE, 2023

1. Mr. Herriot was shocked at Tricki's appearance because the dog had become over-weight. Mr. Herriot compared the dog to a bloated sausage with a leg at each corner. The dog's eyes were bloodshot and rheumy, stared straight ahead and his tongue lolled from his jaws. It made Mr. Herriot worried about the Tricki.
2. Mrs. Pumphrey was a young, rich and well to do lady. She pampered her pet dog Tricki. She used to spend on the well-being and maintenance of her pet. Once she overfed her dog by giving him malt,

cod-lover oil and fruits and vegetables and what not. That dog also loved to eat sweets, ice-creams and chocolates. So, she couldn't be strict and deny him the sweet treats. She gave in to Tricki's greedy demands. She was worried when her dog became listless. She could not live without him.

3. Dr. Herriot deeply understood both his animal patients and their owners. His experience in rural Yorkshire helped him build trust and strong relationships. He treated animals with care, considering their environment and owners' concerns. His empathy and communication skills reassured pet owners, making treatments more effective. His stories in *All Creatures Great and Small* highlight his bond with both animals and humans, making him a beloved veterinarian.

CBSE, 2022

1. (d) (i) and (iv) – indulgent and foolish

CBSE, 2021

1. Mrs. Pumphrey does not deserve to keep a pet because she is overly indulgent and lacks the responsibility needed to maintain a pet's health. She spoils her dog, Tricki, with excessive food and treats, ignoring the consequences of overfeeding. Her lack of discipline leads to Tricki becoming overweight and sick. Though she loves him dearly, her misguided care harms him, showing that she is unfit to handle a pet responsibly.

CBSE, 2020

1. The major flaw in Tricki was his greed for food. He was excessively pampered by Mrs. Pumphrey, who constantly fed him rich food, leading to obesity and poor health. Tricki lacked self-control and would eat whatever was given to him, making him overweight and lethargic. His overindulgence in food, combined with a lack of exercise, resulted in serious health issues, requiring veterinary intervention.

2

CHAPTER

The Thief's Story

Author: Ruskin Bond



Previous Year Questions

CBSE, 2024

1. Hari Singh says "He knew it but neither his lips nor his eyes showed anything."

Anil successfully addressed the situation by not addressing it at all. Elaborate based on your reading of The Thief's Story.

2. I went back to the bazaar and sat down in the shelter of the clock tower. The clock showed midnight. I felt for the notes. They were damp from the rain.

Anil's Money. In the morning he would probably have given me two or three rupees to go to the cinema, but now I had it all.

I couldn't cook his meals, run to the bazaar, or learn to write whole sentences any more.

I had forgotten about them in the excitement of the theft. Whole sentences, I knew, could one day bring me more than a few hundred rupees. It was a simple matter to steal and sometimes just as simple to be caught.

(The Thief's Story)

- (i) Which of the following is NOT a reason why Hari Singh thinks he would not be able to write whole sentences?
- (a) Anil would not be there to teach him.
 - (b) He had robbed Anil and left.
 - (c) He would not go back to Anil to learn.
 - (d) He had no money to take admission in school.
- (ii) Why is it fair to say that Hari Singh's tone, when he says "I couldn't cook his meals, run to the bazaar or learn to write whole sentences any more," is filled with remorse and regret? Answer in about 40 words.
- (iii) What do you infer about Hari Singh from this statement? "Whole sentences, I knew, could one day bring me more than a few hundred rupees."

- (iv) State True or False with reference to the given extract. The reason. Hari Singh was filled with a feeling of guilt was because Anil trusted him.

3. Answer any one of the following two questions in 100-120 words.

- (a) Imagine that Hari Singh from The Thief's Story' by Ruskin Bond, writes a diary entry, exploring the theme of human values and relations that are essential in life and can transform a person in the context of his own experience. Write this diary entry as Hari Singh.

(The Thief's Story)

CBSE, 2023

1. How did Hari Singh justify to himself his stealing Anil's money?

CBSE, 2022

1. After cooking a bad meal and told to go away, Hari stayed on as he:
- (a) needed a job.
 - (b) needed shelter.
 - (c) wanted to steal something.
 - (d) found Anil to be very simple.

CBSE, 2021

1. On what condition did Anil employ Hari Singh? How did Hari Singh fail in his job?

CBSE, 2020

1. Hari Singh is both a thief and a human being. Comment.
2. Why does Anil not hand Hari Singh over to the police?
3. In which queer way did Anil make a living?



Explanations

CBSE, 2024

1. Yes it is absolutely true that anil addressed the situation but he behaved like he had not addressed anything. It was not only because of his kind heart. Anil had a great trust on hari singh. Hari Singh took the money but after that he didn't escaped. This is because he felt anil's love, trust and compassion towards him. Anil also felt that if he would address him as a thief and send him to jail then there could be a greater possibility that the small thief would be converted into a criminal after coming Out. Hari Singh also required studies. So not to destroy Hari Singh's future was one of the thought that made anil to the act in a simple manner. Anil also believed that there could be the possibility that Hari Singh would change his mood and passion.
2. (i) (d) He had no money to take admission in school.
(ii) It is fair to say that Hari Singh's tone is filled with remorse and regret because he realizes the consequences of his actions. He understands that by stealing from Anil, he has lost the opportunity to learn and improve his life, which Anil was generously offering.
(iii) From this statement, "Whole sentences, I knew, could one day bring me more than a few hundred rupees," we infer that Hari Singh recognizes the long-term value of education and literacy. He understands that learning to read and write can offer him better and more legitimate opportunities in the future than stealing ever could.

(iv) True

3. 10 October 2024

Dear Diary,

Today has been a day of reckoning for me. I've always lived by taking what I needed, often without considering the consequences. But today, I faced a dilemma that made me question everything. Anil, the man I tried to steal from, showed me kindness

and trust instead of anger or betrayal. His simple gestures of teaching me to cook and write left a deep impact on me.

I realized that human values like trust, kindness, and forgiveness are not weaknesses, but strengths that can transform a person. Anil's faith in me, despite my deceit, made me reflect on my own actions and the emptiness of my previous life. I returned the money I stole, not out of fear, but out of a newfound respect.

Today taught me that relationships built on honesty and mutual respect are the true wealth in life. I want to learn from Anil, to become a better person, and perhaps, to find redemption.

Yours sincerely,

Hari Singh

CBSE, 2023

1. Hari Singh justified stealing Anil's money by convincing himself that Anil would hardly notice the loss since he was careless with his finances. He also believed that stealing from Anil was not entirely wrong because Anil did not pay him wages. Moreover, he thought it was a part of his profession as a thief. However, despite these justifications, his conscience troubled him, leading him to return the stolen money.

CBSE, 2022

1. (c) wanted to steal something

CBSE, 2021

1. Anil employed Hari Singh on the condition that he would be willing to learn how to cook. Anil did not offer a fixed salary but promised to feed and teach him. However, Hari Singh failed in his job because he did not know how to cook. The first meal he prepared was terrible, and Anil had to throw it away. Despite this failure, Anil did not dismiss him and instead patiently tried to teach him.

1. Hari Singh is a skilled and cunning thief, but he is also capable of change and redemption. Despite his dishonest ways, he has a conscience and desires a better life. His decision to return Anil's stolen money shows that he values trust and kindness over crime. This inner conflict makes him more than just a thief—he is a human being with emotions and the potential for transformation.
2. Anil does not hand Hari Singh over to the police because he understands that kindness and trust can

reform a person better than punishment. He sees potential in Hari and chooses to give him another chance. By forgiving him and not mentioning the theft, Anil encourages Hari to choose an honest path in life.

3. Anil made a living in an unusual way by writing articles, earning money irregularly, and sometimes struggling financially. He lived a simple, carefree life, spending what he had freely. Unlike others with stable jobs, his income was uncertain, depending on his writing skills and the success of his articles.

The Midnight Visitor

Author: Robert Arthur



Previous Year Questions

CBSE, 2024

1. Who was Henry? What role did he play in Ausable's plan? (The Midnight Visitor)
2. Despite his unusual appearance, Ausable's presence of mind helped him get rid of Max.
Comment with reference to the story 'The Midnight Visitor'.
3. One should never judge a book by its cover. Explain with reference to Ausable and how he outwits Max with his presence of mind. (The Midnight Visitor)

CBSE, 2023

1. Describe Max as a secret agent.

CBSE, 2020

1. How is Ausable different from other secret agents?
2. Read the given extracts and answer the questions that follow:

Ausable moved to an armchair and sat down heavily. "I'm going to raise the devil with the management this time, and you can bet on it," he said grimly. "This is the second time in a month that somebody has got into my room through that nuisance of a balcony!"

- (a) Who is Ausable?
 - (i) A secret agent
 - (ii) A tourist in a hotel
 - (iii) A reporter
 - (iv) A businessman
- (b) Why was Ausable angry with the management?
 - (i) His room was unsafe.
 - (ii) The food was not good.
 - (iii) The balcony was a nuisance.
 - (iv) The armchair was not soft.
- (c) Was there a balcony with the room? Yes/No.
- (d) Ausable was playing a _____ on his visitor.



Explanations

CBSE, 2024

1. Henry was a waiter at the hotel where Ausable stayed. He played an unwitting role in Ausable's plan to outsmart Max. Ausable pretended that Henry was coming to deliver drinks, but hinted it was actually a policeman. This misled Max into believing he was trapped, leading to his fatal mistake.

Answer in 40-50 words.

2. Despite his unusual appearance, Ausable's quick thinking helped him outsmart Max. He invented a story about a balcony to explain Max's entry. When Henry, the waiter, knocked, Ausable pretended it was the police, causing Max to panic and escape through the nonexistent balcony. Ausable's presence of mind turned a dangerous situation into a clever victory.

Answer in 40-50 words.

3. Ausable, despite appearing unimpressive and unlike a typical spy, demonstrates cleverness and quick thinking. He uses his calm demeanor and a fabricated story about a balcony to trick Max. When Henry, the waiter, knocks, Ausable pretends it's the police, causing Max to panic and escape through a nonexistent balcony, showcasing Ausable's sharp intellect.

CBSE, 2023

1. Max, the secret agent in *The Midnight Visitor*, is portrayed as **overconfident yet incompetent**. Unlike the typical image of a spy, he is nervous, clumsy, and lacks intelligence. He tries to extract information from Ausable forcefully but is easily outwitted. His lack of foresight and poor planning lead to his downfall when he falls for Ausable's trick about the non-existent balcony. Max's character contrasts sharply with a skilled secret agent, making him appear foolish.

CBSE, 2020

1. Ausable is different from other secret agents because he does not fit the typical image of a spy. Unlike the sharp, athletic, and action-oriented agents seen in movies, Ausable is fat, slow-moving, and speaks with an accent. However, he is highly intelligent and resourceful. He uses his quick thinking and presence of mind to outsmart his enemies rather than relying on physical strength. His ability to deceive Max with the fake balcony story showcases his cleverness.
2. (a) (i) A secret agent
(b) (i) His room was unsafe.
(c) No.
(d) Trick.

4

CHAPTER

A Question of Trust

Author: Victor Canning



Previous Year Questions

CBSE, 2024

1. Answer ANY ONE of the following two questions in 100-120 words:

How did the lady in red manage to outsmart and out maneuver the other thief, Horace Danby, by robbing the safe without leaving a single fingerprint? (A Question of Trust)

2. Horace Danby was a typical thief. Describe how he planned his work. (A Question of Trust)
3. "Horace Danby is a thief who was cheated by another thief." Justify. (A Question of Trust)

CBSE, 2023

1. What does the phrase 'honour among thieves' mean? Why does Horace get angry at this phrase?



Explanations

CBSE, 2024

1. In *A Question of Trust* by Victor Canning, the lady in red outsmarts Horace Danby with clever manipulation and deceit. Posing as the lady of the house, she catches Horace in the act of robbing the safe. She pretends to be in distress over having forgotten the combination to the safe and persuades Horace to open it for her, claiming she needs to retrieve some jewellery. Horace, eager to please her, opens the safe without any suspicion. After he leaves, the lady takes all the valuables, ensuring that Horace unknowingly does the hard work for her. She wears gloves, leaving no fingerprints, while Horace, foolishly, handles everything barehanded, leaving his prints behind.
2. Horace Danby, though a thief, was meticulous and methodical in planning his work. He carefully selected one house each year to rob, ensuring it was wealthy and well-maintained. Horace spent weeks studying the target house, learning its layout, security arrangements, and the movements of its inhabitants. He chose times when the owners were away on holiday to avoid confrontation. Horace prided himself on his

knowledge of safes and his ability to disable alarms. He would break into houses with precision, leaving minimal evidence behind. His careful planning and cautious approach allowed him to maintain a facade of respectability, as he led a quiet, ordinary life as a lockmaker the rest of the time.

Answer in 40-50 words.

3. In *A Question of Trust*, Horace Danby, a meticulous thief, is outsmarted by a cunning woman who pretends to be the lady of the house. She manipulates Horace into opening the safe for her, and then steals the valuables herself, leaving him to take the blame.

CBSE, 2023

1. The phrase "honour among thieves" means that even criminals are expected to be loyal to each other and not betray their own kind. Horace Danby gets angry at this phrase because he feels betrayed by the young woman who tricked him. He believed she was also a thief like him and expected her to follow this unspoken rule. However, she deceived him and left him to be caught, breaking the supposed "honour" among thieves.

Footprints Without Feet

Author: H.G. Wells



Previous Year Questions

CBSE, 2024

1. Answer any one of the following two questions, in 100-120 words:

Imagine that Griffin's conscience pricks him and he decides to write a diary entry, about misusing science and endangering society, in the context of his own experience.

Write this diary entry, as Griffin, in about 120 words.

(Reference Footprints without Feet by H.G. Wells)
(CBSE, 2024)

2. Scientists contribute to make the world a better place. Griffin is an antithesis to this statement. Justify.

(Footprints Without Feet)

3. Griffin's brilliance as a man of science fades before his darker traits. Give reasons from the text to support your answer.

(Footprints Without Feet)

4. The arrival of a stranger at an inn in winter was in any case an unusual event. A stranger of such uncommon appearance set all tongues wagging. Mrs. Hall, the landlord's wife, made every effort to be friendly. But Griffin had no desire to talk, and told her. "My reason for coming to Iping is a desire for solitude. I do not wish to be disturbed in my work. Besides, an accident has affected my face." Satisfied that her guest was an eccentric scientist, and in view of the fact that he had paid her in advance, Mrs. Hall was prepared to excuse his strange habits and irritable temper.

(Footprints Without Feet)

- (i) State any one inference about Griffin from the given context: "My reason for coming to Iping is a desire for solitude. I do not wish to be disturbed in my work. Besides, an accident has affected my face."

- (ii) State True or False:

Even though Mrs. Hall was satisfied with Griffin, she was skeptical to excuse his strange habits and irritable temper.

- (iii) It was not difficult for Griffin to convince the landlord and his wife about his strange appearance and eccentric behaviour. Elaborate in about 40 words with reference to the context.

- (iv) Which phrase would correctly substitute 'set all tongues wagging' in the given sentence from the extract? A stranger of such uncommon appearance _____.

5. A character arc is the transformation or development of a character throughout a story and refers to the changes a character undergoes as a result of his/her experiences, challenges and interactions with other characters.

In light of the above information, trace the character arc of Griffin in H.G. Wells' 'Footprints without Feet'.

CBSE, 2023

Read the following extract and answer the questions that follow:

His landlord disliked him and tried to eject him. In revenge, Griffin set fire to the house. To get away without being seen he had to remove his clothes. Thus it was that he became a homeless wanderer, without clothes, without money and quite invisible - until he happened to step in some mud, and left footprints as he walked!

1. Griffin's landlord tried to eject him because.

- (a) he was a lawless person.
- (b) he had set his house on fire.
- (c) he didn't like him
- (d) he was a drug addict.

2. Fill in the blank with one word only. Griffin deliberately removed his clothes because he wanted to become _____.
3. Select the option that correctly captures the application of the word 'fire' as used in this extract.
 - (a) Griffin said that he would fire the manager.
 - (b) The soldiers opened fire at the enemy
 - (c) His remarks provoked heavy fire from the political opponents
 - (d) The Amar Palace was completely destroyed by the fire.
4. Griffin's presence was felt when
 - (a) he jumped into the water with a splash
 - (b) he wore clothes
 - (c) he left muddy footprints
 - (d) he stepped in mud.
5. Which of the following is not true with reference to the given extract?
 - (a) Griffin had become penniless
 - (b) Griffin promised to behave himself

CBSE, 2022

Read the extract given below and answer the questions/complete the statements that follow by choosing the most appropriate options from the given ones: Without making any noise and with a poker grasped firmly in his hand, the clergyman flung open the door. "Surrender!" Then to his amazement he realised that the room appeared to be empty. He and his wife looked under the desk, and behind the curtains and even up the chimney. There wasn't a sign of anybody. Yet the desk had been opened and the housekeeping money was missing. "Extraordinary affair!" the clergyman kept saying for the rest of the day.

1. The clergyman felt amazed:
 - (a) that there was no one visible in the room.
 - (b) when he saw his wife peeping under the desk.

- (c) the arrangement of furniture had been disturbed.
 - (d) there was nobody even behind the curtains.
2. The clergyman was moving:
 - (i) stealthily (ii) quickly (iii) boldly
 Choose the correct option:
 - (a) (i) is right and (ii) is wrong.
 - (b) (ii) is right and (iii) is wrong.
 - (c) (iii) is right and (i) is wrong.
 - (d) (i) is right and (iii) is wrong.
3. Study the following statements:
 - (i) The clergyman and his wife were thorough in their search.
 - (ii) The thief had failed to take anything.
 Choose the correct option.
 - (a) (i) is the assertion and (ii) is the response.
 - (b) (ii) is the assertion and (i) is the response.
 - (c) (i) is true and (ii) is false.
 - (d) (i) is false and (ii) is true.
4. What is an 'extraordinary affair'?
 - (a) Something very brilliant
 - (b) Something very special
 - (c) Something unusual
 - (d) Something very careful
5. At the loss of his money the clergyman must have felt :
 - (a) sorry
 - (b) sad
 - (c) angry
 - (d) surprised.

CBSE, 2021

1. How was Griffin received at the inn in Iping?

CBSE, 2020

1. A brilliant scientist though he was, Griffin misused his scientific discovery. Illustrate this point by giving any two examples from the story. (100-150 words)



Explanations

CBSE, 2024

1. Thursday

10th October 2024

Dear Diary,

Today, my conscience pricked me. I've used my scientific discoveries not for the betterment of humanity, but for selfish and harmful purposes. My invisibility formula, a brilliant achievement, led me down a dark path. I set fire to my landlord's house, stole money, and terrified innocent people. I see now that my actions have endangered society and caused fear and chaos. Instead of using my discovery to help others, I became a criminal. Science should be used to improve lives, not destroy them. I regret my choices deeply. I hope that someday, my story will serve as a warning about the dangers of misusing scientific knowledge for personal gain.

2. Griffin, despite his scientific brilliance, uses his discovery of invisibility for selfish and harmful purposes rather than for the betterment of society. Instead of contributing positively, he resorts to theft, violence, and causing chaos. His actions are destructive, exemplifying how science can be misused when guided by immoral intentions. Griffin's behaviour contradicts the ethical responsibility that comes with scientific knowledge, portraying him as an antithesis to the ideal image of a scientist working for the greater good.
3. Griffin's intelligence and his groundbreaking discovery of invisibility are overshadowed by his immoral behaviour. He uses his invisibility for personal gain, stealing from shops and tormenting innocent people. His violent tendencies, lack of remorse, and isolation from society reflect his darker side. Instead of using his scientific achievement for good, Griffin becomes a threat to those around him, as seen in his cruel treatment of the people of Iping and his aggressive outbursts. His brilliance is thus eclipsed by his selfishness, cruelty, and disregard for others.

4. (i) Griffin wishes to isolate himself due to his condition

and to avoid suspicion, hinting at his secretive and possibly guilty nature.

- (ii) False.
- (iii) Griffin's claim of a disfiguring accident and his upfront payment convinced Mrs. Hall to overlook his strange appearance and irritable behaviour. His eccentricity, combined with financial assurance, made it easier for him to dismiss any doubts they had.
- (iv) The phrase "caused a stir" would be a suitable substitute. Answer in 100-120 words.

5. Griffin's character arc in *Footprints Without Feet* demonstrates his descent into moral decay. Initially portrayed as a brilliant scientist who discovers the secret to invisibility, his lack of ethical consideration quickly becomes apparent. Instead of using his discovery for good, Griffin's actions are driven by greed, malice, and a desire for power. He begins as a man seeking solitude but soon becomes a criminal, exploiting his invisibility to terrorise others. His transformation is one of increasing alienation and corruption, as his darker traits overpower his scientific brilliance. Griffin's character arc reflects how unchecked ambition and misuse of knowledge can lead to destructive outcomes.

CBSE, 2023

1. (a) 174- he was a lawless person
2. invisible
3. (d) The Amar Palace was completely destroyed by the fire.
4. (c) he left muddy footprints
5. (b) griffin promised to behave himself

CBSE, 2022

1. (d) there was nobody even behind the curtains.
2. (a) (i) is right and (ii) is wrong.
3. (c) (i) is true and (ii) is false.
4. (c) Something unusual.
5. (d) Surprised

CBSE, 2021

1. Griffin's arrival at the inn was met with curiosity, especially from the landlord's wife. A stranger's presence is always an unusual event and Mrs. Hall was all the more eager to be friendly with their new guest.

CBSE, 2020

1. Griffin was a brilliant scientist but he was not a law-abiding person, he carried out experiment after experiment to prove that human body could become

invisible. Finally, one day he swallowed certain rare drugs and his body became transparent just like a thin sheet of glass. When Griffin became invisible he started taking advantage of his scientific discovery. First, he set fire to his landlord's house and ran away. Then he stole food and clothes without paying for it in a London store. When the store opened the next day and the shop assistants started arriving, he ran and escaped by removing his clothes and becoming invisible again. Besides, he also robbed the owner of a theatrical company and stole money from a clergyman's desk.

6

CHAPTER

The Making of a Scientist

Author: Robert W. Peterson



Previous Year Questions

CBSE, 2024

1. Justify how Ebright's mother played an important part in his becoming a scientist. (The Making of a Scientist)
2. "Richie was my whole life after his father died.," said Richard's mother. Describe Richard Ebright's relationship with his mother.
3. How can one say that Ebright's curiosity/inquisitiveness drove him to become a scientist?

CBSE, 2023

1. How did Ebright's mother help him to become a scientist?
2. Why did Richard Ebright raise a flock of butterflies?

CBSE, 2022

1. 'A parent should try to be companion to a child' Explain with reference to Richard's mother.
2. What are the essential qualities for becoming scientist, according to Ebright's teacher?
3. What role did Ebright's mother play in his success? (The Making of a Scientist)

CBSE, 2021

1. Ebright could not win a prize in the Science Fair in class VII. What lesson did he learn?

CBSE, 2020

1. Why did Ebright lose interest in tagging butterflies?
2. How did Richard Ebright's mother help him?



Explanations

CBSE, 2024

1. Ebright's mother played a key role in his journey to becoming a scientist. She encouraged his curiosity, provided him with tools and resources like microscopes and books, and spent evenings working on learning activities with him. Her constant support and involvement nurtured his interest in science and motivated him to pursue it passionately.
2. Richard Ebright had a very close relationship with his mother. After his father died, she became his main companion and supporter. She encouraged his curiosity, provided resources for his scientific interests, and spent evenings learning with him. Her support and involvement were crucial in shaping his passion for science and his overall development.
3. Ebright's curiosity led him to explore and experiment from a young age. He collected butterflies, conducted experiments, and constantly sought answers to scientific questions. His desire to understand how things work drove him to perform research and make discoveries, ultimately leading him to a successful career as a scientist.

CBSE, 2023

1. Richard's mother proved to be a great help. She took him on trips and bought scientific equipment for him. She spent all her time in setting up challenges for him. This helped him to learn a lot. She presented him the book 'The Travels of Monarch X'. The book changes Richard's life forever.
2. The book 'The Travels of Monarch X' was about how monarch butterflies migrate to Central America. By reading the book, it opened the world of science to Richard Ebright. Readers of the book were invited to help study butterfly migration by tagging butterflies for research by Dr. Frederick A. Urquhart. Collecting butterflies one by one would have been a tedious and time-consuming task. Therefore, Richard Ebright raised a flock of butterflies.

CBSE, 2022

1. Parents are the best companion, guide, friend and support system in a child's life. Richard's mother always encouraged her child's curiosity in scientific

research. She brought him microscopes, cameras, and other scientific equipment. Her support played an essential role in Richard's journey as a scientist. Hence, a parent should try to be a companion to a child so that he/she succeeds in life.]

2. According to Mr. Richard A. Weiherer, the essential qualities for becoming a scientist are to have a first rate mind, along with curiosity and the will to win for the right reason. A good scientist must not win for the sake of winning, but to be willing to do the best job he/she can.
3. Richard Ebright's mother played an important role in making him a successful scientist. She not only encouraged him but also bought him scientific equipment, camera, etc. She also took him on trips and prepared various learning activities for him to do. This helped him learn a lot. It was the book "The Travels of Monarch X" that she bought for Richard, which opened the world of science for him.

CBSE, 2021

1. In the seventh grade, Richard participated in the County Science Fair. He displayed slides of frog tissue, which he showed under a microscope. Although he did not win, he understood that simply making a neat display is not enough to win such a competition. The winners had done real experiments. This experience gave Richard Ebright a hint of what real science is.

CBSE, 2020

1. In the story 'The Making of a Scientist' we learned about the work of a famous scientist, Richard Ebright. He used to raise thousands of butterflies to study their habits. He tagged many butterflies and released them to record their migratory habits. Only two of his tagged butterflies returned to him and they had travelled only seventy-five miles. When Ebright saw that there was no feedback from the tagged butterflies, he started losing interest in them.
2. As a child Ebright was always interested in learning new things. His mother encouraged him to learn more by introducing him to the world around him by taking him to trips, bought him telescopes, microscopes, cameras, mounting materials and other equipment, and helped him in many other ways.

7

CHAPTER

The Necklace

Author: Guy de Maupassant



Previous Year Questions

CBSE, 2024

1. What is the twist at the end of the story "The Necklace"? (The Necklace)
2. What is common about the role that Dr. Urquhart and Mr. Weiherer played in Richard Ebright's life? Describe any one commonality with evidence from the text "The Making of a Scientist". (The Necklace)
3. A character arc is the transformation or development of a character throughout a story and refers to the changes a character undergoes as a result of their experiences, challenges, and interactions with other characters.

In the light of the above information, trace the character arc of Matilda in Guy De Maupassant's 'The Necklace', in about 120 words.

CBSE, 2023

1. Mme Loisel's disposition invites her doom. Elucidate

with reference to the text.

2. Contentment in one's life is very important to lead a peaceful life. We should be happy with what we have and should not crave for what we don't have. Matilda suffered in life because she was not content in her life. Her desires led to her disaster. What do you learn from her mistake in life?

CBSE, 2022

1. How did the necklace change the life of Loisel?
2. Matilda realised that one little act of negligence can lead to total ruin. What do you learn from this and how would you move on in life?

CBSE, 2020

1. Mme Forestier proved to be a true friend of the Loiseles. Elaborate.
2. What changes occurred in Matilda's lifestyle after she had lost the necklace?



Explanations

CBSE, 2024

1. The twist in *The Necklace* occurs when Madame Loisel learns that the necklace she borrowed and replaced with a costly one was actually a fake. After ten years of hardship to repay the debt for the replacement, she discovers that the original necklace was made of imitation diamonds, worth far less than she had assumed.
2. Both Dr. Urquhart and Mr. Weiherer played crucial roles in shaping Richard Ebright's success as a scientist by acting as mentors who encouraged his intellectual curiosity and scientific growth. Dr. Urquhart, an expert on butterflies, guided Ebright's research during his studies and inspired him to think beyond simple projects. Similarly, Mr. Weiherer, his high school teacher, recognised Ebright's potential and motivated him to pursue original research rather than merely collecting data. One commonality between them is their emphasis on independent thinking and experimentation. Mr. Weiherer's advice led Ebright to conduct his groundbreaking research on how a cell determines its function, while Dr. Urquhart's mentorship deepened his interest in scientific inquiry, paving the way for his future achievements.
3. In Guy De Maupassant's 'The Necklace,' Matilda undergoes a profound character arc. Initially, she is discontented with her modest life and dreams of luxury and status. This longing drives her to borrow a diamond necklace from a friend for a party, where she revels in the attention and admiration of others. However, the loss of the necklace plunges her into a desperate struggle to replace it, leading to years of hardship and poverty for her and her husband. Through these trials, Matilda experiences a transformation from a vain and discontented woman to one who understands the true value of things and the consequences of her choices. The story's conclusion, where it is revealed the necklace was fake, underscores the irony of her transformation. Thus, Matilda's character arc illustrates the themes of deception, vanity, and the harsh realities of social ambition.

CBSE, 2023

1. Mme. Loisel always craved for a life of riches, exquisite food, sparkling jewellery, etc. However, she did not have such a life, and it upset her. She envied her childhood friend, Mme. Forestier, because the latter had everything that Matilda desired. She borrowed a necklace from her childhood friend to go to a ball, enjoyed being the center of attention at the ball, but somehow lost the necklace in the end. Mme. Loisel and her husband then had to cut down all their expenses, move to an attic and do menial jobs to pay the loan they took to replace the lost necklace. After ten years of struggle, they were able to pay the debt, but it had aged Mme. Loisel a lot. In the end she was even sadder and more bitter than before. Hence, we can easily conclude that her disposition invites her doom.
2. Life is a great mystery. For every individual this mystery of life comes wrapped in a unique package. For some, it is all riches, comfort, name and fame. For some it is nothing but sheer hunger, poverty, anguish and an everyday quest for bare survival. One, however, must learn to live within one's means and be content with what one has. Contentment in one's life is very important to lead a happy and peaceful life. In the light of the story 'The Necklace' we find that Matilda suffered a lot in her life as she was not content in her life. She is of a humble background but dreams of riches and comforts. She is proud of her beauty and wants to be admired. She lost the necklace, worn in the ball, that was borrowed from her old friend. She had to buy a new one exactly same, for that she and her husband had to take a loan. Then it took Loiseles a decade to pay back money they borrowed to buy the

CBSE, 2022

1. Matilda doisel was a charming young lady who always wanted a luxurious life. For attending a ball, she borrowed a necklace from her friend Mme Forestier but eventually lost it. In order to repay the debt for the replaced necklace, the Loiseles had to live a life full of

drudgery and pain for to ten years.

2. Matilda longed for a luxurious life but lived modestly, which made her unhappy. She envied Mme. Forestier and borrowed a diamond necklace to shine at a grand ball. That night, she enjoyed immense admiration, but her joy was short-lived as she lost the necklace. To replace it, the Loisels fell into debt and suffered for ten years. Later, Matilda learned the necklace was fake. This story teaches that vanity and dishonesty lead to misery. Had I been in her place, I would have confessed the loss. Accepting reality and honesty are crucial to avoiding unnecessary hardships in life.

1. Mme. Forestier unknowingly taught Matilda a valuable lesson. When Matilda returned the replaced necklace, she kindly revealed that the original was fake. Though unaware of Matilda's hardships, her honesty saved her from further misery, proving her to be a true and compassionate friend.
2. Matilda's life turned miserable. She dismissed her maid, moved to a smaller house, and did all chores herself. Poverty aged her, making her rough and weary. The once vain and beautiful Matilda transformed into a bitter, hardened woman due to years of struggle.

8

CHAPTER

Bholi

Author: K.A. Abbas



Previous Year Questions

CBSE, 2024

1. Why did Bholi's teacher feel like an artist admiring her masterpiece? (Bholi)
2. Do you think Bholi could have confidently refused to marry Bishamber if she wasn't educated? Give reasons. (Bholi)
3. A character arc is the transformation or development of a character throughout a story and refers to the changes a character undergoes as a result of his/her experiences, challenges and interactions with other characters.

In the light of the above information, trace the character arc of Bholi in K.A. Abbas's 'Bholi'.

4. Imagine that Bholi writes a diary entry, exploring the themes of 'Girl Child' and 'Impact of Education', in the context of her own experiences.

Write this dairy entry, as Bholi.

CBSE, 2023

1. Bholi was believed to be a dumb 'cow'. What turned her into a fearless, bold and confident girl?
2. Education is considered the most important tool for empowering women in society. It plays an important role in social and cultural development. Prove the above statement in the light of the story 'Bholi'.

CBSE, 2022

1. Imagine you are Bholi and you have been invited to give a speech on the importance of girl education. Write the speech on 'Girl Education and Empowerment'.

CBSE, 2020

1. Bholi's heart was overflowing with a 'new hope and a new life'. What does the phrase "a new hope and a new life" mean to Bholi?
2. Why did Bholi not marry Bishamber?
3. Why did Bholi dislike Bishambar?



Explanations

CBSE, 2024

1. Bholi's teacher felt like an artist admiring her masterpiece because she had nurtured Bholi's confidence and self-worth. Through her guidance, Bholi transformed from a fearful, insecure girl into a bold, self-assured individual. The teacher saw this transformation as a testament to her efforts.
2. No, Bholi might not have confidently refused to marry Bishamber if she wasn't educated. Education gave her self-confidence and taught her to value herself. Without education, she may have lacked the courage and knowledge to stand up against societal pressure and make her own decision, especially given her family's expectations and her own insecurities about her appearance and speech.
3. In Bholi by K.A. Abbas, Bholi's character arc shows a remarkable transformation from a timid, underconfident girl to a self-assured and empowered woman. Initially, Bholi is a neglected child due to her stammer and physical appearance, which leads to her insecurity and fear. However, her life changes when she starts attending school, where her teacher's kindness and encouragement help her gain confidence. Over time, Bholi develops self-respect and courage. This growth culminates in her rejecting a greedy and selfish groom, thus asserting her independence and refusing to be treated unfairly. Bholi's journey reflects her strength and resilience, symbolising her victory over societal norms and personal inhibitions.
4. Thursday
09 October 2023
Dear Diary,
Today has been a day of great change for me. I never thought I could speak up like I did. It feels like a miracle. All these years, I was called "Bholi" because of my simple ways and my stammering. But today, I found my voice.
Education has changed everything. It taught me to see myself differently, not just as the girl with pockmarks and a stammer, but as someone with

potential. My teacher believed in me when no one else did. She showed me kindness and patience. She made me realize that being educated means more than just reading and writing—it means finding my strength and speaking up for myself.

Being a girl child in our village isn't easy. We are judged by our appearance and expected to conform to societal norms. But education opened doors for me. It gave me courage to refuse a marriage that was based on greed and not on love or respect. It empowered me to make my own choices.

I know now that education is not just about getting degrees. It's about empowerment. It's about believing in oneself and challenging stereotypes. Today, I am proud of who I am, and I owe it all to the power of education.

Yours truly,
Bholi

CBSE, 2023

1. Bholi was considered a dumb "cow" due to her speech impairment and lack of confidence. However, education transformed her into a fearless and bold girl. Her teacher's encouragement helped her overcome her fear and realize her worth. With knowledge and self-respect, she stood up for herself and refused to marry Bishamber, proving she was no longer weak or submissive.
2. In Bholi, education empowers Bholi by giving her confidence and self-respect. Initially timid, she grows into a strong, independent woman who refuses an unfair marriage. The story highlights how education liberates women from social injustices, helping them make informed decisions and fight for their rights.

CBSE, 2022

Speech on Girl Education and Empowerment

Good morning, respected guests, teachers, and dear friends,

I am honored to stand before you today to speak on a cause close to my heart—girl education and empowerment.

Education is not just about learning to read and write; it is about gaining confidence, self-respect, and independence. A girl who is educated can support herself, make informed decisions, and contribute to society. She is less likely to be oppressed and more likely to stand up for her rights.

My own life is proof of this. I was once a timid girl, considered worthless by society. But education changed me. It gave me the courage to reject injustice and choose my own path. Girls like me deserve the same opportunity—to learn, grow, and lead.

Let us work together to ensure that every girl gets an education. Because when you educate a girl, you empower a nation.

Thank you!

CBSE, 2020

1. The phrase "a new hope and a new life" meant independence and self-respect for Bholi. Education gave her confidence, and she realized her worth. Instead of feeling helpless, she decided to take charge of her life, rejecting societal norms that treated women unfairly.
2. Bholi refused to marry Bishamber because he demanded a dowry of five thousand rupees after seeing her pockmarked face. She chose self-respect over a forced marriage.
3. Bholi disliked Bishamber because he was greedy, heartless, and only cared about money. He was willing to humiliate her for dowry, proving he lacked kindness and integrity.

9

CHAPTER

The Book that Saved the Earth

Author: *Claire Boiko*



Previous Year Questions

CBSE, 2024

1. A well-known book of nursery rhymes saved the world from a Martian invasion. Comment with reference to 'The Book that Saved the Earth'.
2. How did Think Tank interpret the following nursery rhyme?
"How does your garden grow with cockle shells and silver bells?"
(The Book that Saved the Earth)
3. How did Apprentice Noodle act smartly by suggesting something about the book without offending Think-Tank?
(The Book That Saved The Earth)

CBSE, 2023

CBSE, 2022

CBSE, 2021

CBSE, 2020



Explanations

CBSE, 2024

1. In "The Book that Saved the Earth," a book of nursery rhymes prevented Martians from invading Earth. The Martians misunderstood the book's rhymes as Earth's military secrets. This misunderstanding led them to fear Earth's capabilities, causing them to abandon their invasion plans. So, a simple book saved the world by preventing interplanetary conflict.
2. In The Book that Saved the Earth, Think-Tank misinterprets the nursery rhyme "How does your garden grow with cockle shells and silver bells?" as a secret Earth code about advanced agricultural methods. He believes that humans use "bells" and "shells" to control their environment, showcasing his ignorance and arrogance.
3. Apprentice Noodle acted smartly by gently suggesting an alternative interpretation of the books (which Think-Tank thought were sandwiches) without directly contradicting him. Noodle respectfully mentioned that Earthlings used books for communication, not consumption, based on information he recalled. By framing it as a minor detail rather than a correction, Noodle avoided offending Think-Tank's ego and helped redirect the Martian invasion plans based on a more accurate understanding of Earth's culture.

CBSE, 2023

CBSE, 2022

CBSE, 2021

CBSE, 2020